

Xin Shi Wei Zhong

心是謂中 - Complete Translation Variants

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Note for review: these are machine-generated translation variants. The source reference is currently recorded as TBD.

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Passage 1

Source text

心，中，處身之中以君之，目、耳、口、踵四者為相，心是謂中。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center: it dwells in the midst of the body and rules it as lord; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels/feet—serve as its ministers. This heart-mind is what is called the center.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart/mind: the center. It dwells in the center of the body in order to rule it; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers. The heart/mind: this is called the center.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
心	topic / subject	the heart-mind	Classical 心 can mean “heart,” “mind,” or “heart-mind.”
中	predicate / definition	the center / central	Could be read as “is central” or “is the center.”
處	verb	dwells / is situated	Literally “occupies a place.”
身之中	locative phrase	in the middle of the body	身 = body; 之 marks modification: “the body’s middle.”
以	purposive / instrumental marker	in order to / thereby	Links the heart’s position with its ruling function.
君之	verb + object	rule it / be lord over it	君 as verb: “to act as ruler/lord”; 之 likely refers to the body, though the exact referent is not explicit.
目、耳、口、踵	list of nouns	eyes, ears, mouth, heels	踵 literally “heel”; perhaps standing for the lower extremities/feet, but the text says “heels.”
四者	summative phrase	these four	Refers to the four listed items.
為	copular / functional verb	serve as / act as	Introduces their role.
相	noun / role	ministers / assistants	相 can mean “minister,” “assistant,” or “supporting officer.”
心	resumed subject	the heart-mind	Repeats the topic.
是謂	formulaic phrase	this is called / this is what is meant by	是 = “this”; 謂 = “call, say.”
中	term being defined	center / centrality	Repeats the key term 中.

Aligned gloss translation:

“The heart-mind is the center: it is situated in the middle of the body and thereby rules it. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as ministers/assistants. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center.”

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart/mind is the center:
[it dwells in the center of the body and thereby acts as its lord];
[the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers/assistants].

The heart/mind—this is what is called “center.”

Syntax map

- 心，中: topic + definition: “The heart/mind is the center.”
- 處身之中以君之: “[dwelling in the body’s middle] + thereby [ruling/lording over it].”
- 目、耳、口、踵四者為相: “eyes, ears, mouth, heels—the four—serve as ministers.”
- 心是謂中: “As for the heart/mind, this is called ‘center.’”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center: it occupies the middle of the body and thereby rules it. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four—serve as its ministers/assistants. This is why the heart-mind is called “the center.”

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart-mind is the center. It resides in the midst of the body and rules it; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart-mind is what is called the center.

Glossary

- 心 (xin): “heart-mind”; the organ/faculty of cognition and command.
- 中 (zhong): “center,” “middle”; here both spatial and governing centrality.
- 君 (jun): “to rule as lord/ruler.”
- 相 (xiang): “minister,” “assistant”; subordinate functionaries serving the ruler.
- 踵 (zhong): “heel(s),” possibly standing more broadly for the feet or lower bodily movement.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center. It occupies the middle of the body and thereby rules it; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart-mind is what is called “the center.”

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart-mind is the “center.” It occupies the middle of the body and rules over it. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers or assistants. This is why the heart-mind is called the center.

Anchor notes

1. 心 → “heart-mind”: the term can include both feeling and thinking, not just the physical heart.
2. 中 → “center”: both a bodily middle and a governing central position may be implied.
3. 處身之中 → “occupies the middle of the body”: a literal spatial reading.
4. 以君之 → “rules over it”: 君 is used verbally, “to act as ruler/lord.”
5. 目、耳、口、踵 → “eyes, ears, mouth, and heels”: four bodily parts named as subordinate functions.

6. 踵 → “heels”: possibly standing for the feet or movement more broadly, but the literal word is “heels.”
7. 四者為相 → “these four serve as its ministers or assistants”: 相 suggests ministers who aid a ruler.
8. 心是謂中 → “This is why the heart-mind is called the center”: restates the definition after explaining its ruling role.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center.

The heart-mind dwells in the center of the body and thereby rules the body.

The four things—the eyes, the ears, the mouth, and the heels, perhaps meaning the feet—serve as ministers.

The heart-mind is what is called the center.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim: “The heart/mind is the center”: it is called zhong (“center,” “middle,” possibly “centrality”).
- Agency: The heart/mind “dwells in the middle of the body and rules it”; the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are treated as its ministers/assistants.
- Causal relation: Because the heart/mind occupies the body’s central position and governs the other parts, it is what is termed the “center.”
- Uncertainty / interpretive risk: 心 may mean “heart,” “mind,” or “heart-mind”; 中 may be spatial “middle/center” or carry a more normative sense. 踵 literally means “heel,” but may stand more broadly for the feet or movement.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center. It stays in the middle of the body and rules it like a lord. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are its four ministers (helpers to a ruler). This is why the heart-mind is called the “center.”

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

“The heart/mind is the center. It is situated in the center of the body and thereby rules it. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers/assistants. The heart/mind: this is what is called ‘the center.’”

Note: 踵 literally means “heel.” The pairing with eyes, ears, and mouth is somewhat unexpected, so I have kept it as “heels” rather than smoothing it into another organ.

Grammar notes

1. 心: can mean both “heart” and “mind”; here it is the ruling inner faculty, so “heart/mind” is appropriate.
2. 中: functions as a noun, “center” or “middle,” not merely the adjective “central.”
3. 心, 中: an appositional statement: “The heart/mind—the center.”
4. 處身之中: 處 means “to dwell/be situated”; 身之中 means “the middle of the body.”
5. 之 in 身之中: possessive/attributive marker, “of”: “the body’s center.”
6. 以君之: 以 introduces the means or consequence: “thereby / by this”; 君 is used verbally, “to rule as lord”; 之 refers back to the body or the whole person.
7. 目、耳、口、踵四者: “the four things: eyes, ears, mouth, and heels.” 者 nominalizes and gathers the four items.
8. 為相: 為 means “to serve as / act as”; 相 means “minister, assistant, aide.”
9. 心是謂中: 是 can mark the preceding term emphatically: “the heart/mind—this is called the center.”

10. 謂: “to call, to name, to term”; 謂中 = “is called ‘center.’”

Mini vocabulary

- 心 — heart; mind; inner ruling faculty
- 中 — center; middle; central position
- 處 — to dwell; to be situated
- 身 — body; person
- 君 — ruler, lord; to rule
- 目 — eye
- 耳 — ear
- 口 — mouth
- 踵 — heel; to follow upon
- 相 — minister; assistant; aide
- 謂 — to call; to term; to say that something is called

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The heart-mind is the center. It resides in the middle of the body and rules it; the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
心	concept / body organ	“Heart-mind”; identified as the “center” and as ruler of the body	High
中	abstract concept	“Center” or “middle”; the defining status/name of the heart-mind	High
身	body / embodied person	The body within which the heart-mind is situated and over which it rules	High
君	political metaphor / role	“Ruler” or “lord”; describes the governing function of the heart-mind	High
目	body organ	Eye(s); one of the four “ministers” serving the heart-mind	High
耳	body organ	Ear(s); one of the four “ministers” serving the heart-mind	High
口	body organ	Mouth; one of the four “ministers” serving the heart-mind	High
踵	body part	Heel(s); one of the four “ministers” serving the heart-mind. Possibly stands for lower bodily movement, but the text only says “heel(s)”	Medium
相	political metaphor / role	“Minister” or “assistant”; role assigned to the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels in relation to the heart-mind	High

No proper named entities appear in the passage.

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 心 , 中
 - “The heart/mind is the center.”
 - “The heart/mind is centrality.”
 - “As for the heart/mind: it is the middle.”
2. 處身之中以君之
 - “It occupies the middle of the body and thereby rules it.”
 - “Being situated within the body, it acts as its lord.”

- “It places itself at the body’s center in order to govern it.”

3. 目、耳、口、踵四者為相

- “The four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers.”
- “Eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are its assistants.”
- “The four things, eyes, ears, mouth, and heels, act as aides/counselors.”

4. 心是謂中

- “The heart/mind: this is called the center.”
- “This is why the heart/mind is called ‘central.’”
- “The heart/mind is what is meant by ‘the middle.’”

Full translations

A

The heart/mind is the center. It occupies the middle of the body and thereby rules it; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart/mind: this is called the center.

B

As for the heart/mind, it is centrality. Being situated within the body, it acts as its lord; eyes, ears, mouth, and heels, these four, are its assistants. This is why the heart/mind is called “the middle.”

C

The heart/mind is the middle. It places itself at the body’s center in order to govern it, while the four things—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—act as aides. The heart/mind is what is meant by “central.”

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The heart/mind is the center: it occupies the middle of the body and rules it as lord; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels/feet—serve as its ministers. This is why the heart/mind is called the center.”

Sentence confidence

1. 心，中，處身之中以君之，目、耳、口、踵四者為相，心是謂中。

Confidence: 82/100

Reasons: The overall structure is fairly clear: the xin 心 is identified with zhong 中, placed centrally in the body, and described through a ruler–minister metaphor. Main uncertainty lies in whether 中 should be translated literally as “center” or more philosophically as “centrality/the mean,” and whether 踵 means “heels” literally or “feet” by extension.

Top 5 risk phrases with alternatives

1. 心
 - Chosen: “heart/mind”
 - Alternatives: “heart,” “mind,” “the heart-mind”
 - Risk: Classical Chinese 心 often covers both emotional and cognitive functions.
2. 中
 - Chosen: “center”
 - Alternatives: “middle,” “centrality,” “the Mean,” “what is central”
 - Risk: Could be spatial, conceptual, or moral-philosophical.
3. 處身之中

- Chosen: “occupies the middle of the body”
- Alternatives: “is situated at the center of the body,” “dwells within the body’s middle”
- Risk: The phrase may be anatomical, metaphorical, or both.

4. 以君之

- Chosen: “rules it as lord”
- Alternatives: “takes lordship over it,” “governs them,” “serves as its ruler”
- Risk: The pronoun 之 could refer to the body as a whole or to the faculties/organs that follow.

5. 踵

- Chosen: “heels/feet”
- Alternatives: “heels,” “feet,” “steps,” “movement”
- Risk: Literal meaning is “heel,” but in context it may stand for the feet or bodily movement.

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 心

- Alternative: “heart,” “mind,” or “heart-mind.”
- Choice: “heart-mind.”
- Justification: In Classical Chinese, 心 often includes both cognitive and affective functions; “heart-mind” preserves that range.

2. 中

- Alternative: “center,” “middle,” or “mean.”
- Choice: “center.”
- Justification: The passage explains 中 spatially as being “in the middle of the body” and politically as ruling, so “center” fits best. “Mean” would add an ethical/philosophical sense not explicit here.

3. 處身之中以君之

- Alternative: “dwelling in the middle of the body and ruling it,” or “placing itself in the body’s center in order to rule them.”
- Choice: “dwelling in the middle of the body and thereby ruling it.”
- Justification: 之 could refer to the body as a whole, though it may also refer forward/backward to the four organs/parts. The grammar is somewhat compressed.

4. 目、耳、口、踵四者為相

- Alternative: “the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are ministers,” or “serve as assistants.”
- Choice: “the four—the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers.”
- Justification: 相 can mean “minister” or “assistant.” Since 君 “ruler” appears just before, “ministers” preserves the political metaphor.

5. 心是謂中

- Alternative: “the heart-mind is what is called the center,” or “this is why the heart-mind is called the center.”
- Choice: “The heart-mind: this is what is called the center.”
- Justification: The phrasing is definitional and emphatic.

Final translation

The heart-mind is the center: dwelling in the middle of the body, it thereby rules it; the four—the eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Primary translation

“The heart-mind is the center. It occupies the middle of the body and acts as its ruler; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center.”

Deliberately sceptical alternative translation

“The heart/mind, the ‘middle’: it is lodged within the body and is made its lord; the four things—eye, ear, mouth, and heel—are assistants. The heart/mind is what is meant by ‘middle.’”

Where the alternative diverges, and why

- 心: I render it as “heart-mind” or “heart/mind” rather than simply “heart,” because Classical Chinese 心 often covers both the physical heart and the faculty of thought or command.
- 中: “Center” is plausible, but “middle” is more literal and may avoid over-reading it as an abstract doctrine.
- 處身之中: This can mean “occupies the middle of the body,” but more cautiously it may mean simply “is lodged within the body.” The anatomical precision is uncertain.
- 以君之: I translate as “acts as its ruler,” but sceptically this could be “is made its lord” or “thereby lords over it.” The pronoun 之 is not fully explicit: it likely refers to the body or the whole person, but that is inferred.
- 相: “Ministers” fits the political metaphor created by 君 “ruler/lord,” but “assistants” is a more cautious rendering if one does not want to impose a fully bureaucratic image.
- 踵: Literally “heel.” It may stand for movement or the feet more generally, but the text says 踵, so “heel” is retained rather than expanded to “feet.”

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

The heart-mind is the center: it dwells in the middle of the body and thereby rules it. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers/assistants. The heart-mind is what is called “the center.”

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

心者，中也。處於身中，以為其君。目、耳、口、踵四者，為其相。心，是謂中。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 心 is rendered as “heart-mind,” since it may include both physical heart and governing mind; English separates these more than the source does.
- 中 is translated as “center,” but it may also imply “middle” or possibly a normative “centrality/balance”; the translation favors spatial/governing sense.
- 以君之 is rendered “thereby rules it”; literally it is closer to “by/with [this] it is lord over it” or “takes the role of ruler over it.”
- 相 is rendered “ministers/assistants”; it could mean “ministers,” “aides,” or “supporting counterparts.” The political metaphor is preserved but may be stronger in English.
- 踵 is translated as “heels,” literally; if intended more broadly as the lower limbs/feet, the English may be too narrow.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The heart-mind is the center: it dwells in the middle of the body and thereby rules it. The four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart-mind is what is called the center.”

Uncertainty notes

- 心 may mean “heart,” “mind,” or “heart-mind”; I use “heart-mind” to preserve both senses.
- 中 can mean “center,” “middle,” or possibly “central governing position.” Here “center” best fits the repeated contrast with bodily parts.
- 君之 literally suggests “to lord/rule over it/them.” The object 之 is ambiguous: it may refer to the body as a whole, or to the other bodily parts.
- 相 means “minister/assistant/counsellor.” “Ministers” preserves the political metaphor of ruler and officials.
- 踵 literally means “heel.” It may stand for the feet or locomotion more generally, but the text says “heel(s),” so I have kept “heels.”

Red-team alternative

“The heart is the middle: located in the center of the body, it acts as lord over it; the four things—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—are its aides. This heart is called the middle.”

Back-translation audit

- “The heart-mind is the center” ⇌ 心，中
- “dwells in the middle of the body” ⇌ 處身之中
- “and thereby rules it” ⇌ 以君之
- “the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels” ⇌ 目、耳、口、踵四者
- “serve as its ministers” ⇌ 為相
- “The heart-mind is what is called the center” ⇌ 心是謂中

No external historical context, source attribution, or extra named entities have been added.

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart/mind is the center.

It occupies the middle of the body and serves as its ruler.

The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels: these four are its ministers.

The heart/mind—this is called the center.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind is the center. It is situated at the center of the body and rules it; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. Thus the heart-mind is called the center.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Chinese segment	Defensible readings
心	"heart"; "mind"; "heart-mind"
中	"center/middle"; possibly "centrality" or "the mean/equilibrium"
心，中	"The heart-mind is the center"; "As for the heart-mind: it is centrality"
處身之中	"dwells/abides in the middle of the body"; "occupies the body's center"; less literally, "is situated centrally in the person"
以君之	"and thereby rules it" — with "it" = the body/person; or "rules them" — with "them" = the four organs/parts; 君 can be verbal: "act as ruler/lord over"
目、耳、口、踵	"eye, ear, mouth, heel"; 踵 may stand for "heel/foot" or bodily movement/contact
四者為相	"these four serve as ministers/aides"; 相 may mean "minister," "assistant," or "supporting counterpart"
心是謂中	"This is why the heart-mind is called the center"; or "The heart-mind: this is what is meant by 'centrality/the middle'"

Translation 1 — spatial-body and ruler-minister reading

"The heart-mind is the center. It occupies the middle of the body and thereby rules it. The eye, ear, mouth, and heel—these four serve as its ministers. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center."

Translation 2 — "mind" and functional hierarchy reading

"The mind is central. Situated at the center of the person, it acts as lord over the body; the four things—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—are its assistants. This is why the mind is called 'the middle.'"

Translation 3 — more literal, preserving uncertainty around 中

"The heart is 'middle'/centrality: it dwells in the body's middle and uses this to be lord over it. The eye, the ear, the mouth, and the heel, these four, are ministers. The heart—this is termed 中, 'the center' or 'the mean.'"

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

"The heart-mind is the center. It dwells in the midst of the body and rules it as lord; the four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers. The heart-mind: this is what is called the center."

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal

The heart/mind: the center.

It dwells in the middle of the body and thereby rules it.

The four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as ministers.

The heart/mind: this is called "the center."

2. Scholarly

The heart-mind is the "center": situated at the center of the body, it governs the body. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are its four ministers. Thus the heart-mind is what is meant by "center."

3. Plain-language

The heart-mind is the body's center. It sits in the middle and rules over the body. The eyes, ears, mouth, and feet act like its helpers. That is why the heart-mind is called the center.

4. Sceptical

The text presents the heart-mind as “central”: because it is said to occupy the body’s middle, it is treated as the ruler. The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels are cast as subordinate aides. On this basis, the heart-mind is named “the center.”

5. Uncertainty-marked

The “heart/mind” is [called] the “center.”

It is [said to be] located in the middle of the body and to rule it.

The four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels / feet [?]-are [its] ministers or assistants.

The heart/mind: this is what is called “center.”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart-mind is the center:

lodged in the midst of the body, it rules there as lord.

The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers.

Thus the heart-mind is called the Center.

Factual anchors

- 心: “heart-mind,” the seat of awareness, judgment, and command.
- 中: “center” or “middle”; possibly also carrying the sense of proper centrality.
- 處身之中: “dwells/is situated in the middle of the body.”
- 君之: “lords over it,” “rules it.”
- 相: “ministers,” assistants to a ruler.
- 踵: literally “heels”; here it may stand for the feet or bodily movement.

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

The heart-mind: the center.

It sits in the body’s middle and masters it as lord.

Eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—these four serve as its ministers.

Thus the heart-mind is called the center.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Translation anchor
心	heart / heart-mind
中	center, middle
處身之中	dwelling / being placed in the middle of the body
以君之	to rule it, to act as lord over it
目、耳、口、踵	eyes, ears, mouth, heels
四者	the four
為相	serve as ministers / aides
心是謂中	the heart-mind is therefore called “the center”

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation

The heart/mind rests within the body's core,
A lord that rules from inmost, central store;
Eye, ear, mouth, heel (?)—four ministers before:
This heart/mind is called “Center,” nothing more.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation (critical):

The heart-mind is the center: dwelling in the midst of the body, it rules it. The four—eyes, ears, mouth, and heels—serve as its ministers/assistants. This is why the heart-mind is called “the center.”

Notes on uncertainty:

- 心 may mean “heart,” “mind,” or “heart-mind.”
- 相 can mean “ministers,” “assistants,” or supporting officials.
- 踵 literally means “heels,” though it may stand more broadly for the feet or bodily movement.

Memory aid — mnemonic rendering, not a critical translation:

Heart in the middle, ruling within; eyes, ears, mouth, and heels help it govern.

Memory aid — alliterative version, not a critical translation:

Mind in the middle masters the members; eyes, ears, mouth, and motion are its ministers.

Memory aid — short rhyme, not a critical translation:

The heart sits mid and wears the crown;
eyes, ears, mouth, and heels bow down.

Passage 2

Source text

心所為美惡，復訶若影；心所出小大，因命若響。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does, whether good or evil, returns/reproaches like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, follows the call like an echo.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind makes as beautiful or evil, again it reproaches (?) like a shadow; what the mind sends out as small or great, because of the call/command, is like an echo.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
心	subject	the heart-mind / mind	心 can mean "heart," "mind," or "heart-mind."
所為	nominalized verb phrase	what it does / makes	所 + verb: "that which is done by ..."
美惡	object/complement	beautiful and ugly; good and bad	美惡 may be aesthetic or moral; "good and evil" is possible.
復	adverb / verb?	returns; again; in response	Here likely indicates recurrence or return, but the exact force is uncertain.
訶	verb	reproaches; scolds; calls out?	訶 usually means "to rebuke/reproach"; the fit is uncertain.
若影	comparison	like a shadow	Suggests something that follows or corresponds closely.
心	subject	the heart-mind / mind	Repeated subject.
所出	nominalized verb phrase	what it sends forth / brings out	所 + 出: "that which comes out from ..."
小大	object/complement	small and great	Could mean "minor and major," "small or large."
因	verb / preposition	follows; depends on; because of	Indicates dependence or correspondence.
命	noun / verb	command; naming; fate/life?	命 is ambiguous; "command/call" may fit the echo image.
若響	comparison	like an echo / resonance	響 is a responding sound or echo.

Aligned gloss translation:

"What the heart-mind does—good or bad—returns/reproaches(?) like a shadow; what the heart-mind sends forth—small or great—follows a command/call(?) like an echo."

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

"What the mind does—[whether beautiful/good or ugly/evil]—[again returns / rebukes(?)] like a shadow; what the mind sends forth—[whether small or great]—follows from [command / fate(?)] like an echo."

Syntax map:

- [心所為 [美惡]] = "what the mind does, [fair/good and foul/evil]"
- [復訶 若影] = "again/returningly [rebukes?] like a shadow" — 訶 is uncertain here
- [心所出 [小大]] = "what the mind brings forth, [small and great]"

- [因命 若響] = “because of / in accordance with [命: command, allotment, fate?], like an echo”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does, whether good or evil, returns/rebukes [詞, uncertain] like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, follows its command like an echo.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

What the mind does, whether good or bad, returns—or is censured?—like a shadow.
What issues from the mind, whether small or great, follows the command/name, like an echo.

Glossary

- 心: the mind; heart-mind.
- 所為: what is done; actions or conduct.
- 美惡: good and bad; also possibly fair and foul/beautiful and ugly.
- 復: to return; again; in response.
- 詞: to rebuke, scold, or shout; its precise force here is uncertain.
- 若影: like a shadow.
- 所出: what comes forth; what is produced or issued.
- 小大: small and great; minor and major.
- 因命: following/dependent on a command, designation, or “naming”; uncertain.
- 若響: like an echo or resonance.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does, whether good or bad, returns—or is reproached?—like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, follows the call like an echo.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

What the mind sets in motion—good or bad—comes back with rebuke, or follows it, like a shadow.
What the mind sends out—small or great—arises according to its “command” or condition, like an echo.

Anchor notes

1. 心所為 — “what the mind sets in motion”: literally, “what the mind does/makes.”
2. 美惡 — “good or bad”: literally “beautiful and ugly,” likely used in a moral or evaluative sense.
3. 復 — “comes back” / “again”: taken as return or recurrence.
4. 詞 — “rebuke”: the character means scolding or reproach; its exact role here is uncertain.
5. 若影 — “like a shadow”: suggests close following or inseparable consequence.
6. 心所出 — “what the mind sends out”: literally, “what the mind emits/produces.”

7. 小大 — “small or great”: referring to matters, acts, or effects of different scale.
8. 因命 — “according to its ‘command’ or condition”: uncertain; could mean following an order, mandate, or allotted circumstance.
9. 若響 — “like an echo”: suggests a responsive effect, something that answers what was sent forth.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does as good or evil returns, perhaps “answers” or “is reproved” if 訶 is read literally, like a shadow.
What the mind sends out, whether small or great, follows a command, or perhaps “depends on fate,” like an echo.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim / translation: “What the heart-mind makes as beautiful/good or ugly/evil returns / reproaches (?) like a shadow; what the heart-mind sends out as small or great follows from command/fate/life (?) like an echo.”
- Agency: The heart-mind (xin) is the active source: it “does/makes” distinctions of 美惡 and “sends out” 小大.
- Causal relation: The effects are figured as inseparable responses: like a shadow following form, and like an echo answering sound/command.
- Uncertainty: 訶 is uncertain here: it may mean “reproach/censure,” but the phrase 復訶若影 is difficult; 命 may mean “command,” “allotment/fate,” or “life.”
- Interpretive risk: Reading 美惡 as moral “good/evil” rather than aesthetic “beautiful/ugly,” or 命 as fixed “fate,” may over-specify a passage that remains terse and ambiguous.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does, whether good or bad, returns like a shadow [“訶” is uncertain here].
What the mind sends out, whether small or great, follows the call like an echo.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

“What the mind does—beautiful or bad—returns/rebukes (?) like a shadow;
what the mind sends forth—small or great—depends on / follows command (?) like an echo.”

Alternative, keeping the difficult words more literally:

“The beautiful and evil things which the mind does: again, 訶, like a shadow;
the small and great things which the mind brings forth: because of 命, like an echo.”

Grammar notes

1. 心所為: literally “what the mind does.” 所 nominalizes the following verb: “that which is done by the mind.”
2. 美惡: a paired contrast, “beautiful and ugly,” or more morally, “good and bad.” Here “good/bad” may fit the ethical tone, but 美 is not the usual 善.
3. 復: usually “again,” “in return,” or “thereupon.” In this line it may suggest consequence or recurrence: “comes back again.”
4. 訶: literally “to scold, rebuke, censure.” The phrase 復訶若影 is syntactically difficult; it may mean “is in turn censured like a shadow,” but the sense is uncertain.
5. 若影: “like a shadow.” 若 marks comparison: “as if,” “like.”
6. 心所出: literally “what the mind sends out / produces.” 出 can mean “go out,” “issue forth,” “produce.”

7. 小大: “small and great,” a binary pair meaning “whether small or large,” “minor and major.”
8. 因命: literally “because of / depending on 命.” 命 may mean “command, order,” or “fate/life/decreed.” “Following a command” is possible, but uncertain.
9. 若響: “like an echo” or “like a sound/resonance.” In Classical Chinese, 響 often suggests a responsive echo.
10. The two clauses are parallel: 心所為...若影 ; 心所出...若響 — “what the mind does... like a shadow; what the mind emits... like an echo.”

Mini vocabulary

- 心 — mind, heart-mind
- 所 — nominalizing particle: “that which...”
- 為 — to do, make, act
- 美惡 — beautiful and bad; good and evil; pleasing and hateful
- 復 — again; in return; furthermore
- 訶 — to rebuke, scold, censure
- 若 — like, as, as if
- 影 — shadow
- 出 — to go out; issue forth; produce
- 小大 — small and great; minor and major
- 因 — because of; relying on; according to
- 命 — command; order; mandate; fate/life
- 響 — sound; resonance; echo

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“What the heart-mind does—good or evil—returns/reproaches(?) like a shadow;
what the heart-mind sends forth—small or great—follows a summons/fate(?) like an echo.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
心 “heart-mind”	Abstract concept / faculty	The agent or source of actions and emanations	High
美惡 “good and evil” / “beautiful and bad”	Moral qualities	Qualifies what the heart-mind does	Medium-high
小大 “small and great”	Scale / magnitude	Qualifies what the heart-mind sends forth	Medium
影 “shadow”	Metaphoric image	Image for something that follows or returns in response	High
響 “echo/resonance”	Metaphoric image	Image for responsive consequence or reverberation	High
訶 “reproach / scold / utter?”	Action/concept, uncertain	Describes what “returns” in relation to the heart-mind’s deeds; exact sense uncertain	Low
命 “command / summons / fate / life?”	Abstract concept, uncertain	Something by which what the heart-mind sends forth is conditioned or followed; exact sense uncertain	Low

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 心所為美惡
 - “What the mind does, whether good or evil”

- “The mind’s making of beauty and ugliness”
- “The fair and foul things produced by the mind”

2. 復訶若影

- Reading 訶 literally: “again rebukes/censures, like a shadow”
- Taking the phrase more loosely: “returns/responds like a shadow”
- If 訶 is uncertain or possibly corrupt: “is somehow mirrored/followed like a shadow”

3. 心所出小大

- “What the mind sends forth, small or great”
- “The small and great things that issue from the mind”
- “From the mind come distinctions of small and large”

4. 因命若響

- “Because of command/decreed, like an echo”
- “Depending on naming, like a resonance”
- “Following what is called/commanded, like an echo”

Translation A

What the mind does, whether good or evil, is again censured as a shadow follows;
what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, depends on command like an echo.

Translation B

The beauty and ugliness made by the mind are mirrored like shadows;
the small and large things issuing from the mind arise through naming, like echoes.

Translation C

The fair and foul things produced by the mind return upon it like a shadow;
the lesser and greater things that come from the mind answer to what is decreed, like an echo.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“What the mind does, whether beautiful/good or ugly/evil, returns/rebukes (?) like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, follows its summons/name (?) like an echo.”

Sentence confidence

1. 心所為美惡，復訶若影；心所出小大，因命若響。

Confidence: 45/100.

The general paired structure is clear: actions or productions of the mind are compared to a shadow and an echo. However, several key words are uncertain: 訶 is difficult in context, and 命 may mean “command,” “summons,” “naming,” or possibly “fate/life.” 美惡 may mean “beautiful and ugly” or ethically “good and evil.”

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 美惡
 - Chosen: “beautiful/good or ugly/evil”
 - Alternatives: “beauty and ugliness”; “good and evil”; “fair and foul”
2. 復訶
 - Chosen: “returns/rebukes (?)”

- Alternatives: “again reproaches”; “responds back”; “returns”; “is denounced again”
- Note: 訶 usually suggests rebuke/scolding, but that is awkward with “like a shadow.”

3. 若影

- Chosen: “like a shadow”
- Alternatives: “as a shadow does”; “shadow-like”; “following like a shadow”

4. 心所出小大

- Chosen: “what the mind sends forth, whether small or great”
- Alternatives: “the small and great that the mind produces”; “what issues from the mind, small or large”; “the mind’s production of smallness and greatness”

5. 因命

- Chosen: “follows its summons/name (?)”
- Alternatives: “depends on command”; “arises through naming”; “accords with fate”; “is caused by life/destiny”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 美惡

- Alternative A: “beautiful and ugly”
- Alternative B: “good and evil”
- Choice: “good and evil,” because in ethical/philosophical contexts 美惡 often functions evaluatively, not merely aesthetically.

2. 復訶

- Alternative A: “returns/requites and rebukes”
- Alternative B: “responds to the call/shout”
- Alternative C: read as an uncertain or possibly corrupt phrase, since 訶 normally means “to scold/rebuke” or “to cry out,” and its relation to “like a shadow” is not straightforward.
- Choice: preserve uncertainty: “comes back/rebukes [?] like a shadow.” The phrase seems to describe consequence or response following the mind’s actions, but the exact force of 訶 is unclear.

3. 心所出小大

- Alternative A: “what the mind produces, small and great”
- Alternative B: “what issues from the mind, whether small or great”
- Choice: “what issues from the mind, whether small or great,” to keep the parallel with 心所為.

4. 因命

- Alternative A: “according to command”
- Alternative B: “because of fate/life”
- Alternative C: “following what is named/ordered”
- Choice: “according to its command,” because 命 can mean “command/order,” and this fits the simile 若響, “like an echo,” which responds to a call.

5. 若影 / 若響

- 若影: “like a shadow,” suggesting close following or inescapable accompaniment.
- 若響: “like an echo,” suggesting response to a sound or command.

Final translation

What the mind does, whether good or evil, comes back—rebukes/answers [?]-like a shadow; what issues from the mind, whether small or great, follows its command like an echo.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“What the mind does—fair or foul—returns in response, like a shadow;
what the mind sends out—small or great—follows its command, like an echo.”

Deliberately sceptical alternative

“What the heart-mind makes to be beautiful or ugly is in turn censured, as if by a shadow;
what the heart-mind brings forth, whether small or large, depends on ‘command’ or ‘naming,’ like a resonance.”

Where this diverges, and why

- 美惡 may mean “good and evil,” but it more literally suggests “beautiful and ugly” or “fair and foul.” I have avoided fixing it too firmly as moral language.
- 復訶 is uncertain. 訶 usually means “to rebuke/censure,” but the phrase is awkward. The main translation treats it more generally as “returns in response,” because the parallel with 若影 “like a shadow” suggests following or reflecting. The sceptical version keeps “censured” closer to 訶.
- 命 may mean “command,” but could also imply “naming” or “designation.” With 若響 “like an echo/resonance,” “command” works if the image is of a voice producing an echo; “naming” is also possible if the line concerns what the mind articulates or assigns.

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

What the mind does—whether good or bad—returns/reproves like a shadow;
what the mind sends forth—whether small or great—follows a summons/command like an echo.

Back-translation / Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

心之所作，善惡皆然，還應如影；
心之所出，小大皆然，因呼命而應如響。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 美惡 was rendered as “good or bad,” though it can also mean “beautiful or ugly”; the moral sense is interpretive.
- 復訶 is uncertain. I translated it as “returns/reproves,” but 訶 normally means “to scold/rebuke,” while the phrase may imply some kind of response or consequence “like a shadow.”
- 因命 was rendered as “follows a summons/command”; 命 may mean “command,” “order,” “calling,” or possibly “fate/life.” The echo image supports “calling/summons,” but this is not certain.
- The back-translation adds 皆然, 還應, and 呼 to clarify the English sense; these are interpretive expansions not explicit in the source.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“What the mind does, whether good or bad, returns/rebukes like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, follows a summons like an echo.”

Uncertainty notes

- 美惡 may mean “beautiful and ugly,” but in this context more likely “good and bad” / “wholesome and unwholesome.”
- 復訶 is difficult.
 - 復 can mean “return,” “again,” or “in turn.”
 - 訶 usually means “to scold/rebuke/censure,” but that sense sits awkwardly with 若影 (“like a shadow”). The phrase may imply that consequences “come back” upon the mind like a shadow, but the wording is not fully clear.
- 因命若響 is also somewhat uncertain. 命 may mean “command,” “summons,” or “calling out”; 響 can mean “sound,” “resonance,” or “echo.” I have read it as “responds to a call like an echo.”

Red-team alternative

“What the mind makes as fair or foul is again censured like a shadow; what the mind produces, small or great, depends on command like a resonance.”

This version keeps 訶 more literally as “censured” and 命 more literally as “command,” though the resulting English is less idiomatic.

Back-translation audit

- “What the mind does” ⇌ 心所為
- “good or bad” ⇌ 美惡
- “returns/rebukes” ⇌ 復訶
 - flagged as uncertain because 復 and 訶 do not combine transparently here.
- “like a shadow” ⇌ 若影
- “what the mind sends forth” ⇌ 心所出
- “small or great” ⇌ 小大
- “follows a summons / depends on a command” ⇌ 因命
- “like an echo” ⇌ 若響

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind makes good or evil returns—[or: is rebuked?—like a shadow.

What the mind sends out, small or great, follows the command like an echo.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does, whether good or bad, comes back like a shadow; what the mind sends forth, whether small or great, answers to its summons like an echo.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Segment	Possible readings	Translation effect
心所為	1. "what the mind does/makes" 2. "acts done from/by the mind" 3. less likely: 心所 as a compound, "mental factors/concomitants"	Determines whether 心 is the subject, or 心所 is a technical/compound subject.
美惡	1. "good and evil" 2. "beautiful and ugly" 3. "what it approves and disapproves / esteems and hates"	Moral, aesthetic, or evaluative contrast.
復	1. "again" 2. "in return / back upon it" 3. "respondingly"	May mark recurrence, karmic return, or response.
訶	1. "rebuke, censure, scold" 2. possibly an uncertain/odd graph in this context; if kept literal, "reproach"	Main crux: 復訶若影 may mean "returns to rebuke like a shadow," but the phrase is not fully secure.
若影	"like a shadow"	Suggests close following, return, or inseparability.
心所出	1. "what the mind sends forth/produces" 2. "what issues from the mind," perhaps speech, intention, or action	Determines whether 出 is general production or utterance/expression.
小大	1. "small and great" 2. "minor and major" 3. "of every scale"	Scope: all consequences/things, whether slight or weighty.

| 因命 | 1. "depends on command/order" 2

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

What the mind does—whether good or evil—returns (or is "rebuked," 訶, uncertain) like a shadow; what the mind brings forth—whether small or great—follows upon its command like an echo.

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal version

What the mind does as good or bad, it again "he/ke"-s like a shadow;
what the mind sends out as small or great, follows command/name like an echo.

2. Scholarly version

The good and evil that the mind performs return upon it like a shadow;
the small and great that issue from the mind respond, as if to a summons, like an echo.

3. Plain-language version

Whatever good or bad the mind does follows it like a shadow.
Whatever small or great thing comes from the mind answers back like an echo.

4. Sceptical version

If the text is sound, it seems to say that the mind's good and bad actions have consequences that accompany it like a shadow, and that what proceeds from the mind, whether small or great, responds like an echo. But the phrase 復訶 is difficult and may not mean "return" or "respond" straightforwardly.

5. Uncertainty-marked version

The mind's acts—whether "beautiful/good" or "ugly/evil"—[return? are rebuked?] like a shadow;
what the mind brings forth—small or great—[follows a command? depends on naming?] like an echo.

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

What the heart-mind does—fair or foul—
comes back upon it, perhaps as "rebuke", like a shadow.

What the heart-mind sends forth—small or great—
follows its command like an echo.

Factual anchors

- 心: “heart-mind,” the seat of thought, intention, and feeling.
- 美惡: “beautiful/good” and “ugly/evil”; rendered as “fair or foul.”
- 復訶: uncertain. 復 can mean “return/again”; 訶 usually means “rebuke/scold,” but the phrase is difficult here.
- 若影 / 若響: “like a shadow / like an echo,” images of consequence or response.
- 小大: “small and great,” i.e. things of any scale.
- 命: “command,” “charge,” or “decree”; here rendered as “command,” with some uncertainty.

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

What the heart-mind makes—fair or foul—
returns to rebuke it, shadow-like.

What the heart-mind sends forth—small or great—
follows its mandate, echo-like.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Anchor meaning
心	“heart-mind,” the inner agent
所為	what it does / makes
美惡	fair/good and foul/bad
復訶	“again/returningly rebukes” — uncertain phrasing; 訶 means to scold or reproach
若影	like a shadow
所出	what it sends out / brings forth
小大	small and great
因命	by/following command, mandate, or fate — uncertain
若響	like an echo / resonance

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

What the mind makes—fair or foul—returns, or chides, like shadow’s throw;
What the mind sends—small or great—by “command” follows, echo-low.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Working translation

“What the mind does—good or bad—comes back / rebukes (?) like a shadow;
what the mind sends out—small or great—follows the call / condition (?) like an echo.”

Notes on uncertainty

- 美惡 may mean “good and bad,” or more literally “beautiful and ugly.”

- 復訶 is unclear: 復 suggests “return again,” while 訶 means “reprove, scold, rebuke.” The phrase may imply consequence returning upon the mind, but the exact force is uncertain.
 - 因命 may mean “because of command/call,” “following what is ordained,” or “according to its prompting.”
 - 影 / 響 are clear images: “shadow” and “echo/resonance.”
-

Memory aid — mnemonic rendering, not a critical translation

“Mind makes good or ill: it shadows back.

Mind sends small or great: it echoes the call.”

Memory aid — alliterative version, not a critical translation

“Mind’s making, fair or foul, follows like a shadow;

Mind’s message, minor or mighty, murmurs back like an echo.”

Memory aid — short rhyme, not a critical translation

“What mind may make, its shadow shows;

What mind lets out, the echo knows.”

Passage 3

Source text

心欲見之，目故視之；心欲聞之，耳故聽之；心欲道之，口故言之；心欲用之，踵故舉之。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

When the mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it; when the mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it; when the mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it; when the mind wishes to use it, the heel therefore lifts it.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart desires to see it, the eyes therefore look at it;
when the heart desires to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it;
when the heart desires to speak it, the mouth therefore says it;
when the heart desires to use it, the heels therefore lift it [or: are raised].

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
心	subject	the heart-mind	Seat of intention/desire.
欲	verb/modal	wants, desires	Governs the following action.
見之	verb + object	to see it	之 = "it/this"; referent unspecified.
目	subject	the eyes	Bodily organ carrying out the heart-mind's wish.
故	connective/adverb	therefore, accordingly	Marks consequence.
視之	verb + object	look at it	之 = "it/this."
心	subject	the heart-mind	Repeated parallel structure.
欲	verb/modal	wants, desires	
聞之	verb + object	to hear it	之 = "it/this."
耳	subject	the ears	
故	connective/adverb	therefore, accordingly	
聽之	verb + object	listen to it	之 = "it/this."
心	subject	the heart-mind	
欲	verb/modal	wants, desires	
道之	verb + object	to say/express it	道 may mean "speak of," "tell," or "express."
口	subject	the mouth	
故	connective/adverb	therefore, accordingly	
言之	verb + object	says it	之 = "it/this."
心	subject	the heart-mind	
欲	verb/modal	wants, desires	
用之	verb + object	to use it	Referent of 之 is unspecified.
踵	subject	heel(s)	Could stand for the feet or bodily movement; exact nuance uncertain.
故	connective/adverb	therefore, accordingly	
舉之	verb + object	lift/raise it	Uncertain in context: perhaps "the heels/feet are raised," i.e. movement is initiated.

Aligned gloss translation

The heart-mind wants to see it; the eyes therefore look at it.

The heart-mind wants to hear it; the ears therefore listen to it.

The heart-mind wants to express it; the mouth therefore says it.

The heart-mind wants to use it; the heel(s) therefore lift it / are raised for it.

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

[When the heart/mind desires to see it, the eyes therefore look at it];

[when the heart/mind desires to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it];

[when the heart/mind desires to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it];

[when the heart/mind desires to use it, the heels therefore lift it / are raised for it].

Syntax map:

- Repeated pattern: 心欲 X 之 , Y 故 Z 之
 - 心 = heart/mind, subject of desire
 - 欲 X 之 = desires to X it
 - Y = corresponding bodily organ/part
 - 故 = therefore / for that reason
 - Z 之 = performs the corresponding action toward “it”
- Four parallels:
 1. 見 → 目視 = see → eyes look
 2. 聞 → 耳聽 = hear → ears listen
 3. 道 → 口言 = speak/say → mouth speaks
 4. 用 → 踵舉 = use → heels lift / move, uncertain in nuance

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart/mind wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it; when the heart/mind wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it; when the heart/mind wants to speak it, the mouth therefore says it; when the heart/mind wants to use it, the heel/foot therefore raises it.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it;

when the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it;

when the heart-mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it;

when the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel—or perhaps the foot—therefore lifts it up.

Glossary

- 心 (xin): “heart-mind”; the seat of intention, desire, or cognition.
- 欲: to wish, desire, want.
- 見 / 視: “to see” / “to look at”; here paired as intention and bodily action.
- 聞 / 聽: “to hear” / “to listen”; similarly paired.

- 道 / 言: “to speak of, articulate” / “to say, speak.”
- 用: to use, employ, put into action.
- 踵: heel; possibly standing for the foot or bodily movement more generally.
- 舉: to lift, raise, take up; the precise bodily action implied here is somewhat uncertain.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

When the mind wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.

When the mind wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.

When the mind wants to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it.

When the mind wants to use it, the heel—or foot—therefore lifts/moves it.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind wants to see something, the eyes therefore look at it.

When the heart-mind wants to hear something, the ears therefore listen to it.

When the heart-mind wants to express something, the mouth therefore speaks it.

When the heart-mind wants to put something to use, the heel therefore lifts—sets the body in motion.

Anchor notes

1. 心 — rendered as “heart-mind,” since it can mean both the seat of thought and intention.
2. 欲見之 — “wants to see something”; 之 is treated as a general object, “it / something.”
3. 目故視之 — “the eyes therefore look at it”; 故 marks consequence: the organs act because the heart-mind intends.
4. 欲聞之 — “wants to hear something”; paired with the ears’ response.
5. 耳故聽之 — “the ears therefore listen to it”; 聽 is more active than simply “hear.”
6. 欲道之 — translated as “wants to express something”; 道 here is taken as “say / articulate,” though it can also mean “speak of” or “convey.”
7. 口故言之 — “the mouth therefore speaks it”; 言 gives the actual verbal action.
8. 欲用之 — “wants to put something to use”; the object remains unspecified.
9. 踵故舉之 — rendered with some uncertainty as “the heel therefore lifts—sets the body in motion”; literally, “the heel therefore raises/lifts it,” suggesting bodily movement or action following intention.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart-mind desires to see something, the eyes therefore look at that thing.

When the heart-mind desires to hear something, the ears therefore listen to that thing.

When the heart-mind desires to speak of something, or perhaps to state something, the mouth therefore speaks of that thing.

When the heart-mind desires to use something, the heel therefore raises that thing.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Translation: “When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it; when the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it; when the heart-mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it; when the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heels/feet therefore raise it.”
- Main claim: The passage presents the heart-mind 心 as the initiating center: bodily organs act because the heart-mind first desires or intends.
- Agency: The eyes, ears, mouth, and heels/feet are not portrayed as independent agents; they respond to what the heart-mind wants.
- Causal relation: Each clause follows the same pattern: 心欲 X 之 → organ 故 X 之 — “the heart-mind wants to do something with it; therefore the corresponding bodily part performs the action.”
- Uncertainty / interpretive risk: 之 is unspecified and may mean “it,” “this,” or the relevant object of perception/action. 道 is taken here as “speak of / express,” but could also imply “say” or “put into words.” 踵 literally means “heel,” likely standing for the feet or lower body; 舉 may mean “raise,” “lift,” or possibly “move/step,” so the last clause is the least certain.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart (mind) wants to see it, the eyes then look at it.

When the heart wants to hear it, the ears then listen to it.

When the heart wants to speak of it, the mouth then says it.

When the heart wants to use it, the heels then lift for it.

“Use it” and “heels lift” are somewhat uncertain here. They may mean that when the mind intends action, the feet begin to move.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.

When the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.

When the heart-mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it.

When the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel therefore raises it — or, more literally but less clearly, “the heel therefore lifts it.”

Grammar notes

1. 心欲 X 之: “The heart-mind wants to X it.”

心 here can mean the inner faculty of intention, thought, or will, not just the physical heart.

2. 欲 functions as a modal verb: “to want to,” “to wish to,” “to intend to.”
3. 之 is an object pronoun: “it,” “this,” or “that.” The exact referent is not specified in the passage.
4. The passage is built from four parallel clauses:

心欲見之 / 目故視之;

心欲聞之 / 耳故聽之;

心欲道之 / 口故言之;

心欲用之 / 踵故舉之.

5. 故 means “therefore,” “accordingly,” or “for that reason.” It marks the bodily organ’s action as following from the heart-mind’s desire.
6. 見 and 視 are paired but not identical: 見 is “to see,” while 視 is more actively “to look at.”

7. 聞 and 聽 are similarly paired: 聞 is “to hear,” while 聽 is more actively “to listen to.”
8. 道 and 言 are paired: 道 can mean “to speak of,” “to express,” or “to state”; 言 means “to speak,” “to say.”
9. 目、耳、口、踵 are body parts acting as instruments of the heart-mind’s intention: eyes, ears, mouth, and heel.
10. 踵故舉之 is the most uncertain phrase. 踵 usually means “heel,” and 舉 means “to raise” or “to lift.” The literal sense is “the heel therefore raises/lifts it,” but the intended action may be something like bodily movement or putting something into use.

Mini vocabulary

- 心 — heart; mind; heart-mind; will or intention
- 欲 — to want; to wish; to desire
- 見 — to see
- 目 — eye; eyes
- 故 — therefore; thus; for that reason
- 視 — to look at; to regard
- 聞 — to hear
- 耳 — ear; ears
- 聽 — to listen
- 道 — to speak of; to say; to express
- 口 — mouth
- 言 — to speak; to say
- 用 — to use; to employ
- 踵 — heel
- 舉 — to raise; to lift; to set in motion, perhaps here uncertainly
- 之 — it; him; her; this/that as object pronoun

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“When the heart-mind wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
 When the heart-mind wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
 When the heart-mind wants to say/speak it, the mouth therefore speaks it.
 When the heart-mind wants to use it, the heels/feet therefore lift/move it.”

Uncertainty: In the last clause, 踵 literally means “heel,” but may stand more generally for the foot/feet. 舉之 literally means “raise/lift it,” but in context may imply initiating movement or action.

Named entities

None identified.

Abstract concepts and key terms

Term	Role in passage	Confidence
心 “heart-mind”	Central faculty of desire/intention; initiates each action	High
欲 “wanting/desiring”	Motivating impulse of the heart-mind	High
見 “seeing”	Intended perceptual act carried out by the eyes	High
聞 “hearing”	Intended perceptual act carried out by the ears	High
道 “to say / express / speak of”	Intended verbal expression carried out by the mouth	Medium
用 “using / employing”	Intended practical action carried out through bodily movement	Medium
故 “therefore / for that reason”	Marks causal relation between heart-mind’s desire and bodily organ’s action	High
之 “it”	Unspecified object of seeing, hearing, speaking, or using	High
目 “eyes”	Bodily organ executing seeing	High
耳 “ears”	Bodily organ executing hearing	High
口 “mouth”	Bodily organ executing speech	High
踵 “heel(s) / foot or feet”	Bodily part executing or initiating movement/action	Medium
舉 “raise / lift / move”	Action associated with the heel/foot in response to the heart-mind’s intention	Medium

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 心
 - “the heart-mind”
 - “the mind”
 - “one’s inner intention/desire”
2. 欲見 / 欲聞 / 欲道 / 欲用
 - “wishes to see / hear / speak / use”
 - “desires seeing / hearing / saying / employing”
 - “intends to see / hear / express / put into use”
3. 之
 - “it,” referring to the object of attention or desire
 - “this,” referring generally to what is to be seen/heard/spoken/used
 - possibly the corresponding act itself: “seeing it,” “hearing it,” etc.
4. 故
 - “therefore,” marking consequence
 - “accordingly / for that reason”
 - possibly “then,” as a looser sequential connector
5. 道之
 - “speak of it / say it”
 - “express it”
 - less likely: “guide it” or “put it on the Way,” depending on how 道 is read
6. 踵故舉之
 - “the heels therefore raise it”
 - “the feet therefore lift/move it”
 - “the heels therefore rise for it,” i.e. the body is set in motion to act or go toward it

Translation A

When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
When the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
When the heart-mind wishes to speak it, the mouth therefore says it.
When the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heels therefore lift it.

Translation B

If the mind desires to see something, the eyes accordingly gaze upon it.
If the mind desires to hear something, the ears accordingly listen to it.
If the mind desires to express something, the mouth accordingly speaks it.
If the mind desires to employ something, the feet accordingly move to raise or carry it out.

Translation C

The heart wishes to see: for that reason the eyes look.
The heart wishes to hear: for that reason the ears listen.
The heart wishes to give voice: for that reason the mouth speaks.
The heart wishes to put something to use: for that reason the heels rise and act.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it; when the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it; when the heart-mind wishes to express it, the mouth therefore speaks it; when the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel/foot therefore lifts it.”

Sentence confidence

1. 心欲見之，目故視之；心欲聞之，耳故聽之；心欲道之，口故言之；心欲用之，踵故舉之。

Confidence: 82/100.

Reason: The first three parallel clauses are straightforward: the “heart/mind” desires, and the corresponding organ acts. The main uncertainty is the final clause, especially 踵故舉之, where “heel/foot lifts it” is literal but slightly awkward in English, and the exact intended action may be “move,” “raise,” or “put into action.”

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 心
 - Chosen: “heart-mind”
 - Alternatives: “mind,” “heart,” “intention”
 - Risk: Classical Chinese 心 often includes both thought and desire; “heart” alone may sound emotional, while “mind” may sound too cognitive.
2. 故
 - Chosen: “therefore”
 - Alternatives: “accordingly,” “for this reason,” “then”
 - Risk: Could mark consequence in each parallel clause rather than strong logical causation.
3. 道之
 - Chosen: “express it”
 - Alternatives: “speak of it,” “say it,” “state it,” “tell it,” “explain it”
 - Risk: 道 can mean “speak/say” but also “explain” or “speak about”; exact nuance is uncertain.
4. 用之

- Chosen: “use it”
- Alternatives: “employ it,” “put it into use,” “make use of it,” “act on it”
- Risk: In context, 用 may mean practical action rather than merely “using” an object.

5. 踵故舉之

- Chosen: “the heel/foot therefore lifts it”
- Alternatives: “the heel therefore raises it,” “the foot accordingly lifts,” “the heel/foot accordingly moves,” “the foot is therefore raised”
- Risk: 踵 literally means “heel,” but may stand for the foot or bodily movement; 舉之 literally “raises it,” but the object of 之 is not fully clear.

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points

1. 心

- Alternative: “heart,” “mind,” “heart-mind.”
- Choice: “mind.”
- Justification: In this passage 心 is presented as the directing faculty that desires or intends, while bodily organs carry out the action. “Mind” best conveys that function in English, though “heart-mind” would be more literal.

2. 故

- Alternative: “therefore,” “accordingly,” “for that reason.”
- Choice: “accordingly.”
- Justification: The word marks the bodily organ’s action as following from the mind’s desire.

3. 之

- Alternative: “it,” “this,” “the thing.”
- Choice: “it.”
- Justification: The referent is not specified in the passage; “it” preserves that openness.

4. 道之

- Alternative: “speak of it,” “say it,” “express it,” “tell it.”
- Choice: “speak of it.”
- Justification: 道 here likely means “to speak/say,” not “the Way.” “Speak of it” is slightly broader than “say it” and fits the parallel with mouth and speech.

5. 用之

- Alternative: “use it,” “employ it,” “put it into practice.”
- Choice: “use it,” with uncertainty noted.
- Justification: 用 normally means “use/employ,” but in parallel with 踵 “heels” and 舉 “raise/lift,” it may imply bodily action or putting something into effect.

6. 踵故舉之

- Alternative: “the heels accordingly raise it,” “the feet accordingly lift themselves,” “the heels accordingly are raised for it,” “the feet accordingly move.”
- Choice: “the heels accordingly lift for it,” with visible uncertainty.
- Justification: Literally, 踵 is “heel(s)” and 舉 is “raise/lift.” The syntax is awkward if rendered “raise it,” since heels do not normally “raise” the object. The intended sense may be that the body/feet act when the mind

wants to use or carry something out.

Final translation

When the mind wishes to see it, the eyes accordingly look at it;
when the mind wishes to hear it, the ears accordingly listen to it;
when the mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth accordingly speaks of it;
when the mind wishes to use it, the heels accordingly lift for it — or, more loosely, the feet accordingly move.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Primary translation

When the mind wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
When the mind wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
When the mind wants to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it.
When the mind wants to make use of it, the heel therefore lifts/moves it.

Deliberately sceptical alternative

The heart-mind desires seeing it, and so the eyes look;
the heart-mind desires hearing it, and so the ears listen;
the heart-mind desires giving voice to it, and so the mouth speaks;
the heart-mind desires putting it into action, and so the heel is raised.

Where this diverges, and why

- 心 is rendered as “mind” in the primary version, but “heart-mind” in the alternative, because the term can cover intention, desire, and cognition rather than “mind” alone.
- 道之 is uncertain. It may mean “speak of it / express it”, matching 口言之 “the mouth says it.” I avoid reading it as “guide it” or “practice the Way,” since the immediate parallel points to speech.
- 用之 is also somewhat uncertain. The primary “make use of it” is literal, while the alternative “putting it into action” tries to fit the bodily sequence.
- 踵故舉之 is the most awkward line. 踵 literally means “heel,” and 舉 means “raise/lift.” Taken literally: “the heel therefore raises it.” More idiomatically, it may mean that the body begins to move—“the heel is raised”—but the exact force of 之 here is not fully clear.

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
When the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
When the heart-mind wishes to speak it / speak of it, the mouth therefore says it.
When the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel therefore lifts it — or, less literally, the foot is therefore raised for it.

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

心欲見彼，目乃視彼；
心欲聞彼，耳乃聽彼；
心欲道彼，口乃言彼；
心欲用彼，踵乃舉彼。

Mismatches / possible drift

1. 心 was translated as “heart-mind,” because it can include intention, thought, and desire, not only the physical heart.

2. 之 was rendered as “it,” but the antecedent is not specified in the passage.
3. 故 was translated as “therefore,” while the back-translation uses 乃; this slightly shifts the connective from “for this reason” to “then/thereupon.”
4. 道之 is uncertain. Because it is paired with 口言之, I translated it as “speak it / speak of it,” but 道 can also mean “say,” “tell,” or “make known.”
5. 心欲用之, 踵故舉之 is the most awkward line. Literally it says something like “the heart-mind wishes to use it; the heel therefore raises it.” The exact sense of 舉之 with 踵 is uncertain; it may imply bodily movement or action, hence “the foot is raised for it.”

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind wishes to see something, the eyes accordingly look at it;
 when the heart-mind wishes to hear something, the ears accordingly listen to it;
 when the heart-mind wishes to speak of something, the mouth accordingly says it;
 when the heart-mind wishes to use something, the heel/foot accordingly raises it.

Uncertainty notes

- 心 is translated as “heart-mind,” since it can mean the seat of intention, thought, and desire.
- 故 here is taken as “accordingly / for that reason,” marking the bodily organ’s action as following the heart-mind’s intention.
- 道之 is rendered “speak of something,” because the following phrase 口故言之 makes verbal expression the likely sense.
- 踵故舉之 is the most uncertain phrase:
 - 踵 literally means “heel,” but may stand for the foot or lower limb more generally.
 - 舉之 literally means “raises it.” The referent of 之 is unclear; it may refer to the foot/heel itself, the body, or the intended action/object.
 - A smoother interpretation might be “the foot accordingly lifts/moves,” but that supplies an implicit object not explicit in the text.

Red-team alternative

The mind wants to see it, so the eyes look at it;
 the mind wants to hear it, so the ears listen to it;
 the mind wants to utter it, so the mouth speaks it;
 the mind wants to put it into action, so the foot is lifted.

Back-translation audit

- “heart-mind wishes to see” → 心欲見之
- “eyes accordingly look at it” → 目故視之
- “heart-mind wishes to hear” → 心欲聞之
- “ears accordingly listen to it” → 耳故聽之
- “heart-mind wishes to speak of” → 心欲道之
- “mouth accordingly says it” → 口故言之
- “heart-mind wishes to use” → 心欲用之
- “heel/foot accordingly raises it” → 踵故舉之

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
When the heart wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
When the heart wants to speak it, the mouth therefore says it.
When the heart wants to use it, the heel therefore lifts it.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart-mind wants to see it, the eyes accordingly look at it; when the heart-mind wants to hear it, the ears accordingly listen to it; when the heart-mind wants to express it, the mouth accordingly speaks of it; when the heart-mind wants to put it to use, the heel/foot accordingly lifts it.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Segment	Possible readings
心	"the heart"; "the mind"; the seat of intention/desire
欲	wants; desires; intends; is about to
見之	to see it / him / this; to perceive it; possibly "to meet it/him"
目	the eye / eyes
故	therefore; accordingly; for that reason; deliberately/for the purpose
視之	looks at it; sees it; gazes upon it
聞之	to hear it; to learn of it
耳	the ear / ears
聽之	listens to it; hears it; attends to it
道之	to speak of it; to say it; to express it; possibly "to guide it" or "to make a way for it," though "speak of it" fits best with 口
口	the mouth
言之	says it; speaks it; expresses it
用之	to use it; to employ it; to put it into action; to make use of it
踵	the heel; by extension the foot/feet; possibly "following upon," though the body-part parallel favors "heel/foot"
舉之	raises it; lifts it; puts it forward; sets it in motion; undertakes it

Translation 1: "mind commands the organs"

When the mind wishes to see something, the eyes accordingly look at it.
When the mind wishes to hear something, the ears accordingly listen to it.
When the mind wishes to speak of something, the mouth accordingly says it.
When the mind wishes to use something, the heel accordingly lifts it.

Translation 2: "heart and bodily faculties"

When the heart desires to see it, the eyes therefore gaze on it;
when the heart desires to hear it, the ears therefore attend to it;
when the heart desires to give voice to it, the mouth therefore speaks it;
when the heart desires to put it to use, the foot therefore raises it / is raised for it.

Translation 3: more literal, preserving the repeated structure

The heart wants to see it; therefore the eyes look at it.
The heart wants to hear it; therefore the ears listen to it.
The heart wants to speak it; therefore the mouth says it.
The heart wants to use it; therefore the heel raises it.

Translation 4: with 用之 and 舉之 as “put into action”

If the mind intends to perceive it, the eyes look;
if the mind intends to hear it, the ears listen;
if the mind intends to express it, the mouth speaks;
if the mind intends to employ it in action, the foot is accordingly lifted.

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

“When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it; when the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it; when the heart-mind wishes to speak it, the mouth therefore utters it; when the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel—i.e. the foot—therefore raises it / is raised for it.”

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal version

When the heart-mind wants to see it, the eyes therefore look at it;
when the heart-mind wants to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it;
when the heart-mind wants to speak it / speak of it, the mouth therefore says it;
when the heart-mind wants to use it, the heel therefore raises it.

2. Scholarly version

If the mind intends to see something, the eyes accordingly look at it;
if the mind intends to hear something, the ears accordingly listen to it;
if the mind intends to express it, the mouth accordingly speaks it;
if the mind intends to put it to use, the heel accordingly lifts/moves it.

3. Plain-language version

Whatever the mind wants to do, the body follows:
if it wants to see, the eyes look;
if it wants to hear, the ears listen;
if it wants to say something, the mouth speaks;
if it wants to act or make use of something, the feet move.

4. Sceptical version

The passage seems to present the heart-mind as the directing agent of the body: the eyes see, ears hear, and mouth speaks because the mind wants them to. The final phrase is less straightforward: “the heel therefore raises it” may mean that the feet move when the mind wants to act, but the exact force of “heel” and “raise” here is not fully clear.

5. Uncertainty-marked version

The heart-mind wants to see it, and so the eyes look at it;
the heart-mind wants to hear it, and so the ears listen to it;
the heart-mind wants to 道 it — perhaps “speak it,” “speak of it,” or “express it” — and so the mouth says it;
the heart-mind wants to 用 it — “use it,” “employ it,” or perhaps “act on it” — and so the 踵, literally “heel,” 舉 it — literally “raises/lifts it,” though the phrase may imply the foot/heel being lifted in movement.

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind wants to see it,
the eyes therefore gaze at it.

When the heart-mind wants to hear it,
the ears therefore listen for it.

When the heart-mind wants to speak of it,
the mouth therefore gives it words.

When the heart-mind wants to put it to use,
the heel therefore lifts and goes to it.

Factual anchors

Item	Anchor
心	"heart-mind": the seat of desire/intention
目 / 耳 / 口 / 踵	eyes, ears, mouth, heel/foot as bodily instruments
故	"therefore," "accordingly," marking response to the heart-mind's desire
道之	Rendered as "speak of it"; could also mean "say it" or "tell it"
踵故舉之	Literally something like "the heel therefore raises/lifts it"; taken here as the foot/heel lifting to act or go, but the exact bodily image is somewhat compressed

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

When the heart-mind would see it,
the eyes accordingly survey it.

When the heart-mind would hear it,
the ears accordingly attend it.

When the heart-mind would speak it,
the mouth accordingly says it.

When the heart-mind would use it,
the heels accordingly heave—are lifted for it.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Literal anchor	Translation choice
心	heart / mind	"heart-mind"
欲	desires / wants	"would"
見之	see it	"see it"
目故視之	the eyes therefore look at it	"eyes accordingly survey it"
聞之	hear it	"hear it"
耳故聽之	the ears therefore listen to it	"ears accordingly attend it"
道之	speak it / say it; possibly "put it into words"	"speak it"
口故言之	the mouth therefore says it	"mouth accordingly says it"
用之	use it / employ it	"use it"
踵故舉之	the heels therefore lift/raise it; wording is physically terse and somewhat uncertain	"heels accordingly heave—are lifted for it"

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

The heart-mind longs to see—so eyes bestow;
It longs to hear—so ears attend and know;
It longs to speak—so mouth lets language flow;
It longs to use/act—so the lifted heels go.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind wishes to see it, the eyes therefore look at it.
When the heart-mind wishes to hear it, the ears therefore listen to it.
When the heart-mind wishes to speak of it, the mouth therefore says it.
When the heart-mind wishes to use it, the heel/foot therefore lifts it.

Notes on uncertainty

- 心 is rendered as “heart-mind”, since it can mean the seat of thought, intention, and feeling.
- 之 is repeated throughout as “it”, but its precise referent is not supplied in the passage.
- 踵 literally means “heel”; by extension it may suggest the foot in action.
- 舉之 means “raises/lifts it”; in context it may imply bodily movement in service of intention, but the exact action remains somewhat unclear.

Memory aids, not critical translations

Mnemonic rendering

The heart-mind wants; the body acts:
to see, the eyes look;
to hear, the ears listen;
to speak, the mouth talks;
to use, the foot lifts.

Alliterative version

Mind means to meet it: eyes examine.
Mind means to mark its sound: ears attend.
Mind means to mention it: mouth makes words.
Mind means to manage it: heel heaves.

Short rhyme

If mind would see, the eyes will go;
if mind would hear, the ears will know.
If mind would speak, the mouth will say;
if mind would use, the foot gives way.

Passage 4

Source text

心靜毋有所至，百體四相莫不。為君者其監於此，以君民人。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

Keep the mind still, with nothing to which it goes. Of the hundred bodily parts and the four forms, none is not [affected / responsive]. Let one who is a ruler take this as his mirror, and so rule the people.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The mind still: do not have anything to which it reaches.
The hundred body-parts and the four forms—none does not [do so / is not so].
One who is a ruler should take this as a mirror,
so as to rule the people.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
心	subject/topic	the heart-mind	Could mean "mind," "heart," or "heart-mind."
靜	predicate/adjectival verb	is still; is quiet	May also be read imperatively: "make/keep the mind still."
毋	negative imperative/prohibitive	do not; let there not be	Governs the following existential phrase.
有所至	verb phrase / existential construction	have something/somewhere it reaches; have a place/object of arrival	所至 = "that to which one arrives/reaches"; exact sense uncertain.
百體	subject/topic	the hundred bodily parts	A general expression for the body's many parts.
四相	coordinated subject/topic	the four appearances/forms/aspects	Meaning uncertain; could refer to four bodily aspects or manifestations, but the text does not specify.
莫不	universal negative construction	none do not; all ...	Incomplete as transmitted/punctuated: 莫不 normally expects a following predicate. The predicate may be omitted or lost.
為君者	nominal phrase	those who are rulers; one who acts as lord	為 = "be/act as"; 者 nominalizes.
其	modal/adverbial particle	should; ought to; let them	Jussive or exhortative force.
監於此	verb phrase	look to this; take this as a mirror/warning/model	監 can mean "inspect," "mirror," or "take warning from."
以	purposive connector	in order to; thereby	Introduces the purpose/result.
君	verb	rule; be lord over	Used verbally.
民人	object	the people; the common people	Literally "the people and persons," or simply "the people."

Aligned gloss translation:

"Let the heart-mind be still, and let it have no place/object to which it reaches.
As for the hundred bodily parts and the four forms/aspects, none do not ... [predicate unclear or missing].
Those who are rulers should look to this, in order thereby to rule the people."

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

[When] the mind is still [and] has nothing to which it goes,
[then] the hundred body-parts and the four forms/signs—none is not [so / responsive / in order?].

Those who act as rulers should look to this,
and use it to rule the people.

Syntax map

- 「心靜」: subject-predicate — “the mind is still.”
- 「毋有所至」: negative existential/verbal phrase — “there is nothing to which it reaches/goes.”
- 「百體四相莫不」: compound subject + universal negative, with predicate apparently omitted or uncertain — “the hundred body-parts and four forms/signs, none do not ...”
- 「為君者」: nominalized phrase — “those who are rulers.”
- 「其監於此」: modal/admonitory 「其」 + verb phrase — “should take heed / look to this.”
- 「以君民人」: purpose/instrumental phrase — “thereby / with it, rule the people.”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

When the mind is still, let there be nothing toward which it goes. Of the hundred bodily parts and the four forms, there are none that do not [the text leaves the predicate unstated/unclear].

Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror, in order to rule the people.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Keep the heart-mind still, and let it have nothing toward which it goes. As for the hundred bodily parts and the “four appearances,” there are none that do not [accord with this?] — the text here is elliptical. Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror, and thereby rule the people.

Glossary

- 心 (xin): “heart-mind”; the seat of thought, intention, and affect.
- 靜 (jing): still, quiet, tranquil.
- 毋有所至: “let there be nothing to which it goes/reaches”; interpreted cautiously as restraining directed mental movement.
- 百體: “the hundred bodily parts,” i.e. the body in all its parts.
- 四相: literally “four appearances/forms/aspects”; precise referent uncertain here.
- 莫不: “none do not ...”; the expected predicate is absent or implied.
- 監於此: “take this as a mirror/model,” or “take warning from this.”
- 君民人: “to rule the people”; 君 used verbally, “to act as lord/ruler over.”

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

Keep the heart-mind still, and let it not go toward anything; of the hundred bodily parts and the four forms, there is none that does not [follow/be affected—text incomplete or elliptical]. Those who rule should take this as a mirror, and use it to rule the people.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Keep the heart-mind still; do not let it fix on, or go toward, anything.

As for the hundred parts of the body and the “four appearances,” none of them fail to ... [the predicate seems absent or uncertain].

Those who rule should take this as a mirror, and use it in ruling the people.

Anchor notes

1. 心 → “heart-mind”: the seat of thought, feeling, and intention.
2. 靜 → “still”: calm, unmoving, undisturbed.
3. 毋有所至 → “do not let it fix on, or go toward, anything”: literally, “have nothing to which it arrives/reaches.”
4. 百體 → “the hundred parts of the body”: a conventional way to refer to all bodily members or components.
5. 四相 → “four appearances”: the exact referent is uncertain, so the phrase is kept fairly literal.
6. 莫不 → “none of them fail to ...”: the construction expects a following verb or predicate, but the transmitted line appears incomplete or elliptical.
7. 為君者 → “those who rule”: literally, “those who are rulers/lords.”
8. 其監於此 → “should take this as a mirror”: 監 means to look into, inspect, or take warning/model from.
9. 以君民人 → “use it in ruling the people”: 君 is used verbally, “to act as ruler over”; 民人 means the people or populace.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart-mind is still, there is no place to which the heart-mind goes.

Of the hundred bodily parts and the four aspects, none is not [so].

Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror.

Those who are rulers should use this to rule the people.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Translation: “When the mind is still and does not go toward anything, the hundred bodily parts and the four forms/aspects—none do not [respond / accord]. One who acts as ruler should take this as a mirror, and thereby rule the people.”
- Main claim: Inner stillness of the mind/heart is presented as the condition under which the body’s many parts and outward aspects become properly ordered or responsive.
- Agency: The primary agency lies first in the mind/heart; by analogy, the ruler should observe this principle and apply it in governing.
- Causal relation: Mental stillness and non-directedness → bodily coordination or compliance; similarly, a ruler’s self-regulation or centeredness → proper rule over the people.
- Uncertainty / interpretive risk: The phrase 「百體四相莫不」 appears grammatically incomplete: “none do not ...” lacks an explicit verb or predicate. “四相” is also uncertain: it may mean “four appearances/forms,” “four limbs/aspects,” or another technical category. The translation therefore supplies “[respond / accord]” only tentatively.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

Let the mind be still, and do not let it go toward anything. Then the hundred parts of the body and the four forms (or “four signs”) will all be so—though the text seems incomplete here.

Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror (a lesson), so that they may rule the people.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

“Let the mind be still, and do not let there be anything to which it goes.

As for the hundred bodily parts and the four aspects, there are none that do not [—the predicate is missing or left implicit].

Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror/warning, and thereby rule the people.”

Grammar notes

1. 心靜: Literally “the mind is still.” It may be read as a descriptive clause or as an injunction: “let the mind be still.”
2. 毋: A negative imperative, “do not,” “let there not be.”
3. 有所至: Literally “have that to which one arrives/goes.” Here 所至 means “that which is reached” or “the place/object toward which it goes.”
4. 毋有所至: Close sense: “do not have anything toward which [the mind] goes,” suggesting non-directedness or non-attachment.
5. 百體: Literally “the hundred bodies/parts,” commonly meaning all the parts of the body.
6. 四相: Literally “four appearances/aspects/forms.” The exact referent is uncertain in this isolated passage, so it is best kept literal.
7. 莫不: “There is none that does not...” It normally expects a following verb or adjective, but in the supplied text it is incomplete or elliptical.
8. 為君者: “Those who are rulers” or “one who acts as ruler.” 為 means “to be / to serve as.”
9. 其 before 監: Exhortative/modal: “should,” “ought to,” “let them.”
10. 監於此: Literally “mirror oneself in this” or “take warning from this.” 監 can mean to inspect, take as a mirror, or heed as a lesson.
11. 以君民人: 以 marks means or purpose: “thereby / in order to.” 君 is used verbally, “to rule as lord over.”
12. 民人: “the people,” “the populace”; the two characters reinforce the sense of common people.

Mini vocabulary

- 心 — mind, heart
- 靜 — still, quiet, calm
- 毋 — do not; let there not be
- 至 — to arrive, reach, go to
- 百體 — the hundred bodily parts; the whole body
- 四相 — four aspects/forms/appearances, exact sense uncertain here
- 莫不 — none do not; all without exception
- 為君者 — one who is a ruler; rulers
- 監 — to inspect; to take as a mirror; to heed as a warning
- 君 — ruler; to rule
- 民人 — the people, populace

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“When the mind is still, let it have nowhere that it goes/reaches; the hundred parts of the body and the four forms/aspects—there is none that is not [so / affected]. Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror/admonition, and thereby rule the people.”

Note: The phrase 「百體四相莫不」 appears incomplete or elliptical: 「莫不」 normally expects a following predicate, so the translation preserves the uncertainty.

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
心	Abstract / psycho-physical concept	The “mind/heart” whose stillness is described	High
靜	Abstract concept	Stillness or quietude, the desired state of the mind	High
所至	Abstract concept / action-state	A place or object toward which the mind “reaches”; negated by 「毋」	Medium
百體	Body concept	“Hundred bodily parts,” representing the whole body	High
四相	Abstract / bodily or formal concept	“Four forms/aspects/signs”; exact referent uncertain	Low–Medium
君 / 為君者	Social-political role	The ruler, or those who act as rulers	High
監於此	Abstract action	To take this as a mirror, lesson, or warning	Medium–High
民人	Social collective	The people/common folk to be ruled	High
君民人	Political action/concept	To rule/govern the people; literally “to act as lord over the people”	Medium

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 心靜毋有所至

- “When the mind is still and has nowhere to go / reach”
- “Keep the mind calm, and do not let it be directed toward anything”
- “If the heart-mind is tranquil, nothing comes to it / reaches it” (less certain)

2. 百體四相

- “the hundred parts of the body and the four appearances/forms”
- “all the body’s members and the four features”
- “the whole body and its fourfold manifestations” (interpretive)

3. 莫不

- Literally “none does not ...,” but the predicate is absent or omitted in the supplied text.
- Possible completions in translation:
 - “none is not [affected / brought into order]”
 - “all [follow / respond]”
 - “there is nothing that is not [so]”

4. 為君者其監於此

- “Those who are rulers should examine this”
- “Let one who acts as lord take this as a mirror”
- “A ruler should take warning from this”

5. 以君民人

- “thereby to rule the people”
- “and so be lord over the common people”
- “use it in governing the people”

Translation A

When the mind is still and has nowhere toward which it goes, among the hundred parts of the body and the four forms there is none that is not [accordingly ordered]. Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror, and by it rule the people.

Translation B

Keep the heart-mind calm, and do not let it be fixed on anything; then all the body's members and the four appearances will all [respond]. One who serves as ruler should examine this, and use it to govern the people.

Translation C

If the mind is tranquil and nothing reaches it, then the whole body and its fourfold forms—none will fail to [be affected]. Let those who are lords take warning from this, so as to be lords over the people.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

1. “If the mind is still and has nowhere to which it goes, then the hundred bodily parts and the four appearances—there are none that do not [respond / follow; text appears incomplete].”

Confidence: 45/100.

Reason: The opening is intelligible in general sense, but 「百體四相莫不」 lacks an expressed predicate after 「莫不」, making the sentence syntactically incomplete or possibly corrupt. 「四相」 is also uncertain in this context.

2. “Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror, in order to rule the people.”

Confidence: 78/100.

Reason: 「為君者」, 「監於此」, and 「以君民人」 are relatively clear, though 「監」 may mean either “observe,” “take warning from,” or “take as a model/mirror,” and 「君民人」 is slightly terse.

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 心靜
 - Main rendering: “the mind is still”
 - Alternatives: “the heart-mind is calm”; “when the mind is tranquil”
2. 母有所至
 - Main rendering: “has nowhere to which it goes”
 - Alternatives: “does not arrive at anything”; “lets nothing reach it”; “is not directed toward anything”
3. 百體
 - Main rendering: “the hundred bodily parts”
 - Alternatives: “all the parts of the body”; “the whole body”; “the many limbs and members”
4. 四相
 - Main rendering: “the four appearances”
 - Alternatives: “the four forms”; “the four aspects”; possibly “the four limbs” if the text is corrupt for a similar phrase, but this is not in the supplied text

5. 莫不

- Main rendering: “there are none that do not [respond / follow]”
- Alternatives: “all without exception...”; “none fail to...”; but the following verb or complement is missing in the supplied passage, so any completion is uncertain.

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 心

- Alternatives: “heart,” “mind,” “heart-mind.”
- Choice: “heart-mind” to preserve the Classical Chinese sense of 心 as both cognitive and affective.

2. 靜

- Alternatives: “still,” “quiet,” “calm,” “at rest.”
- Choice: “still” / “is still,” because the passage seems to describe an inner state.

3. 毋有所至

- Alternatives:
 - “do not let it have anywhere it goes”
 - “there is nothing to which it arrives”
 - “nothing reaches it”
- Choice: “has nowhere to arrive at / nothing to which it goes”, with uncertainty noted. The syntax allows more than one reading: the heart-mind may be without an object or destination, or nothing may reach it.

4. 百體四相

- Alternatives:
 - “the hundred bodily parts and the four appearances”
 - “the hundred members and four forms”
 - possibly “four limbs,” if 相 were an error or variant, but the supplied text has 相, not 肢.
- Choice: “the hundred bodily parts and the four forms/aspects”, keeping 相 as “forms/aspects” and not emending it.

5. 莫不

- Issue: The phrase is incomplete as supplied: 莫不 normally means “there is none that does not ...,” but the following verb or complement is absent.
- Choice: Render visibly as “none is not [so / affected / included]” rather than supplying a specific missing action.

6. 為君者其監於此

- Alternatives:
 - “Those who are rulers should take warning from this”
 - “Those who act as rulers should examine this”
 - “Let the ruler take this as a mirror”
- Choice: “Those who would be rulers should take this as a mirror/warning.” 監 can mean to inspect, look to, or take as a cautionary model.

7. 以君民人

- Alternatives:

- “in order to rule the people”
- “thereby to be lord over the common people”
- Choice: “in order to rule the people.” 君 is used verbally: “to rule as lord over.”

Final translation

“When the heart-mind is still, it has nowhere to arrive at / nothing to which it goes; among the hundred bodily parts and the four forms, there is none that is not [so]. Those who would be rulers should take this as a mirror, in order to rule the people.”

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Let the heart-mind be still, with nothing toward which it goes.
As for the hundred bodily parts and the four forms, none do not [—the statement is incomplete or elliptical].
Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror, and by it rule the people.”

Deliberately sceptical alternative

“The mind is quiet; let nothing arrive at it.
The hundred members and four aspects—none [do not ...].
One who is a ruler should observe this, so as to lord it over the common people.”

Points of uncertainty / divergence

- 心靜毋有所至
 - Main translation takes this as: “the heart-mind is still and has no object/destination.”
 - Alternative takes 毋有所至 more literally as a prohibition: “let nothing arrive at it.”
 - The phrase could mean either the mind does not go out toward things, or things do not reach/disturb the mind.
- 百體四相莫不
 - This is grammatically incomplete as transmitted: 莫不 means “none do not ...,” but the verb or predicate after it is missing.
 - I have not supplied a hidden completion such as “obey,” “respond,” or “be ordered,” because that would be conjectural.
- 為君者其監於此
 - 監於此 may mean “take this as a mirror,” “look carefully at this,” or “take warning from this.”
 - The main translation uses “take this as a mirror”; the alternative uses the more neutral “observe this.”
- 以君民人
 - Main translation: “rule the people,” taking 君 as a verb.
 - Alternative: “lord it over the common people,” a more sceptical rendering, because 君 as a verb can carry the sense of exercising rulership over others.

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

“Let the mind be still, with nothing to which it goes or reaches. As for the hundred bodily parts and the four forms/aspects, there is none that does not [—predicate missing or implicit]. Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror/admonition, and thereby rule the people.”

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

心宜靜，毋有所往至；百體四相，莫不 [闕其所謂]。為君者，其鑒於此，以君民人。

Mismatches / possible drift

1. 心靜母有所至

- I rendered this as an exhortation: “Let the mind be still...”
- But it could also be read more descriptively: “When the mind is still, there is nothing it reaches.”

2. 有所至

- Translated as “goes or reaches,” combining spatial and intentional senses.
- The phrase may mean “arrives at something,” “attaches to something,” or “has an object it reaches.”

3. 百體四相莫不

- The source appears incomplete after 莫不 (“none does not...”).
- I preserved this with “[predicate missing or implicit]” rather than supplying a verb such as “follow,” “be still,” or “be ordered.”

4. 四相

- Rendered cautiously as “four forms/aspects.”
- The exact referent is uncertain from the supplied passage alone.

5. 監於此

- Translated as “take this as a mirror/admonition.”
- 監/鑒 can imply “observe,” “take warning from,” or “use as a model”; the English includes more than one possible sense.

6. 以君民人

- Rendered as “thereby rule the people.”
- Literally: “use [it] to lord/rule over the people/men.” The doubled sense of 民人 is flattened in English as “the people.”

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Let the heart-mind be still, with nothing toward which it goes.

Of the hundred bodily parts and the four “forms/aspects,” there is none that does not [—].

Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror, and thereby rule the people.

Uncertainty notes

- 心靜母有所至: Could mean “let the mind be still and have no destination/object,” or “when the mind is still, nothing reaches it.” I have taken 心 as “heart-mind” and 母有所至 as “have nothing toward which it goes.”
- 百體四相莫不: The phrase appears incomplete: 莫不 normally expects a following verb or predicate (“none does not ...”). Since none is supplied, I have marked the gap with [—] rather than filling it in.
- 四相: Literally “four forms/aspects/appearances.” Its precise meaning here is uncertain; I have not normalized it to “four limbs” or any doctrinal term.
- 監於此: Rendered as “take this as a mirror,” i.e. use it as a model or warning. It could also mean “observe this.”
- 君民人: I read 君 as a verb, “to rule,” and 民人 as “the people.”

Red-team alternative

When the mind is quiet, let there be no place to which it arrives.

The hundred members of the body and the four aspects—none is not [affected/ordered].

One who serves as ruler should observe this, using it to be lord over the common people.

Back-translation audit

“Let the mind be still and without anything it goes to; the hundred bodies/body-parts and four aspects, none does not [missing predicate]. Those who act as rulers should look to this as a mirror, in order to rule the people.”

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart is still; let it have nowhere it goes.
The hundred bodies and four forms: none is not [so].
Let those who are rulers take this as a mirror,
and thereby rule the people.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

“When the mind is still and has nowhere it goes, the hundred parts of the body and the four forms/aspects—none do not ... [the predicate after ‘none do not’ is absent or unclear in the supplied text].

Those who rule should take this as a mirror, and by it rule the people.”

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Segment	Possible readings
心靜	“When the heart-mind is still”; “make the heart-mind still”; “the heart-mind is calm”
母有所至	“let it have nowhere it goes/reaches”; “there is nothing that comes to/reaches it”; “do not let there be anything it aims at/arrives at”
百體	“the hundred bodily parts”; “the whole body”; “all bodily members”
四相	“the four forms/aspects/appearances”; possibly bodily “four limbs/aspects,” but the exact referent is uncertain
莫不	Literally “none do not ...”; but the predicate is missing or elliptical. It may mean “all are so,” “none fail to respond,” or the text may be incomplete/corrupt.
為君者	“one who is a ruler”; “those who rule”
其監於此	“should take this as a mirror”; “should observe this”; “should take warning/instruction from this”
以君民人	“thereby rule the people”; “use it to be ruler over the people”; “so as to govern the populace”

Translation 1 — inward stillness, bodily harmony

“When the heart-mind is still and has nowhere to go toward, the hundred parts of the body and the four aspects—none fail to be so. Those who are rulers should take this as a mirror, and thereby rule the people.”

Translation 2 — nothing reaches the still mind

“If the heart-mind is calm and nothing reaches it, then of the hundred bodily members and the four forms, there are none that do not [accord with it]. One who would be a ruler should observe this, in order to govern the people.”

Translation 3 — prescriptive reading

“Keep the heart-mind quiet; do not let it have anything to which it arrives. As for the hundred members and the four appearances, none will not [follow]. Those who are rulers should take warning from this, using it to rule the people.”

Translation 4 — with visible textual uncertainty

“The heart-mind is still, without any place to which it proceeds; the hundred bodily parts and the four aspects—‘none do not ...’ [the predicate is absent or implied]. Let those who are rulers reflect on this, so as to rule the people.”

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

“When the heart-mind is still and has no place toward which it goes, the hundred parts of the body and the four ‘forms’ [or: aspects; text uncertain]—there is none that does not ... [predicate missing or elliptical].

Those who act as rulers should take this as their mirror, and thereby rule the people.”

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal version

“When the heart-mind is still and has nowhere to arrive/reach, the hundred bodily parts and the four aspects—none does not [—]. Let those who are rulers take this as a mirror, in order to rule the people.”

2. Scholarly version

“If the mind is tranquil and does not direct itself toward any object, then the whole body—the ‘hundred members’ and the ‘four aspects’—all [respond? are brought into order?]. Those who rule should take this as a model, and by it govern the people.”

3. Plain-language version

“When the mind is calm and not fixed on anything, every part of the body is affected—though the text leaves the result unstated. A ruler should learn from this and use the same principle in governing people.”

4. Sceptical version

“The passage seems to say that a still, undirected mind brings all parts or aspects of the body into some corresponding state, but the phrase after ‘none does not’ appears incomplete. The final line is clearer: rulers are urged to observe this and apply it to ruling the people.”

5. Uncertainty-marked version

“Mind/heart still, with nothing to which it goes or reaches; the hundred parts of the body and the four ‘forms/aspects’—there are none that do not [do what is not stated]. Let the one who is ruler look to this as a mirror/warning/model, so as to rule the people.”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the mind is still, let it go reaching after nothing.

The hundred parts of the body, the four outward forms—none is not ... [text breaks off or leaves the predicate unstated].

Those who act as rulers should take this as their mirror,
and by it rule the people.

Factual anchors

Anchor	What the text says
心靜	“the mind/heart is still”
毋有所至	“let there be nothing it reaches toward / arrives at”
百體	“the hundred bodily parts,” i.e. the whole body
四相	literally “four forms/aspects”; exact sense uncertain here
莫不	“none does not ...,” but the following verb or complement is absent in the supplied text
為君者	“those who are rulers / act as lords”
監於此	“take this as a mirror / warning / model”
君民人	“rule the people,” with 君 used verbally

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

Heart hushed: let it have no goal it goes to.
The hundred bodily parts, the four forms—none is not ... [text breaks off / predicate unstated].
Those who would be lords: let them look in this as a mirror,
and by it lord the people, govern the folk.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Literal anchor	Notes
心靜	"heart/mind still"	心 can mean heart, mind, inner seat.
毋有所至	"do not have what/where it reaches"	Suggests no directed striving or arrival.
百體	"hundred bodies/parts"	Likely the many bodily members.
四相	"four forms/aspects"	Exact referent uncertain.
莫不	"none does not ..."	The expected predicate is absent in the supplied text.
為君者	"those who act as rulers/lords"	Refers to rulers.
其監於此	"should take warning/mirror from this"	監 can mean inspect, mirror, take warning.
以君民人	"thereby lord/rule the people"	君 used verbally: to rule as lord.

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation

Let the quiet heart arrive at no fixed place;
The hundred limbs, four forms—none lack [this?] trace.
Let rulers look to this, and learn the art:
To rule the people, rule with such a heart.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

"Let the heart-mind be still, with nothing to which it goes or reaches.
As for the hundred bodily parts and the four aspects, there is none that does not [—].
Those who act as rulers should take this as a mirror/lesson, and thereby rule the people."

Uncertainties

- 百體四相莫不 appears incomplete as transmitted: 莫不 normally expects a following verb or predicate ("none does not ..."). I have left the gap visible as [—] rather than supplying an interpretation.
- 四相 is rendered literally as "four aspects"; its precise referent is uncertain here.
- 監於此 may mean "look into this as a mirror," "take warning from this," or "take this as a model."

Memory aids — not critical translations

Mnemonic rendering:

"Still the mind; let it go nowhere.
All body-parts, all four aspects—none but [blank].
A ruler should mirror this, and so rule the people."

Alliterative version:

"Calm the core; chase no course.

Hundred humors, four forms—none fail to [—].
Lords should look to this lesson, then lead the living.”

Short rhyme:

“Mind at rest, no place to roam;
All the limbs and forms are shown [—].
Rulers, take this truth in view,
And rule the folk by what you knew.”

Passage 5

Source text

人之有為，而不知其卒，不唯謀而不度乎？如謀而不度，則無以知短長。短長弗知，妄作衡觸，而有成功，名之曰幸。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

When people undertake something yet do not know its outcome, is it not simply that they plan but do not take measure? If they plan but do not take measure, then they have no means to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing short and long, they act rashly, striking crosswise and colliding; if they achieve success, it is called luck.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

When a person has something he does, and does not know its end, is this not planning but not measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know the short and the long. The short and the long not being known, one rashly makes crossings-and-collisions; and if there is success, one names it “luck.”

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
人之有為	nominalized subject phrase	people's having something to do / undertaking action	之 marks the phrase as a topic/nominal unit; 有為 = to act, undertake, have purposeful activity
而	connective	and yet / but	marks contrast with the following ignorance
不知	verb phrase	do not know	
其卒	object	its end / outcome	卒 = ending, completion, final result; “death” is possible in other contexts but less likely here
不唯……乎	rhetorical frame	is it not simply that...?	不唯 may mean “is it not only/merely”; 乎 marks the rhetorical question
謀而不度	predicate phrase	they plan but do not measure/calculate	度 = measure, estimate, assess; could imply weighing consequences
如	conditional marker	if	
謀而不度	conditional clause	one plans but does not measure/calculate	repeated from above
則	consequential marker	then	
無以	modal phrase	there is no means by which to...	
知	verb	know	
短長	object	short and long; relative limits/merits	literally “short/long”; by extension “advantages and disadvantages,” “relative measure”
短長弗知	topic/condition phrase	not knowing short and long	弗 = 不, negates 知
妄作	verb phrase	act rashly / do things recklessly	妄 = heedlessly, without basis
衡觸	manner/result phrase	crossing/colliding; crashing about	Uncertain: 衡 may carry the sense of “crosswise” or “weighing/balance”; with 觸 “to strike/collide,” likely “collide recklessly”
而	connective	and / yet	connects reckless action with possible success
有成功	verb-object phrase	have success / achieve completion	成功 = successful result, accomplishment
名之曰	naming formula	name it, saying... / call it...	之 refers to such success
幸	predicate/name	luck / fortunate chance	success not grounded in proper calculation

Aligned gloss translation:

“People undertake action, yet do not know its outcome—is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short and long, the relative limits. Not knowing the short and long, one acts rashly, crashing about; if there is success, it is named ‘luck.’”

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

[When a person has something he does / undertakes an action], and [does not know its end/result], is this not [planning] yet [not measuring/estimating]?

[If one plans] yet [does not measure/estimate], then there is no means by which to know [the short] and [the long]. [The short and the long not being known], [to act rashly, “balancing/colliding” (?) / striking about at random (?)], and yet [to have success]—this is named “luck.”

Syntax map

- 人之有為，而不知其卒 = “[a person’s undertaking action] + [not knowing its end]”
- 不唯謀而不度乎 = rhetorical: “is it not merely [planning] but [not measuring]?”
- 如謀而不度，則無以知短長 = conditional: “if [plan but not measure], then [no means to know short/long]”
- 短長弗知，妄作衡觸，而有成功 = sequence: “[short/long unknown] → [rash action / 衡觸 uncertain] → [success occurs]”
- 名之曰幸 = judgment/naming: “call this ‘luck’”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

When a person undertakes something but does not know its outcome, is this not planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know the short and the long. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts recklessly, crossing and colliding; if there is success, it is called “luck.”

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When a person undertakes action but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without estimating? If one plans but does not estimate, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long—that is, the relative deficiencies and advantages. If these are not known, and one acts rashly, colliding about without measure, yet happens to achieve success, this is called “good fortune.”

Glossary

- 有為: to undertake action; to act with some purpose.
- 卒: end, conclusion, outcome.
- 謀: to plan, devise, deliberate.
- 度: to measure, estimate, assess.
- 短長: literally “short and long”; here likely relative shortcomings and strengths, or disadvantages and advantages.
- 妄作: to act rashly or recklessly.
- 衡觸: uncertain in nuance; likely “to collide about,” “to run into things at random,” or to act in an unmeasured, uncontrolled way.
- 幸: luck, good fortune; success by chance rather than by sound planning.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

When people undertake something but do not know how it will end, is this not planning without measuring? If they plan without measuring, then they have no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing short from long, they act rashly, running crosswise and bumping into things; if they happen to succeed, this is called luck.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When people undertake something but do not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without making an assessment? If one plans but does not measure things out, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long—what is deficient and what is sufficient. Not knowing this, one acts rashly and runs into things blindly; if such action happens to succeed, it is called luck.

Anchor notes

1. 人之有為 — “when people undertake something”; literally, “people having something they do / taking action.”
2. 而不知其卒 — “but do not know how it will end”; 卒 can mean “end,” “conclusion,” or “final outcome.”
3. 不唯……乎 — rendered as “is this not simply...?”; a rhetorical question implying affirmation.
4. 謀而不度 — “planning without making an assessment”; 謀 is to plan or deliberate, while 度 suggests measuring, estimating, or evaluating.
5. 無以知短長 — “there is no way to know what is short and what is long”; figuratively, this may mean not knowing relative limits, adequacy, strengths and weaknesses, or consequences.
6. 短長弗知 — “not knowing this”; repeats the idea of failing to distinguish comparative measures or conditions.
7. 妄作 — “acts rashly”; literally, “does/makes recklessly” or “acts without proper basis.”
8. 衡觸 — “runs into things blindly”; the phrase is somewhat uncertain, but suggests colliding, clashing, or blundering ahead without proper orientation.
9. 而有成功，名之曰幸 — “if such action happens to succeed, it is called luck”; success under these conditions is not credited to sound planning but to chance.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

When a person undertakes an action and does not know the final outcome, is this not planning without measuring?

If there is planning without measuring, there is no way to know the short and the long.

“The short and the long” may mean relative advantages and disadvantages.

If the short and the long are not known, and success occurs after rash, uncertain action, this is called luck.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim: When people undertake action without knowing how it will end, the fault lies in making plans without proper measurement or assessment.
- Translation: “When a person acts with purpose but does not know its eventual outcome, is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short or long. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts rashly, colliding crosswise; if there is success, it is called luck.”
- Agency: The acting person is responsible for the planning and the failure to “measure” or assess; success, if it occurs, is not credited to skill but to fortune.

- Causal relation: Planning without assessment leads to ignorance of relative limits or advantages (“short and long”); that ignorance leads to reckless action; any success under such conditions is accidental.
- Uncertainty / interpretive risk: “Short and long” likely means comparative strengths, limits, or consequences, not literal length. “衡觸” is difficult; it may suggest acting blindly, crashing about, or coming into collision, so the translation “colliding crosswise” remains tentative.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

When people act, but do not know how it will end, is this not because they plan but do not measure it out?

If they plan but do not measure it out, then they have no way to know what is short or long (the limits, gains, or losses).

If they do not know what is short or long, they act rashly, “crossing and striking” things (the phrase is uncertain, but means acting blindly or recklessly). If they still succeed, this is called luck.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

When people undertake something, yet do not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long. When short and long are not known, if one acts recklessly, running crosswise and colliding blindly, and yet achieves success, this is called “luck.”

Grammar notes

1. 人之有為: 之 marks the clause as a topic/nominalized phrase: “as for people’s having undertakings” → “when people undertake something.”
2. 有為: literally “to have doing/action”; here “to undertake action,” “to set about doing something.”
3. 而不知其卒: 而 links contrasting or sequential clauses: “and/but do not know.” 其卒 means “its end,” “its conclusion,” or “how it will turn out.”
4. 不唯……乎?: rhetorical-question form. 不唯 here is close to “is it not just/simply…?” The sentence asks: “Is this not planning without measuring?”
5. 謀而不度: 謀 = to plan, deliberate; 度 = to measure, estimate, assess. The contrast is between making plans and properly calculating/assessing them.
6. 如謀而不度: 如 introduces a condition: “if,” “supposing that.”
7. 則無以知短長: 無以 means “there is no means by which to…”; 短長 literally “short and long,” likely meaning relative measures, merits and defects, limits, or comparative extent.
8. 短長弗知: 弗 is a negative like 不, often before verbs: “not know.” The object 短長 is placed before the verb: “short and long being not known.”
9. 妄作: “to act recklessly / rashly / without proper basis.” 妄 implies arbitrariness or lack of sound judgment.
10. 衡觸: literally something like “crosswise striking/colliding.” The exact nuance is somewhat uncertain; it suggests blundering into things, acting by collision rather than by measured judgment.
11. 而有成功: 而 here can mean “and yet” or simply “and.” In context, “and yet achieves success” fits the contrast with reckless action.
12. 名之曰幸: formula meaning “name it/call it X.” 之 refers to the preceding situation—succeeding despite reckless, unmeasured action. 幸 = luck, good fortune.

Mini vocabulary

- 人 — people; a person

- 有為 — to undertake action; to do something
- 卒 — end, conclusion, final outcome
- 謀 — to plan, deliberate, scheme
- 度 — to measure, estimate, assess
- 無以 — to have no means to; unable to
- 短長 — short and long; relative measures; strengths and weaknesses
- 弗 — not
- 妄作 — to act recklessly or rashly
- 衡觸 — to strike/collide crosswise; to blunder into things, uncertain in nuance
- 成功 — success; accomplishment
- 幸 — luck, fortune, fortunate chance

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring it? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is “short” and what is “long”—that is, the relative limits or merits. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts rashly and runs into things at random; if there is success, it is called “luck.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term / Concept	Role in the passage	Confidence
人 “a person / people”	General human subject who undertakes action	High
有為 “undertaking / purposeful action”	The activity being considered	High
卒 “end / conclusion / outcome”	What the actor fails to know in advance	High
謀 “planning / strategizing”	An intentional process that is insufficient without measurement	High
度 “measuring / assessing / calculating”	The missing evaluative act needed to judge outcomes or proportions	High
短長 “short and long”	Figurative measure of relative extent, limits, advantages/disadvantages, or adequacy; exact nuance uncertain	Medium
弗知 / 不知 “not knowing”	Ignorance of outcome or comparative measure	High
妄作 “acting rashly / arbitrarily”	Action taken without proper assessment	High
衡觸 “crosswise collision / bumping into things / clashing at random”	Image of uncontrolled or reckless action; precise sense uncertain	Medium-Low
成功 “success / accomplishment”	A possible positive result despite poor planning	High
幸 “luck / fortune”	The name given to success achieved without proper assessment	High

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans and possible renderings

- 人之有為
 - “When a person undertakes something”
 - “In people’s purposeful actions”
 - “When someone acts / has something to do”
- 不知其卒
 - “does not know how it will end”

- “does not know its final outcome”
- “does not understand its completion/result”

3. 不唯謀而不度乎

- “is this not simply planning without measuring?”
- “is it not because one schemes but does not calculate?”
- “is it not a case of deliberating but failing to assess?”

4. 短長

- “short and long,” literally the relative lengths
- “advantages and disadvantages”
- “deficiencies and strengths / limits and extent”

5. 妄作衡觸

- “rashly acts, crossing and colliding”
- “recklessly proceeds and runs into things”
- “acts blindly, pushing across and striking against obstacles”

6. 而有成功，名之曰幸

- “and if there is success, it is called luck”
- “should it happen to succeed, one names it fortune”
- “if it achieves success, that is termed chance”

Translation A

When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short or long. Not knowing short from long, one rashly acts, crossing and colliding; if there is success, it is called luck.

Translation B

In people's purposeful actions, if they do not know the final outcome, is it not because they scheme but fail to calculate? If they scheme without calculating, they have no means to know the advantages and disadvantages. Not knowing the advantages and disadvantages, they proceed recklessly and run into things; should they succeed, it is named fortune.

Translation C

When someone acts and yet does not understand the result, is this not a case of deliberating but failing to assess? If one deliberates without assessment, then one cannot know the limits and extent of the matter. Ignorant of its limits and extent, one acts blindly, pushing across and striking against obstacles; if success comes of it, that is called chance.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

1. When people undertake something but do not know how it will end, is this not planning without measuring?

Confidence: 86/100. Reason: The general sense is clear; uncertainty lies in whether 卒 means “end,” “outcome,” or “completion,” and whether 度 is “measure,” “estimate,” or “deliberate.”

2. If one plans without measuring, then there is no way to know what is short or long.

Confidence: 88/100. Reason: Syntax is straightforward; 短長 is literal “short and long,” but may figuratively mean “relative merits,” “advantages and disadvantages,” or “limits.”

3. Not knowing what is short or long, one rashly acts, colliding this way and that; if there is success, it is called luck.

Confidence: 72/100. Reason: The main contrast between rash action and accidental success is clear, but 衡觸 is difficult and may mean “crosswise collisions,” “reckless clashes,” or some broader idea of acting blindly and running into obstacles.

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 其卒

- Chosen: “how it will end”
- Alternatives: “its outcome,” “its completion,” “the final result”

2. 不唯……乎

- Chosen: “is this not…”
- Alternatives: “is it not simply…,” “is this not precisely…,” “is it not only that…”

3. 謀而不度

- Chosen: “planning without measuring”
- Alternatives: “scheming without calculation,” “making plans without estimating,” “deliberating without assessing”

4. 短長

- Chosen: “what is short or long”
- Alternatives: “relative lengths,” “limits,” “advantages and disadvantages,” “strengths and weaknesses”

5. 妄作衡觸

- Chosen: “rashly acts, colliding this way and that”
- Alternatives: “acts blindly and runs into things,” “makes reckless attempts and clashes,” “proceeds at random, bumping crosswise,” “acts absurdly and comes into collision”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 人之有為

- Option A: “When people undertake something”
- Option B: “When a person acts”
- Choice: “When people undertake something”
- Justification: 有為 here seems to mean engaging in some purposeful action or enterprise, not merely “acting” in general.

2. 不知其卒

- Option A: “do not know its end”
- Option B: “do not know how it will turn out”
- Choice: “do not know how it will turn out”
- Justification: 卒 means “end/conclusion”; in context it refers to the outcome or final result of the undertaking.

3. 不唯謀而不度乎？

- Option A: “is this not simply planning without measuring?”
- Option B: “is it not that they scheme but do not calculate?”
- Choice: “is this not planning without measuring?”

- Justification: 謀 is planning or devising; 度 is measuring, estimating, or calculating. 不唯...乎 is taken as a rhetorical formulation: “is it not...?”

4. 短長

- Option A: “short and long”
- Option B: “relative lengths”
- Option C: “strengths and weaknesses / advantages and disadvantages”
- Choice: “what is short and what is long”
- Justification: The literal image of measurement is important after 度, but it may also imply comparative merits, limits, or proportions. The translation keeps the concrete metaphor visible.

5. 妄作衡觸

- Option A: “recklessly act, colliding crosswise”
- Option B: “act blindly and run into things”
- Option C: “make rash attempts, offending and colliding”
- Choice: “act recklessly, crashing and colliding about”
- Justification: 衡 may be functioning like 橫, “athwart/crosswise,” and 觸 means “to touch, strike, collide, offend.” The exact force is uncertain, but the phrase clearly suggests blind, rash action without proper assessment.

Final translation

When people undertake something but do not know how it will turn out, is this not planning without measuring? If they plan but do not measure, then they have no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing what is short and what is long, they act recklessly, crashing and colliding about; and if they do achieve success, this is called “luck.”

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not merely planning without measuring? If one plans without measuring, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts rashly, crosswise and colliding; if there is success, it is called ‘luck.’”

Sceptical alternative translation

“When people set about doing things, yet do not understand their final outcome—is this not simply scheming without calculation? If they scheme without calculation, they cannot know the relative merits and defects. Not knowing the merits and defects, they proceed blindly, striking against things at random; should they nevertheless succeed, we call it fortune.”

Where this alternative diverges

- 有為: rendered first as “undertakes something,” but alternatively as “set about doing things.” The phrase may refer broadly to purposive action, not a single project.
- 卒: translated as “how it will end,” but alternatively as “final outcome.” It could mean the end, completion, or eventual result.
- 謀而不度: “planning without measuring” is fairly literal; “scheming without calculation” is more interpretive, taking 度 as estimating or assessing.
- 短長: literally “short and long.” The alternative reads this figuratively as “relative merits and defects,” but that is uncertain; it could also mean advantages and disadvantages, adequacy and inadequacy, or simply measurable extent.

- 衡觸: especially uncertain. “Crosswise and colliding” preserves the literal feel of 衡/橫 and 觸; “striking against things at random” interprets it as blind, reckless action. The exact idiomatic force is not secure.

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English Translation

When people undertake something, yet do not know how it will end, is this not simply because they plan but do not measure it out? If they plan but do not measure, then they have no means of knowing its short and long. Not knowing the short and long, they rashly make “crosswise collisions” / blind attempts; if there is success, it is called luck.

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

人有為，而不知其終，豈非謀而不量乎？
若謀而不量，則無所知其短長。
短長不知，妄為衡觸；而若有成，則名之曰幸。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 卒 was translated as “how it will end” / “outcome”; it could also mean “completion” or “final result.”
- 度 was rendered as “measure it out”; it may include estimating, calculating, or assessing.
- 短長 was kept close as “short and long,” but it may imply relative merits, limits, advantages and disadvantages, or extent.
- 妄作衡觸 is uncertain. I rendered it as “rashly make ‘crosswise collisions’ / blind attempts.” The exact sense of 衡觸 is not fully clear from the passage alone.
- 有成功 was translated as “if there is success”; literally, “and there is achieved success.”
- 幸 was translated as “luck,” but it can also mean fortunate chance or accidental success.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring it out? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long. If short and long are not known, and one acts rashly, striking about at random, yet still achieves success, this is called “luck.”

Uncertainty notes

- 有為: translated as “undertakes something”; it could also mean “has deliberate action” or “sets out to do something.”
- 卒: rendered as “how it will end”; it may mean the final outcome, completion, or endpoint.
- 度: “measure” here likely means estimate, calculate, or assess in advance, not merely physical measurement.
- 短長: literally “short and long.” It may refer to relative lengths, advantages and disadvantages, limits and capacities, or the scale of the matter.
- 妄作衡觸: the most uncertain phrase. I have translated it as “acts rashly, striking about at random.”
 - 衡 may be related to “horizontal/crosswise,” “balance/weigh,” or possibly function like 橫, “recklessly, violently, at random.”
 - 觸 means “to touch, hit, collide with, encounter.”

Together the phrase seems to describe blind or reckless action without prior assessment.

Red-team alternative translation

When people act and yet do not understand the completion of what they are doing, is that not planning without calculation? If they plan without calculation, they have no means to know the short and the long. Not knowing the short and the long, they recklessly make random collisions; if they nevertheless succeed, one calls it fortune.

Back-translation audit

- “When a person undertakes something” → 人之有為
- “but does not know how it will end” → 而不知其卒
- “is this not simply planning without measuring it out?” → 不唯謀而不度乎
- “If one plans but does not measure” → 如謀而不度
- “there is no way to know what is short and what is long” → 則無以知短長
- “If short and long are not known” → 短長弗知
- “one acts rashly, striking about at random” → 妄作衡觸
- “yet still achieves success” → 而有成功
- “this is called ‘luck’” → 名之曰幸

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

When a person undertakes something, yet does not know its end, is it not planning without measuring?

If he plans but does not measure, then he has no way to know short and long.

Not knowing short and long, he rashly acts, runs crosswise and collides. If there is success, name it “luck.”

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

When people undertake something yet do not know how it will turn out, is this not because they plan but do not assess? If they plan without assessing, they have no way to know what is short or long—what the limits and proportions are. Not knowing these, they act rashly and collide blindly with things; if they happen to succeed, this is called luck.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

- 人之有為
 - “When a person undertakes something”
 - “When people take action”
 - “In human doings / enterprises”
- 不知其卒
 - “do not know its end”
 - “do not know how it will turn out”
 - “do not understand its completion/final outcome”
- 不唯謀而不度乎
 - 謀: plan, scheme, deliberate, devise
 - 度: measure, calculate, estimate, assess

- Possible sense: "Is this not simply planning without calculation?"
- Or: "Is it not because they deliberate but fail to measure things?"
- 短長
 - Literally "short and long"
 - Figuratively "relative measure," "advantages and disadvantages," "limits and extent," "strengths and weaknesses"
 - Possibly temporal: "duration"
- 妄作衡觸
 - 妄作: act rashly, act blindly, do things recklessly
 - 衡觸 is uncertain:
 - "colliding crosswise," i.e. rushing about and bumping into things
 - "making random encounters/contacts"
 - perhaps "reckless collisions and oppositions"
 - Overall likely: "act blindly and crash into things," but the exact image is uncertain.
- 而有成功，名之曰幸
 - "and if there is success, it is called luck"
 - "should it happen to succeed, one names it fortune"
 - "success under such conditions is called chance."

Translation 1: "planning without calculation"

When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts rashly, colliding this way and that; if there is success, it is called luck.

Translation 2: "deliberation without assessment"

In human undertakings, if one does not understand the final outcome, is it not because one deliberates but does not assess? If one deliberates without assessment, then one has no means to know the relative limits of things. When those limits are unknown, one acts blindly and runs into collisions; if something is accomplished, this is named fortune.

Translation 3: "scheming without judging consequences"

When people act and yet do not know the end of what they are doing, is this not a case of scheming without judging the measure of it? If they scheme without judging the measure, they cannot know the advantages and disadvantages. Not knowing the advantages and disadvantages, they recklessly set things in motion, striking against obstacles; if they achieve success, it is called chance.

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

When a person undertakes something but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing the short and the long, one acts rashly, "striking crosswise" here and there; if there is success, it is called luck.

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal

When a person has something he does, but does not know its end, is this not planning without measuring? If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know the short and the long. Not knowing the short and the long, one recklessly acts, crossing and colliding; if there is success, call it “luck.”

2. Scholarly

If someone undertakes an action without knowing how it will end, is that not a case of scheming without calculation? To scheme without calculating is to have no means of discerning its limits and proportions. If those limits are unknown, then action is merely reckless collision; should it nevertheless succeed, it is properly called fortune.

3. Plain-language

If people start doing something without knowing where it will lead, aren't they just making plans without thinking them through? Without judging things carefully, they cannot know what is too short or too long, what will work or fail. If they act blindly and still succeed, that is not skill—it is luck.

4. Sceptical

When someone takes action without knowing the likely result, calling it “planning” is generous: it is planning without assessment. Without assessment, one cannot know the scale, limits, or consequences. If such a person blunders forward and happens to succeed, the honest name for that success is luck.

5. Uncertainty-marked

When a person undertakes something, yet does not know its 卒—its end, outcome, or completion—is this not simply “planning” without 度—measuring, estimating, or judging? If one plans without such estimation, there is no way to know the 短長—the short and long, perhaps the limits, advantages and disadvantages, or proper proportions. Not knowing these, one acts rashly in 衡觸—perhaps “crosswise collision,” “running into obstacles,” or “reckless clashing.” If success results, it is called 幸, luck or fortunate chance.

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When a person sets out to do something, yet does not know how it will end—is this not planning without weighing?

If one plans but does not weigh, there is no way to know what is short and what is long. Not knowing short from long, one acts rashly, barging and striking about; if success comes of it, it is called luck.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Rendering	Note
人之有為	“a person sets out to do something”	Undertaking action or enterprise.
不知其卒	“does not know how it will end”	卒 = end, conclusion, outcome.
謀而不度	“planning without weighing”	謀 = plan; 度 = measure, assess, calculate.
短長	“short and long”	Likely relative merits, limits, or consequences; kept concrete.
妄作衡觸	“acts rashly, barging and striking about”	衡觸 suggests heedless collision or running into things; wording remains somewhat uncertain.
名之日幸	“it is called luck”	Success without proper measure is not credited to sound planning.

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

When people set their hands to doing,
yet do not know where it will end—
is this not planning without pondering,
scheming without scale?

If one plans but does not measure,
there is no way to know short from long.
Not knowing short and long,
one acts rashly, crossing and colliding;
and if success still comes,
call it luck.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Rendered sense
人之有為	people undertaking action / doing something
不知其卒	not knowing its end, outcome, or completion
謀而不度	planning but not measuring, estimating, or judging
無以知短長	having no means to know "short and long" — relative measure, limits, strengths/weaknesses
妄作衡觸	acting rashly; literally uncertain, something like "crosswise striking/colliding"
有成功	having success despite this
名之曰幸	name it "luck" / call it fortune

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

Who acts, yet knows not how the end is weighed—
Is this not planning, but with no measure laid?
With no such measure, short and long stay unknown;
Then rash "weighing/striking" deeds are thrown—
If they succeed, we call it luck alone.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When a person undertakes action but does not know how it will end, is this not simply planning without measuring?
If one plans but does not measure, then there is no way to know what is short or long. Not knowing short from long,
one acts rashly—"balancing and bumping against things," or perhaps "striking about at random" (衡觸,
uncertain) —and if success comes of it, it is called luck.

More literal rendering

People having something to do, yet not knowing its conclusion—is this not planning but not gauging? If they plan
but do not gauge, then they have no means to know short and long. Short and long not being known, they
recklessly make "balancing/colliding" actions (衡觸 uncertain) ; if there is success, it is named "fortune."

Memory aid — mnemonic rendering, not a critical translation

Plan without measure,
lose sight of length;
stumble into success—
call it luck, not strength.

Memory aid — alliterative version, not a critical translation

Plotting without proportion,
people cannot perceive short or long;
rashly they ramble and run into results—
success so stumbled on is “sheer chance.”

Memory aid — short rhyme, not a critical translation

Plan but never measure—
you know no length or line;
if rash work wins some treasure,
call luck the reason why.

Passage 6

Source text

幸，天；知事之卒，心。必心與天兩，事焉果成。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune is Heaven; knowing the outcome of an affair is the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present does the affair thereby truly come to completion.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Fortune: Heaven.

Knowing the ending of affairs: the mind.

It must be that mind and Heaven are both / are two;
then affairs thereupon truly come to completion.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
幸	topic / nominal idea	fortune; luck; fortunate outcome	Could mean “good fortune” or “what happens fortunately/by chance.”
天	predicate / source term	Heaven; the natural order	Elliptical: “fortune is Heaven” or “fortune comes from Heaven.”
知	verb / nominalized action	to know; knowing	Begins a parallel phrase with 幸.
事之卒	object of 知	the end / outcome / completion of affairs	之 marks relation; 卒 = “end, finish, final outcome.”
心	predicate / faculty term	the heart-mind; mind	Elliptical: “knowing the outcome of affairs is the mind’s role.”
必	modal / conditional marker	must; necessarily; only when	Introduces a necessary condition.
心與天	compound subject	mind and Heaven	與 = “and / together with.”
兩	predicate / adverbial idea	two; both; paired	Uncertain force: “are two factors,” “both operate,” or “are brought together.”
事	subject / topic	affairs; undertakings	Refers back to 事 in 事之卒.
焉	connective / adverb	then; thereby; therein	Marks consequence or locus.
果成	verbal phrase	indeed become complete; actually succeed	果 may mean “indeed” or suggest “bear fruit”; 成 = complete, accomplish.

Aligned gloss translation:

“Fortune—Heaven; knowing affairs’ outcome—the mind.

It must be that mind and Heaven are both / paired; affairs then indeed come to completion.”

Smoother rendering:

“Fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing the outcome of affairs belongs to the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both involved / paired do affairs thereby truly succeed.”

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Good fortune—[that belongs to] Heaven;
knowing the end/outcome of an affair—[that belongs to] the heart-mind.
Only when the heart-mind and Heaven are both [in play / paired],
does the affair thereby truly come to completion.”

Syntax map

- 幸, 天: “fortune/luck” = attributed to Heaven.
- 知事之卒, 心: “knowing the completion/end of affairs” = attributed to the heart-mind.
- 必心與天兩: “it must be that heart-mind and Heaven are two/both”; exact force of 兩 uncertain: “both present,” “paired,” or “twofold.”
- 事焉果成: “the affair then/thereby indeed comes to completion.”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

“Fortune is Heaven; knowing the outcome of an affair is the heart-mind. Only when heart-mind and Heaven are both present / paired does the affair indeed come to completion.”

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Fortuity” belongs to Heaven; knowing how an affair will end belongs to the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present—two factors together—can the affair thereby be brought to completion.

Glossary

- 幸: fortune, chance, fortuity; what occurs through luck rather than deliberate control.
- 天: Heaven; the non-human or natural determinant of events.
- 心: the mind/heart; the faculty of awareness, judgment, or intention.
- 事之卒: the end, outcome, or final completion of an affair.
- 兩: “two,” “both,” or “paired”; here taken as indicating the joint presence of mind and Heaven.
- 果成: to be truly/accomplished, to come successfully to completion.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing how an affair will end belongs to the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both involved can the affair truly be accomplished.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Good fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing how a matter will turn out belongs to the heart-mind. Only when the heart-mind and Heaven are both involved—working as a pair, perhaps—can an undertaking truly come to completion.

Anchor notes

1. 幸 → “good fortune”: also “luck” or “being favored”; the text treats it as not fully human-controlled.

2. 天 → “Heaven”: here likely the impersonal order or force beyond human intention.
3. 知事之卒 → “knowing how a matter will turn out”: 卒 means the end, outcome, or completion of an affair.
4. 心 → “heart-mind”: the faculty of thought, awareness, judgment, and intention.
5. 幸, 天;心 → rendered as a contrast: fortune is assigned to Heaven, understanding to the heart-mind.
6. 必 → “only when / necessarily”: marks a required condition.
7. 心與天兩 → “the heart-mind and Heaven are both involved—working as a pair, perhaps”: 兩 is terse; it may mean “the two together” or “both sides.”
8. 事焉果成 → “an undertaking truly comes to completion”: 果成 suggests real or eventual accomplishment; 焉 is taken as “thereupon / in that case,” though its force is somewhat uncertain.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune is Heaven.

Knowing the final outcome of an affair is the mind.

Only if the mind and Heaven are “two,” or perhaps both present, does the affair thereby truly come to completion.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim: “Luck” or favorable fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing how an affair will end belongs to the heart-mind. Only when heart-mind and Heaven are both involved can an affair truly be completed.
- Agency: Heaven provides the element of fortune or external circumstance; the heart-mind provides understanding, foresight, or judgment about the affair’s outcome.
- Causal relation: Success depends on the conjunction of both factors: external favor and internal discernment. With only one, the matter may not “really” come to completion.
- Uncertainty: 「事之卒」 may mean “the end/result of the affair” or “the completion of the affair.” 「兩」 may mean “both,” “paired,” or “as two necessary sides.”
- Interpretive risk: 「幸」 could be read as “good fortune,” “chance,” or “being favored”; translating 「天」 as “Heaven” preserves the term but leaves open whether it means fate, nature, or a divine order.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune comes from Heaven.

Knowing how an affair will end comes from the heart (mind).

Only when the heart and Heaven are both present can the affair truly be completed.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

“Good fortune is from Heaven; knowing how an affair will end is from the heart-mind. Only when the heart-mind and Heaven are both present / paired together does the affair thereby truly come to completion.”

Grammar notes

1. 幸, 天: a compressed nominal-predicate clause: “As for fortune/luck, it is Heaven,” i.e. fortune depends on Heaven or comes from Heaven.
2. 知事之卒, 心: likewise compressed: “Knowing the end of an affair is the heart-mind.” The implied sense is that knowing or judging the outcome belongs to the mind.

3. 事之卒: 之 links 事 “affair, matter” with 卒 “end, conclusion, completion”: “the end/outcome of the affair.”
4. 卒 can mean “end, finish, conclusion”; here it likely means the final outcome of events, not “soldier” or “to die.”
5. 心 is “heart-mind,” the faculty of thought, intention, judgment, and awareness, not merely emotion.
6. 必 introduces necessity: “it is necessary that...,” “only if...,” or “must.”
7. 心與天 means “the heart-mind and Heaven”; 與 functions as “and/with.”
8. 兩 literally “two” or “both”; here it seems to mean that the two factors, mind and Heaven, must both operate or be present.
9. 事焉果成: 焉 may mean “thereby / in that case / then,” marking the consequence of the preceding condition.
10. 果成 can be read as “indeed be completed/succeed” or “come to fruition and be completed”; the phrase carries both confirmation and completion.

Mini vocabulary

- 幸 — luck, fortune, fortunate outcome
- 天 — Heaven; natural or heavenly determination
- 知 — to know, understand, discern
- 事 — affair, matter, undertaking
- 卒 — end, conclusion, completion
- 心 — heart-mind; mind, intention, judgment
- 與 — and; with
- 兩 — two; both
- 焉 — therein; thereby; then
- 果成 — to truly succeed; to come to fruition / completion

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Fortune is Heaven; knowing the outcome of affairs is the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present together do affairs thereby truly come to completion.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
天 “Heaven”	Abstract/cosmic principle	Source or domain of 幸 “fortune/luck”; paired with 心 “mind” as necessary for success/completion	Medium
心 “mind/heart”	Abstract faculty	Source or domain of knowing how affairs end; must work together with 天 “Heaven”	High
幸 “fortune/luck”	Abstract concept	Attributed to Heaven; possibly means favorable chance or good fortune	Medium
事 “affairs/matters”	Abstract/general object	The things whose outcome is known and which may be completed/accomplished	High
卒 “end/outcome/conclusion”	Abstract concept	The final result of affairs, known by the mind	Medium
知 “knowing”	Abstract action/faculty	The mind’s function: knowing the outcome of affairs	High
成 “completion/success”	Abstract result	The achieved result when mind and Heaven are both involved	High
兩 “both/two together”	Relational concept	Indicates that 心 and 天 must both be present or act jointly	Medium

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 幸, 天

- “Good fortune is from Heaven.”
- “Luck belongs to Heaven / is Heaven’s doing.”
- “Being favored is a matter of Heaven.”

2. 知事之卒，心

- “Knowing how an affair will end is a matter of the mind.”
- “Understanding the completion of an undertaking depends on the heart-mind.”
- “To grasp the final outcome of events is the work of one’s intention/mind.”

3. 必心與天兩

- “One must have both mind and Heaven.”
- “Only when the mind and Heaven are both present...”
- “It is necessary that mind and Heaven form a pair / act together...”

4. 事焉果成

- “then the affair will indeed be accomplished.”
- “thereupon the undertaking comes to fruition.”
- “only in this way do things truly succeed.”

Translation A

Good fortune is Heaven’s doing; knowing how an affair will end is the work of the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present will the affair indeed be accomplished.

Translation B

Luck rests with Heaven; understanding the completion of an undertaking rests with the heart-mind. It is necessary for heart-mind and Heaven to act as two together—then the undertaking comes to fruition.

Translation C

Being favored is a matter of Heaven; grasping the final outcome of events is a matter of the mind. If mind and Heaven must be paired, then only so can things truly succeed.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

1. “Luck is Heaven; knowing how an affair will end is the mind.”

Confidence: 74/100.

Reasons: The sentence is highly elliptical but the parallel structure is fairly clear: 幸，天 and 知事之卒，心 assign “luck/fortune” to Heaven and “knowing the end/completion of affairs” to the mind. Uncertainty remains over whether 幸 means “luck,” “fortunate success,” or “what happens by chance,” and whether 卒 means “end,” “completion,” or “final outcome.”

2. “There must be both the mind and Heaven; only then does an affair thereby truly come to completion.”

Confidence: 55/100.

Reasons: The main uncertainty is 心與天兩. I read 兩 as “the two / both,” giving the sense that both human knowing and Heaven’s fortune are needed. But it could also mean “separate/twofold,” which would make the sentence more rhetorical: “If mind and Heaven must be separate, how could an affair ever truly be completed?”

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 幸
 - Chosen: “luck”

- Alternatives: “good fortune,” “fortunate success,” “chance,” “favor”

2. 天

- Chosen: “Heaven”
- Alternatives: “fate,” “the heavens,” “natural allotment,” “what lies beyond human control”

3. 知事之卒

- Chosen: “knowing how an affair will end”
- Alternatives: “knowing the completion of an affair,” “understanding the final outcome of matters,” “foreseeing how things conclude”

4. 必心與天兩

- Chosen: “There must be both the mind and Heaven”
- Alternatives: “Mind and Heaven must be paired,” “the mind and Heaven must both be involved,” “if mind and Heaven are necessarily two/separate,” “one must distinguish mind from Heaven”

5. 事焉果成

- Chosen: “an affair thereby truly comes to completion”
- Alternatives: “the matter is then successfully accomplished,” “the affair consequently reaches fruition,” “how could the affair ever truly be completed?”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points

1. 幸

- Alternatives: “fortune,” “luck,” “being fortunate,” “success by chance.”
- Choice: “fortune”
- Justification: The phrase equates 幸 with 天, suggesting what lies outside human control.

2. 天

- Alternatives: “Heaven,” “fate,” “the natural order.”
- Choice: “Heaven”
- Justification: Keeps the Classical Chinese term’s ambiguity between cosmic order and fate.

3. 知事之卒

- Alternatives: “knowing the end of an affair,” “knowing how a matter will conclude,” “understanding the completion of events.”
- Choice: “knowing the outcome/end of an affair”
- Justification: 卒 can mean “end,” “completion,” or “conclusion”; “outcome” preserves that sense.

4. 心

- Alternatives: “mind,” “heart,” “heart-mind.”
- Choice: “heart-mind”
- Justification: 心 includes cognition, intention, and inward awareness.

5. 必心與天兩

- Main alternatives:
 - A: “There must be both the heart-mind and Heaven...” — taking 兩 as “both/two factors.”
 - B: “If one insists on making the heart-mind and Heaven two/separate...” — taking 兩 as “to divide into two,” with the next phrase possibly rhetorical.

- Choice: A as the main reading, with uncertainty noted.
- Justification: The following phrase 事焉果成 can read as a result: “the matter thereby is indeed completed.” But the syntax also allows a more skeptical/rhetorical reading.

6. 事焉果成

- Alternatives: “the matter thereby is indeed accomplished,” or “how could the matter really be accomplished?”
- Choice: “the matter thereby is indeed accomplished”
- Justification: 焉 can mark “thereby/thereupon,” and 果 can mean “indeed, actually.”

Final translation

Fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing the outcome of an affair belongs to the heart-mind. There must be both heart-mind and Heaven; only then is the affair truly accomplished.

Alternative possible reading of the last sentence: “If one insists on making heart-mind and Heaven two separate things, how could the affair really be accomplished?”

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation (provisional):

“Luck belongs to Heaven; knowing how an affair will end belongs to the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present does the affair thereby truly come to completion.”

Deliberately sceptical alternative:

“Being fortunate is a matter of Heaven; grasping the final outcome of events is a matter of the mind. One must have both mind and Heaven as two factors—only then is anything actually accomplished.”

Where the readings diverge:

- 幸 may mean “luck,” “good fortune,” or “being favored.” I have not treated it as moral “blessing,” since the text gives no clear basis for that.
- 天 could be “Heaven,” “fate,” or “natural allotment.” “Heaven” is literal but may over-personify it.
- 知事之卒 is uncertain: 卒 may mean “end,” “completion,” or “final outcome.” So this could mean either “knowing how things end” or “knowing that things will be completed.”
- 心與天兩 literally suggests “mind and Heaven, the two.” This may mean “both mind and Heaven,” but it could also stress that they are distinct factors.
- 焉果成 is taken as “thereby truly comes to completion,” but 果 could also mean “indeed,” “finally,” or “bear fruit / achieve result.”

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

“Good fortune is Heaven; knowing how an affair will end is the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present / both brought together does the affair thereby truly come to completion.”

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

幸者，天也；知事之終者，心也。必心與天俱備，然後事乃成。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 卒 is rendered as “end / completion,” but it can also suggest “outcome” or “final result.”

- 心與天兩 is uncertain: I translated it as “mind and Heaven are both present / brought together.” Literally, 兩 means “two / both,” and may imply “the two together,” but the exact relation is not fully explicit.
- 焉 is rendered as “thereby / then,” but it could also be read more weakly as a particle marking consequence or location in the argument.
- 果成 is translated as “truly come to completion”; 果 may mean “indeed,” “surely,” or “as a result,” so the force is somewhat interpretive.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Good fortune is from Heaven; knowing how an affair will end is from the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present can the affair truly come to completion.”

Uncertainty notes

- 幸，天: Literally “fortune/luck — Heaven.” This may mean “luck depends on Heaven” or “good fortune is Heaven’s doing.”
- 知事之卒，心: Literally “knowing the end/completion of affairs — the mind.”
 - 卒 can mean “end,” “conclusion,” or “completion.”
 - 心 may mean “mind,” “heart,” “intention,” or “inner discernment.”
- 必心與天兩: Interpreted above as “there must be both mind and Heaven.”
 - 兩 could mean “the two,” “both,” or “paired.”
 - It might also mean “separate/twofold,” yielding a different reading.
- 事焉果成: Read as “then the affair indeed succeeds/is completed.”
 - 焉 here is taken as “thereupon/thereby.”
 - 果 may mean “indeed,” “in the end,” or “successfully.”

Red-team alternative

“Luck belongs to Heaven; understanding the outcome of an affair belongs to the mind. If mind and Heaven must be treated as two separate things, how can the affair truly be accomplished?”

This alternative takes 兩 as “separated into two” and 焉 as closer to “how/whereby,” making the final clause more skeptical or rhetorical.

Back-translation audit

Proposed English:

“Good fortune is from Heaven; knowing how an affair will end is from the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present can the affair truly come to completion.”

Back into Classical-style wording:

幸者，天也；知事之終者，心也。必心與天俱，事乃果成。

Potential mismatch: the back-translation uses 俱 and 乃 to clarify “both present” and “then,” while the original has the more ambiguous 兩 and 焉.

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune: Heaven.

Knowing the end of an affair: the heart-mind.

Only when heart-mind and Heaven are both present,
does the affair then really come to completion.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

Good fortune lies with Heaven; knowing how an affair will end lies with the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present—both counted—does the affair truly come to completion.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Chinese segment	Main defensible readings
幸，天	"Luck / fortune / fortunate success is Heaven," i.e. belongs to Heaven or depends on Heaven.
知事之卒，心	"Knowing the end / outcome / completion of affairs is the mind," i.e. belongs to human awareness, judgment, or intention.
必心與天兩	"One must have both mind and Heaven"; or "mind and Heaven must be paired"; alternatively, "if mind and Heaven are made two/separate."
事焉果成	"Then affairs thereby truly come to completion / succeed"; or, if 焉 is interrogative, "how could affairs really be completed?"

Translation 1 — "both Heaven and mind are needed"

Fortune is Heaven; knowing how affairs will end is the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both present do affairs thereby truly succeed.

Translation 2 — "Heaven and the heart-mind work as a pair"

Good fortune belongs to Heaven; understanding the completion of a matter belongs to the heart-mind. The heart-mind and Heaven must be paired; then the matter comes to fruition.

Translation 3 — "human judgment plus fate"

Luck is a matter of Heaven; to know the final outcome of affairs is a matter of the mind. It is necessary to have both mind and Heaven, and only through this are affairs actually accomplished.

Translation 4 — taking 兩 as "separated" and 焉 as rhetorical

Fortune is Heaven; knowing the end of affairs is the mind. But if the mind and Heaven must be divided in two, how could affairs ever truly be completed?

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

"Good fortune is [from] Heaven; knowing the outcome of an affair is [from] the mind. Only when mind and Heaven are both involved—paired as two—does the affair thereby come to completion."

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

1. Literal

"Good fortune: Heaven.

Knowing the end of affairs: the heart-mind.

Only when the heart-mind and Heaven are two, do affairs thereupon truly come to completion."

2. Scholarly

"Luck belongs to Heaven; understanding how affairs will end belongs to the mind. It is necessary to distinguish the mind from Heaven as two separate factors; only then can matters be successfully accomplished."

3. Plain-language

“Luck is up to Heaven. Knowing how things will turn out is up to the mind. If you keep human judgment and fate distinct, then things can really get done.”

4. Sceptical

“What is called ‘luck’ is attributed to Heaven; what is called ‘knowing the outcome of events’ is attributed to the mind. But only if mind and Heaven are treated as separate can one say that affairs actually reach completion.”

5. Uncertainty-marked

“‘Fortune’ may mean what comes from Heaven; ‘knowing the final outcome of an affair’ may mean what comes from the heart-mind. The phrase 心與天兩 could mean either ‘the mind and Heaven must both be present’ or, more likely, ‘the mind and Heaven must be kept as two distinct things.’ In that case, the passage says: only by distinguishing human understanding from Heaven/fate do affairs truly come to completion.”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Good fortune—that belongs to Heaven.
To know how an affair will end—that belongs to the heart-mind.
Only when heart-mind and Heaven stand as the two together
does the affair truly come to completion.”

Factual anchors

Chinese	Rendering	Note
幸	good fortune / luck	Something granted by 天, not fully controlled by oneself.
天	Heaven	Could imply fate, natural order, or Heaven as an impersonal power.
知事之卒	knowing the end/outcome of an affair	卒 here is read as “end, conclusion.”
心	heart-mind	The faculty of awareness, judgment, intention.
兩	the two together / both	Slightly uncertain: may mean “both are needed” or “heart-mind and Heaven form a pair.”
事焉果成	then the affair truly comes to completion	果 adds the sense of “indeed, decisively, at last.”

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

Fortune—Heaven’s part.
To know how a matter ends—
the heart-mind’s work.

Only when heart-mind and Heaven
stand as the two,
does the deed there and then
truly take shape.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Literal sense	Translation choice / uncertainty
幸，天	“fortune/luck — Heaven”	“Fortune—Heaven’s part”
知事之卒	“to know the end/completion of affairs”	“to know how a matter ends”; 卒 may mean end, outcome, or completion
心	“heart / mind”	rendered as “heart-mind”

Chinese	Literal sense	Translation choice / uncertainty
必心與天兩	"must [have] heart-mind and Heaven as two/both"	"Only when heart-mind and Heaven stand as the two"; 兩 may stress duality or both together
事焉果成	"affairs/deeds thereby indeed become/are completed"	"does the deed there and then truly take shape"

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

Luck—or fortune—is Heaven on high;
 To know a matter's end is the mind/heart's eye.
 Only when mind/heart and Heaven pair thereby,
 Can the affair be truly finished—aye.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

"Good fortune belongs to Heaven; knowing how an affair will end belongs to the heart-mind. Only when heart-mind and Heaven are both present / act together can the affair truly be completed."

Notes on uncertainty

- 幸 may mean "good fortune," "luck," or "fortunate success."
- 心 is the heart-mind: both thinking and inward resolve/awareness.
- 知事之卒 literally: "to know the completion/end of an affair."
- 心與天兩 is terse. It may mean "the heart-mind and Heaven are two," "both heart-mind and Heaven," or "heart-mind and Heaven work as a pair."
- 焉果成: "thereupon it is indeed accomplished" / "how could it be fully accomplished otherwise?"

Memory aids — not critical translations

Mnemonic rendering

"Luck is Heaven's; seeing the end is the mind's. When mind and Heaven make a pair, the matter comes to completion."

Alliterative version

"Fortune is from Heaven; foresight is from the heart. Heart and Heaven together—then the task truly takes."

Short rhyme

"Luck from the sky,
 Mind knows the why;
 When both agree,
 The deed comes to be."

Passage 7

Source text

寧心謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之，聞訊視聽，在善之麇，心焉為之。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. In hearing and questioning, in looking and listening, amid the gathered “herd” of what is good, the mind there acts for it.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the heart and plan it; examine it; measure it; take mirror-warning from it.
Hear, inquire, look, listen—being in the gathering/herd (?) of the good;
the heart therein does it.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
寧	verb/adverbial	calm; make tranquil	Here likely a verb modifying 心, “calm the mind/heart.”
心	object / noun	heart; mind	The seat of intention and judgment.
謀之	verb phrase	deliberate on it; plan it	之 = “it,” referring to the matter at hand.
稽之	verb phrase	examine it; check it	稽 can mean “investigate,” “verify,” or “consult.”
度之	verb phrase	measure it; estimate it	度 = assess, calculate, take the measure of.
鑒之	verb phrase	mirror it; scrutinize it; take warning from it	鑒 can mean “look into a mirror,” “inspect,” or “use as a warning/model.”
聞	verb/noun	hear; hearing	Part of a sequence of perceptive/inquiring acts.
訊	verb/noun	inquire; question	Could mean “ask about” or “interrogate/investigate.”
視	verb/noun	see; look	Visual examination.
聽	verb/noun	listen	Auditory attention; paired with 聞.
在	verb/preposition	be in; be at; lie in	Introduces the following location/condition.
善之麇	noun phrase	the herd/crowd of goodness; the gathering of the good	麇 literally denotes a deer/roe-deer; it may function here like 麇/麇, “to gather, crowd,” but this is uncertain. Literally: “goodness’s deer/herd.”
心	noun / subject	heart; mind	Repeated as the agent or seat of action.
焉	adverb/pronoun	therein; thereupon; in this	Marks location, circumstance, or consequence.
為之	verb phrase	does it; acts for it; carries it out	之 again refers to the matter/action under consideration.

Aligned gloss translation:

“Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, mirror/scrutinize it.
Hear, inquire, see, and listen.
Be within the ‘herd/gathering of goodness’—or among what is good;
the mind, therein/thereupon, acts for it.”

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

“[Settle the heart and] [plan it], [examine it], [measure it], [take mirror-warning from it];
[hear], [question], [look], [listen];

[in / among the 麀 of what is good — perhaps ‘the gathered multitude’ of the good, or literally ‘the deer/roe-deer of the good’];

the heart, therein, acts for it.”

Syntax map:

- 寧心 = “settle/calm the heart”
- 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之 = four parallel verb + object “it” clauses
- 聞訊視聽 = four parallel perception/inquiry verbs
- 在善之麀 = locative phrase, uncertain noun 麀
- 心焉為之 = subject 心 + 焉 “therein/thereby” + 為之 “does/acts for it”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and plan it; examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror. Hear and inquire, look and listen. In what is good—perhaps “where goodness gathers” / “among the good” [uncertain: 麀]—let the mind act upon it.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take reflection from it. By hearing and questioning, by looking and listening, one is among the gathered forms of what is good—there the mind acts for it.

Glossary

- 寧心: “to calm/settle the mind.”
- 謀之: “to deliberate on it,” “to plan concerning it.”
- 稽之: “to examine/investigate it.”
- 度之: “to measure/assess it.”
- 鑒之: “to mirror it,” “to take warning or reflection from it.”
- 聞訊視聽: literally “hearing, questioning, looking, listening”; a sequence of perceptual and investigative acts.
- 善之麀: uncertain. 麀 may suggest a “herd/cluster/gathering,” so translated cautiously as “the gathered forms of what is good.”
- 心焉為之: “the mind thereupon/there acts for it,” i.e. the mind undertakes or responds to the matter.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. What is heard and asked, seen and listened to, lies in the gathered mass [or “herd,” 麀] of the good; the mind is what carries it out.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, weigh it, and take it as a mirror.

Through hearing and questioning, looking and listening—if it is found among what is good, however “gathered” or “clustered” that phrase may mean—the mind should act on it / is the one that carries it out.

Anchor notes

1. 寧心 → “Calm the mind”: taking 寧 as “settle, make tranquil.”
2. 謀之 → “deliberate on it”: 謀 suggests planning or careful consideration.
3. 稽之 → “examine it”: 稽 can mean to investigate, check, or verify.
4. 度之 → “weigh it”: 度 here is understood as measuring or estimating.
5. 鑒之 → “take it as a mirror”: 鑒 can mean to inspect by reflection, or to use as a model/warning.
6. 聞訊視聽 → “through hearing and questioning, looking and listening”: read as a compact list of ways of receiving and testing information.
7. 在善之麀 → “found among what is good ... ‘gathered/clustered’”: 善 is “good”; 麀 is uncertain here, literally a deer term but possibly implying a cluster/group or a textual variant.
8. 心焉為之 → “the mind should act on it / is the one that carries it out”: 焉為之 is ambiguous between “thereupon do it” and “the mind does it with regard to this.”

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

Settle the mind, and deliberate about the matter.

Examine the matter.

Measure the matter.

Take the matter as a mirror, or take warning from the matter.

Hear, inquire, look, and listen.

The matter is in a “gathering of goodness,” if 麀 means a gathering; the reading of 麀 is uncertain.

The mind then acts for the matter.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim / translation: “Calm the heart and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror. Hearing, questioning, seeing, and listening—being amid the cluster/herd of what is good—the heart thereby acts on it.”
- Agency: The heart/mind is the acting center: it calms itself, deliberates, examines, measures, reflects, and finally “does” or “acts” in response.
- Causal relation: Careful inquiry through multiple modes—planning, checking, measuring, reflecting, hearing, asking, seeing, listening—leads the heart toward action grounded in “the good.”
- Uncertainty: 「善之麀」 is difficult. 「麀」 may suggest a “herd,” “cluster,” or gathering; thus the phrase may mean “among gathered goods,” “among good people/things,” or “within the convergence of goodness.”
- Interpretive risk: Rendering 「鑒之」 as “take it as a mirror” and 「心焉為之」 as “the heart thereby acts” is interpretive; the passage is compact and may describe moral cultivation, decision-making, or epistemic verification without clearly distinguishing them.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the heart-mind (心), and plan it.

Examine it, weigh it, and use it as a mirror.

Hear, ask, look, and listen.

If it is among the gathered good things — or “the herd/crowd of goodness” (麀 is uncertain) — then the heart-mind acts on it.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, mirror it / take warning from it.

In hearing, questioning, looking, and listening—being amid the “herd/cluster” of what is good—the mind thereupon acts for it.

Uncertain phrase: 在善之麋 is obscure. Literally it is something like “in/at the 麋 of goodness/the good.” 麋 can mean a kind of deer, and may also be related graphically or semantically to “herd, cluster, gathering”; the translation above takes it cautiously as “herd/cluster.”

Grammar notes

1. 寧心: “to calm/settle the heart-mind.” 心 is the object of 寧.
2. 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之: a chain of parallel verb-object phrases. Each 之 refers back to the matter under consideration: “plan it, examine it, measure it, mirror it.”
3. 謀: here likely “to deliberate, plan, consult about,” not necessarily “plot” in a negative sense.
4. 稽: “to examine, check, investigate”; it can also mean “to delay,” but the parallelism favors “examine.”
5. 度: “to measure, estimate, assess.” The reading “duó,” “to calculate/consider,” fits the context.
6. 鑒: literally “a mirror”; as a verb, “to mirror, inspect, take as a warning/model.” The exact nuance is open.
7. 聞訊視聽: four perception/inquiry terms placed in sequence: “hearing, questioning, seeing, listening.” It may describe the means by which judgment is formed.
8. 在: likely locative or situational: “in, amid, being in.” It introduces the setting or domain in which the preceding actions occur.
9. 善之麋: 之 marks possession or attribution: “the 麋 of goodness/the good.” The phrase is not straightforward.
10. 心焉為之: 焉 may mean “therein, in this, thereupon.” 為之 means “does it / acts for it / brings it about,” with 之 again referring to the matter.

Mini vocabulary

- 寧 — to calm, settle, make peaceful
- 心 — heart; mind; intention
- 謀 — to deliberate, plan, consult
- 稽 — to examine, investigate, check
- 度 — to measure, estimate, assess
- 鑒 — mirror; to reflect on; to take warning/model from
- 聞 — to hear; what is heard
- 訊 — to ask, question, inquire
- 視 — to look at, inspect
- 聽 — to listen, heed
- 善 — good; goodness; what is good
- 麋 — a deer; possibly “herd/cluster” here, uncertain
- 焉 — therein, in this; thereupon
- 為 — to do, act, make, bring about

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Quiet the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. Hearing and inquiry, seeing and listening—these lie amid the gathering of what is good; the mind acts on it there.”

Uncertain point: 善之麇 is difficult. 麇 may mean a “herd/cluster/gathering” metaphorically, though it can also refer literally to a kind of deer. Thus “the gathering of what is good” is tentative.

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Role in passage	Confidence
心	“Mind/heart”; the faculty to be calmed and the agent that acts	High
謀	Deliberation, planning, taking counsel	High
稽	Examination, checking, investigating	High
度	Measuring, estimating, assessing	High
鑒	Mirroring, reflecting on, taking as a warning/model	Medium–High
聞訊	Hearing and questioning/inquiry; receiving reports or asking	Medium
視聽	Seeing and listening; perception through eyes and ears	High
善	The good, goodness, what is beneficial/right	High
麇	“Herd/cluster/gathering,” possibly literal “deer”; meaning here uncertain	Low–Medium
之	The object of deliberation/examination/etc.; unspecified “it/this matter”	Medium

Named entities: none apparent in the supplied passage.

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 寧心

- “settle/calm the mind”
- “with a tranquil mind”
- “rather, in one’s mind ...” though this is less likely here

2. 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之

- “deliberate on it, examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror”
- “plan it, verify it, assess it, reflect on it”
- “consult about it, investigate it, estimate it, use it as a lesson”

3. 聞訊視聽

- “hearing and questioning, seeing and listening”
- “what is heard, asked, seen, and listened to”
- “hear reports, make inquiry, observe, and listen”

4. 在善之麇

- “among the gathering/herd of the good”
- “where goodness is clustered”
- literally, “in the deer/herd of goodness,” with 麇 uncertain or possibly metaphorical

5. 心焉為之

- “the mind thereupon acts on it”

- “the heart is what does it”
- “let the mind be engaged in it there”

Translation A

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. In hearing and questioning, in seeing and listening, when among the gathering of what is good, the mind is thereby to act.

Translation B

With a settled heart, plan it, verify it, assess it, and reflect on it. As to what is heard, asked, seen, and listened to—being amid the cluster of goodness—the heart makes it so.

Translation C

Settle the mind: consult about it, investigate it, weigh it, and use it for reflection. Hear and inquire, look and listen; where the good are gathered, let the mind work upon it.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. In hearing, questioning, seeing, and listening, [be] among the gathering of what is good; the mind is what does this / thereby brings it about.”

Sentence confidence

1. 寧心謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之，聞訊視聽，在善之麀，心焉為之。

Confidence: 55/100.

Reasons: The general ethical/introspective sense is fairly clear: calm the mind, deliberate, examine, measure, reflect, and orient perception toward the good. However, several phrases are syntactically compressed, especially 在善之麀 and 心焉為之, and 麀 is unusual here, making the final clauses uncertain.

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 寧心
 - Main rendering: “calm the mind”
 - Alternatives: “settle the heart-mind”; “make the mind peaceful”; “with a tranquil mind”
2. 稽之、度之、鑒之
 - Main rendering: “examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror”
 - Alternatives: “investigate it, estimate it, and reflect on it”; “check it, assess it, and use it for warning/insight”
3. 聞訊視聽
 - Main rendering: “in hearing, questioning, seeing, and listening”
 - Alternatives: “what one hears, asks about, sees, and listens to”; “hearing reports and observing/listening”; “through inquiry, sight, and hearing”
4. 在善之麀
 - Main rendering: “[be] among the gathering of what is good”
 - Alternatives: “[rest] in the multitude of good things”; “[place oneself] with the good”; “in the flock/herd of goodness”
 - Note: 麀 is especially uncertain; it may suggest a “gathering/herd,” but the exact force is unclear.
5. 心焉為之
 - Main rendering: “the mind is what does this / thereby brings it about”
 - Alternatives: “the mind acts upon it”; “the heart-mind is there engaged in it”; “the mind thereby carries it out”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 寧心

- “calm/settle the heart-mind”: takes 寧 as a verb meaning to make tranquil.
- “with a tranquil heart-mind”: takes it adverbially/descriptively.
- I choose “settle the heart-mind” because it fits the following sequence of deliberate actions.

2. 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之

- 謀: “deliberate on,” “plan,” “consider.”
- 稽: “examine,” “check,” “investigate.”
- 度: “measure,” “estimate,” “weigh.”
- 鑒: “mirror,” “inspect,” “take warning from.”
- I render them as a sequence of reflective acts: “deliberate on it, examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror.”

3. 聞訊視聽

- Could be read as four coordinated acts: “hearing, questioning, seeing, listening.”
- Or as paired expressions: “what is heard and asked about, seen and listened to.”
- I keep the fourfold structure: “in hearing and questioning, seeing and listening.”

4. 在善之麇

- 麇 literally refers to a deer/roe-deer, but may also suggest a clustered “herd” or gathering, close to 麋 in the sense of assembling.
- Possible translations:
 - “among the herd of the good” — literal but strange.
 - “amid the gathering of goodness” — interpretive but smoother.
 - “in the cluster of what is good” — preserves the oddness.
- I choose “amid the gathering of what is good”, while noting the uncertainty of 麇.

5. 心焉為之

- Could mean “the heart-mind acts on it there,” “the heart-mind does this for it,” or “the heart-mind is there engaged in it.”
- I translate cautiously as “the heart-mind there acts for it / carries it out.”

Final translation

Settle the heart-mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror. In hearing and questioning, seeing and listening, amid the gathering of what is good, the heart-mind there carries it out.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. Hear, inquire, look, and listen. If it lies among the gathered things that are good, then the mind acts on it.”

Sceptical alternative

“Would one rather plan it in the mind, check it, estimate it, and inspect it? Hearing reports, questioning, seeing, and listening—within the ‘herd’ of the good, the mind is what does it.”

Points of uncertainty / divergence

- 寧心: I take it mainly as “calm/settle the mind,” but 寧 can also mean “rather / would rather,” giving a different opening.
- 鑒之: Could mean “inspect it,” “take warning from it,” or “use it as a mirror/model.” I translated broadly as “take it as a mirror.”
- 聞訊視聽: The sequence is somewhat redundant if read literally: “hear, inquire, see, listen.” It may mean gathering information through reports, questioning, observation, and listening.
- 在善之麋: This is the most uncertain phrase. 麋 literally suggests a kind of deer or herd/flock; it may function like 麋, “a gathering/crowd.” Thus I render it cautiously as “the gathered things that are good,” but a literal “herd of the good” remains possible.
- 心焉為之: Could mean “the mind thereby does it,” “the mind is responsible for it,” or “the mind acts for this reason.”

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. Hear, question, look, and listen. Being amid the “麋” of goodness—perhaps the herd/cluster, though the word is uncertain—the mind thereupon acts for it.

Back-translation / Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

安其心而謀之，考之，量之，鑑之；聞而訊，視而聽；在善之麋 / 群，心乃為之。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 寧心: rendered as “calm the mind.” It could also mean “settle the heart/mind,” or less likely “would rather set one’s mind.”
- 稽之: translated “examine it”; could also be “investigate,” “check,” or “compare against precedent.”
- 鑒之: translated “take it as a mirror”; could simply mean “inspect it” or “reflect upon it.”
- 聞訊視聽: I expanded the compact sequence into “Hear, question, look, and listen.” The relation among the four actions is not explicit.
- 在善之麋: highly uncertain. 麋 literally suggests a deer/roe-deer; it may imply a herd or cluster if taken near 麋/群. “The herd/cluster of goodness” is interpretive and may drift from a literal “the deer of goodness.”
- 心焉為之: translated “the mind thereupon acts for it.” 焉 may mean “there,” “thereupon,” or function more weakly; 為之 may mean “does it,” “acts for it,” or “takes it as its object.”

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Quiet the mind and plan it; examine it, measure it, and take mirror from it.
Hear, inquire, look, and listen—being amid the gathered multitude of what is good;
there the mind acts upon it.

Uncertainty notes

- 寧心: translated as “quiet the mind,” but it could also mean “settle / make secure the mind.”
- 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之: the repeated 之 may refer to “the matter” under consideration. 鑒之 could mean “reflect on it,” “take warning from it,” or “use it as a mirror.”
- 聞訊視聽: taken as four acts—“hear, inquire, look, listen.” The pairing is somewhat compressed; 聞 and 聽 overlap in English.

- 在善之麋: highly uncertain. 麋 literally denotes a kind of deer, but may be functioning like 麋, “to gather / a crowd, multitude.” I rendered it as “the gathered multitude of what is good.” If read literally, the phrase would be strange: “among the deer of goodness.”
- 心焉為之: could mean “there the mind does it,” “the mind acts for it,” or “the mind is thereby made to do it.” The syntax is compact and ambiguous.

Red-team alternative

Settle the heart and deliberate about it; investigate it, weigh it, and mirror it.
By hearing reports, asking questions, seeing, and listening,
one stays among the cluster of the good, and the heart thereby carries it out.

Back-translation audit

Quiet/settled mind — deliberate it — examine it — measure/weigh it — mirror it.
Hear — question — see — listen.
Be in / among the good’s gathered cluster.
The mind thereupon / therein does it.

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and plan it; examine it; measure it; mirror it.
Hear, inquire, look, listen.
Be amid the herd / gathering of the good.
The mind there acts for it.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, weigh it, take warning from it. In what one hears, asks, sees, and listens to, be among—or attend to—the multitude of what is good; let the mind act upon it.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Segment	Possible readings
寧心	“calm the mind/heart”; “settle the mind”; possibly “with a tranquil mind”
謀之	“deliberate over it”; “plan it”; “consult about it”
稽之	“examine/check it”; “verify it”; “reckon it up”; possibly “delay over it”
度之	“measure it”; “estimate it”; “judge it”
鑒之	“mirror it”; “scrutinize it”; “take it as a warning/model”
聞訊視聽	Could be a sequence of acts: “hear, inquire, look, listen”; or a compound field of perception/report: “what is heard and asked, seen and listened to”
在善之麋	Difficult. 麋 can be read literally as “roe-deer/deer,” or as related to 麋, “flock, herd, crowd, gathering.” Thus: “among the herd of the good,” “in the gathering/massing of good things,” or, more literally and obscurely, “in the deer of goodness.”
心焉為之	“the mind/heart then does it”; “there the mind acts on it”; “the heart is what brings it about”; 焉 may mean “there/in this/thereupon.”

Translation 1 — procedural, with 麋 as “gathering/herd”

“Calm the mind and deliberate on it; examine it, measure it, and take it as a mirror. Hear and inquire, look and listen. When it is within the gathering of what is good, the mind thereupon acts for it.”

Translation 2 — emphasizing verification and perception

“Settle the heart: consider it, verify it, weigh it, and scrutinize it. Hear reports and ask questions; observe and listen. If it lies among the flock of good things, the heart then carries it out.”

Translation 3 — more literal, preserving strangeness of 善之磨

“Pacify the mind and plan it; check it, gauge it, mirror it. Hearing, questioning, seeing, listening—being in the ‘磨’ of goodness, the mind acts there for it.”

Translation 4 — taking 心焉為之 as “the mind makes it so”

“With a tranquil mind, deliberate upon it, examine it, estimate it, and reflect upon it. Through hearing and inquiry, sight and listening, it is placed among the clustered good; there the mind makes it so.”

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

“Settling the heart-mind, one deliberates on it, investigates it, measures it, and takes it as a mirror. Hearing, questioning, looking, and listening—amid the cluster of what is good (磨, perhaps ‘herd/assemblage,’ uncertain)—the heart-mind acts thereon.”

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Literal

“Calm the heart and plan it, examine it, measure it, mirror it; hearing, questioning, seeing, listening—being in the 磨 of goodness, the heart there does it.”

Scholarly

“With the mind made tranquil, one deliberates on the matter, investigates it, gauges it, and takes reflection from it. Through hearing, inquiry, sight, and listening, within the gathered company of the good, the mind acts accordingly.”

Plain-language

“Settle your mind. Think it over, check it, weigh it, and learn from it. Listen, ask, look, and pay attention. Among what is good, let the mind carry it out.”

Sceptical

“This appears to say: quiet the mind and subject the matter to several tests—deliberation, examination, measurement, and reflection. Then use the senses and inquiry. The phrase ‘在善之磨’ is uncertain; it may mean something like ‘among a gathering of good things/people.’ The final clause seems to mean that the mind then acts on it.”

Uncertainty-marked

“Quiet/settle the mind and deliberate on it; examine/check it; measure/estimate it; use it as a mirror/warning. Hear reports, ask questions, look, and listen. In/among the 磨—perhaps ‘herd,’ ‘cluster,’ or ‘gathering’—of the good, the mind there/thereby acts for it.”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Quiet the heart and deliberate on it;
examine it, weigh it, take mirror by it.
Hear and question, look and listen.
If it is among the gathered herd of the good,
let the heart there act for it.

Factual anchors

- 寧心: “settle / quiet the heart-mind.”
- 謀之、稽之、度之、鑒之: a sequence of deliberating, checking, measuring, and using as a mirror or standard.

- 聞訊視聽: hearing, inquiry, seeing, and listening—multiple modes of taking in evidence.
- 善之麀: literally contains 麀, “deer/roe-deer”; here rendered as “gathered herd,” with uncertainty whether it means a cluster/company of good things or good people.
- 心焉為之: “the heart-mind there/thereupon does it” or “acts for it.”

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

Settle the heart and seek it out:
counsel it, check it, calculate it, compare it in the mirror;
hear and ask, look and listen.
Where goodness gathers—like a herd, perhaps—
there the heart is, and there it acts.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Anchor translation	Notes / uncertainty
寧心	settle / calm the heart	寧 = make peaceful, steady
謀之	deliberate on it / plan it	之 refers to the matter at hand, unspecified
稽之	examine / verify it	Can imply checking, investigating, consulting
度之	measure / estimate it	Weighing or calculating
鑒之	mirror it / take it as a model or warning	鑒 = mirror, inspect, reflect on
聞訊視聽	hear, inquire, look, listen	A compact sensory/investigative sequence
在善之麀	in/among the “麀” of goodness	麀 may mean a deer or herd/cluster; phrase is uncertain
心焉為之	the heart there acts / does it	焉 = there/in that; 為之 = does/acts for it

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic:

Calm the heart: devise it, search it, weigh its way;
Hold it to the mirror’s light by day.
Hear, question, look, and listen where you should;
The heart acts there—among the herd/deer? of good.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Calm the mind and deliberate on it;
examine it, measure it, take it as a mirror.
Hear and inquire, look and listen;
amid the cluster of what is good—
there the mind acts upon it.

Notes on uncertainty

- 寧心: “calm/settle the mind” or “with a settled mind.”
- 稽之、度之、鑒之: a sequence of reflective actions: “examine/check it,” “measure/assess it,” “mirror it / take warning from it.”
- 在善之麀: uncertain. 麀 literally refers to a kind of deer/roe-deer, but may function like 麀, “a herd, cluster, gathering.” Rendered here as “the cluster of what is good,” but this is not certain.
- 心焉為之: “the mind there acts/does it,” or “the mind thereby brings it about.”

Memory aids — not critical translations

Mnemonic rendering

Settle the mind: plan it, check it, weigh it, mirror it.

Hear, ask, see, listen.

Gather with the good; let the mind do the deed.

Alliterative version

Calmly consider, check, calculate, contemplate;

hear, question, watch, and weigh;

with the good gathered, the heart goes to work.

Short rhyme

Calm the mind and measure true,

Hear and look, then listen too;

Where the good are gathered near,

There the heart makes action clear.

Passage 8

Source text

斷命在天，苛疾在鬼，取命在人。人有天命，其亦有身命。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

The determining of life-allotment lies with Heaven; harsh illnesses lie with ghosts; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given allotment; he also has a bodily allotment of life.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The cutting off of life is in Heaven; harsh illness is in ghosts; the taking of life is in humans. Humans have Heaven's fate/life-allotment; they also have bodily fate/life.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
斷命	verbal phrase / topic	cutting off life; determining life-span	Could mean "deciding fate/life" or "ending life."
在天	locative predicate	lies with Heaven	在 = "is in / depends on / rests with."
苛疾	noun phrase / topic	harsh illness; severe disease	苛 = harsh, severe; 疾 = illness.
在鬼	locative predicate	lies with ghosts/spirits	鬼 may mean ghosts, spirits, or demonic agents.
取命	verbal phrase / topic	taking life	More active than 斷命: "to seize/take a life."
在人	locative predicate	lies with humans	Could imply human agency in killing or preserving life.
人	subject	human beings; people	General plural.
有	verb	have	—
天命	object	Heaven's mandate; heavenly life-allotment	Here likely "fate/life allotted by Heaven," not necessarily political "Mandate of Heaven."
其	adverb / connective	also; indeed; perhaps	Ambiguous: may be emphatic or modal.
亦	adverb	also	Reinforces addition.
有	verb	have	—
身命	object	bodily life; personal life-allotment	Literally "body-life"; exact sense uncertain.

Aligned gloss translation:

"Cutting off life lies with Heaven; severe illness lies with ghosts/spirits; taking life lies with human beings. Human beings have a Heaven-allotted life; they also have a bodily/personal life."

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

[The cutting off / deciding of life] lies with Heaven;
[harsh illnesses] lie with ghosts/spirits;
[the taking of life] lies with human beings.

Human beings have [a Heaven-allotted life/fate];
they also have [a bodily / personal life-fate].

Syntax map:

- 斷命在天 / 苛疾在鬼 / 取命在人: three parallel clauses, [subject/process] + 在 + [agent/location of control].

- 人有天命，其亦有身命: 人 + 有 + object; second clause parallels the first with 其亦有 + object (“they/one also has ...”).

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

The cutting off of life lies with Heaven; severe illness lies with ghosts; the taking of life lies with humans. A person has a Heaven-given fate/life; he also has a bodily/personal life.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The determining of one's life-span lies with Heaven; grievous illness lies with ghosts; the taking of life lies with human beings. Human beings have a Heaven-given fate; they also have a fate belonging to the body/self.

Glossary

- 斷命: “to determine life,” likely the fixing or cutting short of one's life-span.
- 天: Heaven; the impersonal or cosmic authority governing fate.
- 苛疾: severe, harsh, or grievous illness.
- 鬼: ghosts or spirits, here associated with illness.
- 取命: to take life; to kill or cause death.
- 天命: Heaven's mandate/allotment; fate assigned by Heaven.
- 身命: literally “body-life” or “self-life”; here rendered cautiously as “a fate belonging to the body/self.”

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

The severing of life rests with Heaven; harsh illness rests with ghosts; the taking of life rests with human beings. A person has a Heaven-allotted life, and also has a life of the body.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The cutting off of life is in Heaven's hands; harsh illness is in the hands of ghosts or spirits; the taking of life is in human hands. A person has a Heaven-allotted life, but also has a life bound to the body or self.

Anchor notes

1. 斷命 — rendered as “the cutting off of life,” i.e. death or the ending of one's allotted life.
2. 在天 — “is in Heaven's hands”; Heaven may mean fate, cosmic order, or a divine power.
3. 苛疾 — “harsh illness,” taking 苛 as severe, cruel, or oppressive.
4. 在鬼 — “in the hands of ghosts or spirits”; 鬼 could mean ghosts, spirits, or demonic forces.
5. 取命 — “the taking of life,” suggesting killing or causing death.
6. 在人 — “is in human hands,” meaning that humans can be agents in taking life.
7. 人有天命 — “A person has a Heaven-allotted life,” with 天命 as fate, destiny, or life assigned by Heaven.
8. 其亦有身命 — “but also has a life bound to the body or self”; 身命 is uncertain, possibly “bodily life,” “personal life,” or “one's own mortal existence.”

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

The cutting off of life lies with Heaven.

Severe illness lies with ghosts.

The taking of life lies with human beings.

A human being has a Heaven-given life or fate.

A human being also has a body-given life or fate.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim: “The determining/cutting off of life is in Heaven; harsh afflictions/illnesses are in ghosts; the taking of life is in human beings.”
- Agency: The passage assigns different kinds of power over life to Heaven, ghosts/spirits, and humans respectively.
- Causal relation: A person’s death or suffering may be attributed differently: fate/lifespan to Heaven, severe disease to ghosts, and killing or direct loss of life to human action.
- Uncertainty: 「斷命」 may mean “determine one’s allotted life” or “cut life short”; 「苛疾」 is uncertain but likely “severe/cruel illness”; 「身命」 may mean “bodily life,” “personal life,” or “life belonging to the self.”
- Interpretive risk: “People have a Heaven-given fate/lifespan; they also have a bodily/personal life.” The contrast between 「天命」 and 「身命」 is important but not fully explicit in the passage.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

The ending of life is decided by Heaven (Tian, a higher cosmic power).

Harsh illness comes from ghosts (spirits).

The taking of life lies with human beings.

A person has a Heaven-given life or fate.

They also have a bodily life, or a life of their own.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

“The cutting off/determining of life is in Heaven; severe illnesses are in ghosts/spirits; the taking of life is in human beings. A person has a Heaven-given life/fate; he also has a bodily life/fate.”

Grammar notes

1. 斷命 can mean “to cut off life” or “to determine life/fate.” The phrase is ambiguous: it may refer to Heaven deciding lifespan, or Heaven ending life.
2. 在天: literally “is in Heaven,” meaning “rests with Heaven,” “depends on Heaven,” or “lies in Heaven’s power.”
3. The first three clauses are parallel: 斷命在天，苛疾在鬼，取命在人 — “X is in Y.”
4. 苛疾: likely “severe/harsh illness” or “grievous disease.” 苛 intensifies the unpleasantness or severity.
5. 在鬼: literally “is in ghosts.” This may mean that certain illnesses are attributed to ghosts/spirits, but the exact force is left uncertain.

6. 取命: literally “to take life.” In contrast with 斷命, it suggests active killing or taking someone’s life.
7. 在人: “lies with humans / is in human beings,” implying human agency in taking life.
8. 人有天命: “A person has 天命.” 天命 may mean “Heaven’s mandate,” “Heaven-given destiny,” or “allotted lifespan.”
9. 其亦有身命: 其 may be an emphatic/modal particle, something like “indeed” or “surely,” rather than simply “his.”
10. 身命: literally “body-life” or “bodily fate/life.” It contrasts with 天命, suggesting a life/fate associated with one’s embodied existence.

Mini vocabulary

- 斷 — to cut off; decide; determine
- 命 — life; fate; mandate; lifespan
- 天 — Heaven; the heavens; natural or divine order
- 苛疾 — severe illness; harsh disease
- 鬼 — ghost; spirit
- 取 — to take; seize; obtain
- 人 — human being; person; people
- 天命 — Heaven’s mandate; Heaven-given fate/life
- 其 — his/her/its; also sometimes an emphatic or modal particle
- 身命 — bodily life; embodied fate/life

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The cutting off/determining of life lies with Heaven; harsh illnesses lie with ghosts/spirits; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate/lifespan, and also has a bodily/personal life.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
天 “Heaven”	Cosmological agent / abstract power	The locus or agent of “cutting off/determining life” and source of 天命	High
鬼 “ghosts/spirits”	Spiritual beings	Associated with 苛疾, “harsh/severe illnesses”	Medium-High
人 “human beings / a person”	Human category	Humans may “take life”; an individual also possesses both 天命 and 身命	High
命 “life / fate / lifespan”	Abstract concept	Central object: can be determined, taken, or possessed	High
斷命 “cutting off/determining life”	Abstract action/concept	Said to be “in Heaven”	Medium
苛疾 “harsh/severe illness”	Abstract condition	Said to be “in ghosts/spirits,” i.e. attributed to them	Medium
取命 “taking life”	Abstract action	Said to be “in human beings,” i.e. carried out by humans	High
天命 “Heaven-given fate / heavenly lifespan”	Abstract concept	One kind of 命 that a person has	High
身命 “bodily/personal life”	Abstract concept	Another kind of 命 that a person has; exact nuance uncertain	Medium

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 斷命在天

- “The cutting off of life rests with Heaven.”
- “The determining of one’s lifespan rests with Heaven.”
- “Judgment over fate lies in Heaven.”

2. 苛疾在鬼

- “Severe illnesses rest with ghosts/spirits.”
- “Cruel afflictions are in the power of ghosts.”
- “Tormenting disease comes from demons/spirits.”

3. 取命在人

- “The taking of life rests with human beings.”
- “To seize a life is within human power.”
- “The claiming of life depends on people.”

4. 人有天命，其亦有身命

- “People have a Heaven-given fate, and they also have a bodily fate.”
- “A person has Heaven’s mandate for life, yet also has the life of the body.”
- “Human beings have a destiny from Heaven; they also have a personal/lived destiny.”

Translation A

The cutting off of life lies with Heaven; cruel illness lies with ghosts; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate, and also has a bodily fate.

Translation B

The determining of one’s lifespan is in Heaven’s hands; grievous disease is in the hands of spirits; the seizing of life is in human hands. Human beings have a destiny from Heaven, but they also have a destiny bound to the body.

Translation C

Judgment over life and death rests with Heaven; tormenting afflictions rest with ghosts; killing rests with people. A person possesses Heaven’s mandate for life, and likewise possesses a life that belongs to the body.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

1. 斷命在天，苛疾在鬼，取命在人。

“The determining of life and death rests with Heaven; severe illness rests with ghosts; the taking of life rests with human beings.”

Confidence: 73/100.

Reason: The broad parallel structure is clear: “X is in/with Y.” However, 斷命, 苛疾, and 取命 each allow more than one interpretation, especially whether they refer to fate, illness, or acts of killing.

2. 人有天命，其亦有身命。

“A person has a Heaven-given life-destiny; one also has a bodily life-destiny.”

Confidence: 70/100.

Reason: 天命 is relatively secure as “Heaven’s mandate/fate/life allotment,” but 身命 is less certain: it may mean “bodily life,” “one’s own life,” or a distinct personal/physical allotment of life.

Top 5 Risk Phrases and Alternatives

1. 斷命

- Main rendering: “determining of life and death”
- Alternatives: “cutting off life,” “deciding one’s lifespan,” “ending life,” “death’s allotment”

2. 在天

- Main rendering: “rests with Heaven”
- Alternatives: “lies in Heaven,” “is determined by Heaven,” “belongs to Heaven”

3. 苛疾

- Main rendering: “severe illness”
- Alternatives: “harsh affliction,” “cruel disease,” “grievous sickness,” “tormenting illness”

4. 取命

- Main rendering: “taking of life”
- Alternatives: “seizing life,” “killing,” “causing death,” “depriving someone of life”

5. 身命

- Main rendering: “bodily life-destiny”
- Alternatives: “one’s own life,” “physical life,” “life of the body,” “personal lifespan”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 命

- Alternatives: “life,” “lifespan,” “fate,” “allotment,” “mandate.”
- Choice: translate flexibly as “life-allotment” or “life”, because the passage contrasts different agencies over human existence: Heaven, ghosts/spirits, and people.

2. 斷命在天

- Alternatives: “cutting off life lies with Heaven,” “determining life lies with Heaven,” “the decision over lifespan rests with Heaven.”
- Choice: “The determining of life’s allotment lies with Heaven.”
- Justification: 斷 can mean “cut off” or “decide/judge.” In this context, paired with 天命 below, “determine” better preserves the sense of fate or allotted lifespan.

3. 苛疾在鬼

- Alternatives: “severe illnesses lie with ghosts,” “cruel diseases are caused by ghosts,” “harsh afflictions rest with spirits.”
- Choice: “Severe afflictions lie with ghosts/spirits.”
- Justification: 苛疾 suggests harsh or severe illness; 鬼 may mean ghosts, spirits, or demonic agencies. The exact force is uncertain, so “ghosts/spirits” keeps the ambiguity visible.

4. 取命在人

- Alternatives: “taking life lies with people,” “the seizing of life rests with humans,” “killing is in human hands.”
- Choice: “The taking of life lies with human beings.”
- Justification: 取命 most directly suggests taking someone’s life; 人 contrasts with 天 and 鬼 as another agent.

5. 人有天命，其亦有身命

- Alternatives: “People have a Heaven-given fate; they also have bodily life,” “A person has Heaven’s mandate, but also a personal life-allotment,” “Humans have heavenly destiny; they also have bodily destiny.”
- Choice: “Human beings have a Heaven-given life-allotment; they also have a life-allotment of the body/self.”

- Justification: 身命 is not entirely transparent here. It may mean bodily life, personal life, or one's own allotted life as distinct from 天命. "body/self" preserves the uncertainty.

Final translation

The determining of life's allotment lies with Heaven; severe afflictions lie with ghosts/spirits; the taking of life lies with human beings. Human beings have a Heaven-given life-allotment; they also have a life-allotment of the body/self.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation:

"Whether life is cut short lies with Heaven; grievous illness lies with ghosts; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate, but also has a fate belonging to the body itself."

Sceptical alternative translation:

"Judging life-span is a matter of Heaven; harsh diseases are a matter of ghosts; seizing life is a matter of people. Human beings have a heavenly allotment of life, yet they also have their own embodied allotment."

Where this diverges / why:

- 斷命 may mean "cutting off life," but it could also mean "deciding/fixing life-span." I therefore render it differently in the alternative as "judging life-span."
- 苛疾 is uncertain: "grievous illness," "harsh disease," or possibly "tormenting sickness."
- 取命 literally suggests "taking life," but could be read more broadly as "seizing" or "appropriating life." It is unclear whether the phrase means killing by humans or human agency over life.
- 天命 / 身命 are difficult: 天命 may be "Heaven's command," "fate," or "allotted life"; 身命 may mean "bodily life," "one's own life," or a distinct "embodied fate."

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

The severing or determining of life lies with Heaven; harsh illness lies with ghosts/spirits; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given life-destiny, and also has a bodily life-destiny.

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

命之斷定在天；苛酷之疾在鬼神；奪命在人。人有天所命之命，亦有身體之命。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 斷命 is uncertain: it may mean "cutting off life," "determining life-span," or "deciding fate." I rendered it as "severing or determining of life."
- 鬼 is literally "ghosts"; "spirits" is an interpretive broadening.
- 取命 is rendered as "taking of life," which may imply killing; the phrase could also carry a more general sense of "seizing life."
- 天命 may mean "Heaven's mandate," "Heaven-allotted fate," or "life-destiny from Heaven." I chose "Heaven-given life-destiny."
- 身命 is not fully transparent; "bodily life-destiny" is literal but may not capture the intended contrast with 天命.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The cutting off of life rests with Heaven; harsh illnesses rest with ghosts; the taking of life rests with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given life-span; surely he also has a body-bound life.”

Uncertainty notes

- 斷命: translated as “cutting off of life,” but it could also mean “deciding one’s allotted life-span” rather than actively ending life.
- 苛疾: rendered “harsh illnesses.” The phrase may mean severe, cruel, or oppressive disease; the exact nuance of 苛 is uncertain.
- 在鬼: translated literally as “rests with ghosts.” This may imply demonic/spirit-caused illness, but the text itself only says “with ghosts.”
- 取命: translated as “taking of life.” It could mean “taking away life,” i.e. killing, but 取 can also mean “obtain” or “seize,” so some ambiguity remains.
- 身命: rendered “body-bound life.” This is uncertain: it may mean bodily life, one’s own life, or life as governed by the physical body, in contrast to 天命, “Heaven’s mandate/allotted life-span.”

Red-team alternative

“Life’s allotment is determined by Heaven; grievous sickness is determined by ghosts; the seizing of life is determined by humans. Human beings have a heavenly destiny, and they also have a personal bodily destiny.”

Back-translation audit

- “The cutting off of life rests with Heaven” ≈ 斷命在天
 - Preserves 斷命 and 在天, though “rests with” interprets 在 as causal/responsibility.
- “harsh illnesses rest with ghosts” ≈ 苛疾在鬼
 - Preserves the literal structure, though “ghosts” may understate or overstate the role of spirits.
- “the taking of life rests with human beings” ≈ 取命在人
 - Keeps the parallel phrasing, but 取命 remains ambiguous between taking away life and obtaining/seizing life.
- “A person has a Heaven-given life-span” ≈ 人有天命
 - Interprets 天命 as allotted life-span rather than mandate or destiny.
- “surely he also has a body-bound life” ≈ 其亦有身命
 - 其亦 is represented by “surely ... also,” but the force of 其 may be weaker, closer to “also” or “perhaps.”

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The cutting off of life is with Heaven.

Cruel illness is with ghosts.

Taking life is with humans.

A person has a Heaven-allotted life;

he also has a body’s own life.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

The cutting short of life rests with Heaven; cruel illnesses rest with ghosts; the taking of life rests with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate, and also has a life/fate bound up with the body.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Chinese unit	Possible readings	Notes
斷命	"to determine/fix one's life-span"; "to cut off life"; "to judge fate"	斷 can mean decide/judge or sever/cut off. 命 can be life, allotted span, fate.
在天	"rests with Heaven"; "is in Heaven's hands"; "depends on Heaven"	在 marks locus/responsibility/causal source.
苛疾	"severe illness"; "harsh affliction"; "cruel disease"	苛 suggests severity or harshness; 疾 is illness/affliction.
在鬼	"rests with ghosts/spirits"; "comes from spirits"; "is in the hands of ghosts"	鬼 may be ghosts, spirits, demons, or the dead.
取命	"to take life"; "to seize life"; "to obtain/preserve life"	取 can mean take, seize, obtain. The phrase may point either to killing or to securing life.
在人	"rests with human beings"; "depends on people"; "is in human hands"	Could refer to other people or to oneself/human agency generally.
人有天命	"humans have a Heaven-given fate"; "people have a heavenly allotment"; "a person has Heaven's command/decreed"	天命 can mean Heaven's mandate, decree, destiny, or allotted life.
其亦有身命	"they also have a bodily/personal life"; "surely there is also a fate of the body/self"; "one also has one's own embodied allotment"	其 may be pronominal "they/one" or modal "surely/perhaps." 身命 may mean bodily life, personal life, or life belonging to oneself.

Translation 1: fate, spirits, and human agency

> The determining of life rests with Heaven; severe illness rests with spirits; the taking of life rests with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate, but also has a bodily life of his own.

Translation 2: allotted life-span and preservation of life

> To fix the span of life lies with Heaven; cruel sickness lies with ghosts; to secure life lies with people themselves. Human beings have a heavenly allotment, yet they also have an allotment bound to the body.

Translation 3: death as cut off by Heaven, disease from ghosts, killing by humans

> The cutting off of life is in Heaven's hands; harsh diseases are in the hands of ghosts; the taking of life is in human hands. People have a destiny from Heaven; they also have a life belonging to the body.

Translation 4: more literal, retaining the compact structure

> Deciding life is with Heaven; grievous illness is with ghosts; taking life is with humans. Humans have Heaven's mandate/fate; they also have bodily fate/life.

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

"Life's allotted span is determined by Heaven; grievous illness lies with ghosts; the taking of life lies with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate; he also has a life bound to his own body."

Notes:

- 斷命 may mean "to determine life/fate" or "to cut off life"; here rendered as the fixing of one's allotted span.
- 苛疾 is taken as "grievous/severe illness."
- 取命在人 suggests that human beings can "take life," i.e. cause death by human action.

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Literal

"Cutting off life is with Heaven; harsh illnesses are with ghosts; taking life is with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given life/fate; he also has a bodily/personal life."

Scholarly

“The determination of one’s lifespan rests with Heaven; grievous disease is attributed to ghosts; the taking of life rests with human agency. Human beings possess a heavenly allotment of life, but they also possess a life bound to the body itself.”

Plain-language

“How long someone lives is up to Heaven; terrible sickness comes from spirits; killing is done by people. A person has a fate from Heaven, but also a life that belongs to their own body.”

Sceptical

“Life is said to be ended by Heaven, severe illness blamed on ghosts, and killing assigned to humans. People are said to have a ‘Heavenly fate,’ yet also some separate ‘bodily life.’”

Uncertainty-marked

“Whether life is ‘cut off’ or fixed lies with Heaven; severe or oppressive illness is placed under the power of ghosts; the taking of life lies with people. A human being has a Heaven-ordained ming—‘life,’ ‘fate,’ or ‘allotment’—and perhaps also a shenming, a ‘bodily life’ or ‘personal life.’”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The cutting off of life lies with Heaven;
cruel sickness lies with ghosts;
the taking of life lies with human beings.

A person has a Heaven-allotted life;
yet he also has a life bound to his own body.

Factual anchors

- 斷命: “to cut off / determine life,” ambiguous between fate’s limit and life’s end.
- 天: “Heaven,” the source of allotted destiny or life-span.
- 苛疾: severe, harsh, or tormenting illness.
- 鬼: “ghosts” or “spirits,” here linked to disease.
- 取命: “to take life,” suggesting killing or causing death by human action.
- 身命: literally “body-life” or “personal life,” distinct from 天命, “Heaven’s life-allotment / mandate.”

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation — rhythmic / alliterative

To cut off life rests with Heaven;
cruel sickness rests with ghosts;
to claim a life rests with humans.

A person has a Heaven-given life / fate;
surely, too, a body-bound life.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Anchor rendering	Note of uncertainty
斷命	cut off life / determine fate	Could mean “sever life” or “decide one’s allotted span.”
在天	rests with Heaven	天 may be “Heaven,” not necessarily a personal deity.
苛疾	cruel / harsh illness	苛 suggests severity or harshness.
在鬼	rests with ghosts	鬼 may mean ghosts, spirits, or demonic agents.
取命	claim / take a life	Strongly suggests killing or seizing life.
在人	rests with humans	Human agency.
天命	Heaven-given life / fate	命 can be life-span, fate, allotment, or mandate.
身命	body-bound life / personal life	Literally “body-life”; exact contrast with 天命 is somewhat uncertain.

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

Life’s severing rests in Heaven’s hand;
Harsh sickness lies in ghosts’ command.
To take a life is human deed;
Man has Heaven’s fate—and body’s seed.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Life’s allotment is decided by Heaven; cruel illnesses are with the ghosts; the taking of life is with human beings. A person has a Heaven-given fate/lifespan, and also has a bodily/personal life.”

Notes on uncertainty

- 斷命 may mean “to determine life/fate,” “to cut off life,” or “to decide one’s allotted lifespan.”
- 苛疾 is rendered as “cruel/severe illnesses”; 鬼 may mean “ghosts,” “spirits,” or illness-causing demons.
- 取命在人 literally suggests “taking life lies with people,” likely referring to humans causing death.
- 身命 is uncertain: “bodily life,” “personal life,” or “the life attached to one’s own body.”

Memory aid — mnemonic rendering, not a critical translation

“Heaven fixes fate; ghosts give grievous sickness; humans take lives.
One has Heaven’s life, and one’s own body-life too.”

Memory aid — alliterative version, not a critical translation

“Fate is fixed in Heaven; harsh hurts haunt from ghosts; life is lifted by living men.
Humans hold Heaven’s mandate, and also their own mortal matter.”

Memory aid — short rhyme, not a critical translation

“Heaven sets the span,
Ghosts bring sickness grim;
Humans kill a man—
Yet life still dwells in him.”

Passage 9

Source text

心厥為死，心厥為生。死生在天，其亦失在心。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind: through it one dies; the heart-mind: through it one lives. Death and life rest with Heaven, yet perhaps the fault also lies in the heart-mind.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart/mind's jue [reversal? collapse?] is death; the heart/mind's jue is life.
Death and life are in Heaven; perhaps the error/loss also lies in the heart/mind.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
心厥	subject phrase	"heart reversal/collapse"	厥 is uncertain here: it may mean a pathological "reversal," collapse, or crisis involving the heart.
為	predicate verb	is / becomes / amounts to	Links condition to outcome.
死	complement / outcome	death	
心厥	subject phrase	"heart reversal/collapse"	Repeated phrase; same uncertainty as above.
為	predicate verb	is / becomes / amounts to	
生	complement / outcome	life / survival	
死生	topic phrase	death and life	Paired opposites.
在	locative / dependent verb	lies in / depends on / is with	
天	object	Heaven / fate	Could imply cosmic allotment or destiny; not expanded beyond the text.
其	modal / connective particle	perhaps / indeed / also	Function uncertain; may soften or emphasize the following statement.
亦	adverb	also / likewise	
失	noun or verb	loss / error / failure	Could mean "what is lost," "the failing," or "the error."
在	locative / dependent verb	lies in / is in	
心	object	the heart / mind	心 can mean physical heart, mind, or heart-mind; here it echoes 心厥.

Aligned gloss translation:

心厥為死，心厥為生。

"When the heart suffers reversal/collapse, it is death; when the heart suffers reversal/collapse, it is life."

死生在天，其亦失在心。

"Death and life lie with Heaven; yet perhaps the loss/failing also lies in the heart."

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation:

"[The heart's jue 厥—collapse/reversal?] is death;
[the heart's jue 厥—collapse/reversal?] is life.

[Death and life] lie with Heaven;
perhaps [the failing/error] also lies in the heart.”

Syntax map:

- 心厥為死 / 心厥為生
 - parallel clauses: “heart + 厥” → “becomes/is death / becomes/is life”
- 死生在天
 - subject: 死生 “death and life”
 - predicate: 在天 “are in / depend on Heaven”
- 其亦失在心
 - 其亦: “perhaps also / it also”
 - 失: “loss, failure, error”
 - 在心: “is in the heart”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart: it makes for death;
the heart: it makes for life.
Death and life are in Heaven;
perhaps the fault, too, lies in the heart.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart-mind—therein is death;
the heart-mind—therein is life.
Death and life rest with Heaven;
yet perhaps failure, too, lies in the heart-mind.

Glossary

- 心 (xin): “heart-mind”; the seat of thought, intention, and affect.
- 厥 (jue): rendered here as “therein”; a difficult term in this context, possibly pronominal or emphatic.
- 死生 (si sheng): “death and life,” i.e. mortality and survival.
- 天 (tian): “Heaven”; an impersonal higher order or determining force.
- 失 (shi): “failure,” “loss,” or “error”; the precise sense is uncertain here.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind’s jue—its reversal or collapse—means death; the heart-mind’s jue also means life. Life and death lie with Heaven, yet the failing, too, is in the heart-mind.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

When the heart-mind collapses, it becomes death; when the heart-mind turns back, it becomes life. Life and death lie with Heaven — yet perhaps the failure, too, lies in the heart-mind.

Anchor notes

1. 心 → translated as “heart-mind”, since it can mean both the physical heart and the seat of thought, intention, or awareness.
2. 厥 → rendered with uncertainty as “collapses” / “turns back”; the term can suggest reversal, fainting, or a critical turning point.
3. 心厥為死 → paraphrased as “When the heart-mind collapses, it becomes death.”
4. 心厥為生 → paraphrased as “when the heart-mind turns back, it becomes life,” keeping the repetition while reflecting possible opposite outcomes.
5. 為死 / 為生 → translated as “becomes death / becomes life,” preserving the stark causal or transformative phrasing.
6. 死生在天 → translated as “Life and death lie with Heaven,” where 天 is left as “Heaven” rather than reduced to fate or nature.
7. 其亦 → rendered as “yet perhaps ... too,” preserving the tentative or reflective force.
8. 失在心 → translated as “the failure ... lies in the heart-mind,” though 失 could also mean error, loss, or fault.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

Heart jue 厥, meaning uncertain as “collapse” or “reversal,” is death.

Heart jue 厥, meaning uncertain as “collapse” or “reversal,” is life.

Death and life are in Heaven.

The loss or error may also be in the heart.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim: “The heart’s jue 厥 may become death; the heart’s jue may become life. Death and life rest with Heaven; perhaps the failing also lies in the heart.”
- Agency: “Heaven” is named as holding death and life, but the “heart” is also presented as a possible site of failure or responsibility.
- Causal relation: The passage links the condition/action called xin jue 心厥 to both death and life, while also suggesting that error, loss, or failure may arise “in the heart.”
- Uncertainty: Jue 厥 is ambiguous here: it may mean collapse, reversal, fainting, extremity, or “its/that,” so “heart’s jue” is left partly unresolved.
- Interpretive risk: Reading this as medical, moral, or metaphysical changes the sense: “heart” may mean physical heart, mind, or inner disposition, and “Heaven” may imply fate rather than a personal agent.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

The heart-mind (xin) can be death; the heart-mind can be life.

Death and life lie with Heaven (fate).

Yet the fault may also lie in the heart-mind.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Heart-jue may mean death; heart-jue may mean life. Death and life lie with Heaven; yet perhaps the failure, too, lies in the heart.”

Note: Jue 厥 is left partly untranslated because its sense is uncertain here: it may refer to a medical “collapse/reversal/syncope,” or more generally to a crisis or derangement of the heart/mind.

Grammar notes

1. 心厥: likely a compound, “heart-jue,” perhaps a disorder involving the heart/mind; alternatively 心 could be the subject and 厥 a functional/pronominal word, but the compound reading is more natural.
2. 為死 / 為生: 為 here means “be/become/result in/amount to.” Thus “is death” or “leads to death,” and “is life” or “leads to life.”
3. Repeated structure: 心厥為死, 心厥為生 uses parallel phrasing to stress that the same condition can turn toward death or life.
4. 死生: “death and life,” a binome often meaning “life-and-death outcome.”
5. 在天: literally “is in Heaven”; i.e. “depends on Heaven,” “rests with fate.” 天 may mean Heaven, fate, or a higher determining order.
6. 其: in 其亦失在心, 其 may be modal: “perhaps,” “surely,” “after all,” rather than a simple possessive.
7. 亦: “also,” “too,” suggesting that even if life and death are “in Heaven,” another factor is also involved.
8. 失: literally “loss,” “error,” “failure,” or “what goes wrong.” The precise sense is uncertain.
9. 在心: “is in the heart/mind” or “lies with the heart”; this mirrors 在天 and creates contrast between Heaven/fate and heart/mind.
10. Overall tension: the passage balances fate—死生在天—with internal causation or responsibility—失在心.

Mini vocabulary

- 心 — heart; mind; inner faculty.
- 厥 — collapse, reversal, fainting crisis; also sometimes a pronoun/function word; uncertain here.
- 為 — to be; to become; to result in.
- 死 — death; to die.
- 生 — life; to live; survival.
- 死生 — death and life; life-or-death outcome.
- 天 — Heaven; fate; natural/heavenly order.
- 其 — perhaps; surely; its/his/her, depending on context.
- 亦 — also; too.
- 失 — loss; failure; error; defect.

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“The heart/mind’s jue—its collapse or reversal—means death; the heart/mind’s jue also means life. Death and life are in Heaven’s hands; yet the fault or loss may also lie in the heart/mind.”

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Type	Role in passage	Confidence
心	abstract / bodily-spiritual concept	"Heart" or "mind"; the locus where jue occurs and where "fault/loss" may lie	High
厥	abstract / technical or ambiguous condition	Possibly "collapse," "reversal," "fainting," or a pronoun-like "its"; central ambiguous term linked to both death and life	Medium
死	abstract concept	Death; one possible outcome or meaning of 心厥	High
生	abstract concept	Life; one possible outcome or meaning of 心厥	High
死生	abstract concept	"Death and life," fate of existence	High
天	abstract / cosmological entity	"Heaven"; presented as where death and life reside or are determined	High
失	abstract concept	"Fault," "loss," "error," or "failure"; may also be located in the heart/mind	Medium

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

1. 心
 - "the heart" (the physical or vital organ)
 - "the mind" / "heart-mind"
 - "one's inward disposition" or "inner state"
2. 厥
 - "collapse/syncope/reversal" as a condition: "heart-collapse," "heart-reversal"
 - a pronoun-like element: "its," yielding "the heart, its making/being..."
 - an emphatic or connective particle, difficult to represent directly in English
3. 為死 / 為生
 - "is death / is life"
 - "becomes death / becomes life"
 - "brings about death / brings about life"
4. 其亦失在心
 - "yet the error/failure also lies in the heart"
 - "perhaps the loss, too, is in the mind"
 - "is it not also that what goes wrong lies in the heart?"

Translation A

When the heart is in reversal, it is death; when the heart is in reversal, it is life. Death and life lie with Heaven, yet the failure also lies in the heart.

Translation B

The mind's collapse becomes death; the mind's collapse becomes life. Life and death are in Heaven's hands, but perhaps what is lost is also in the mind.

Translation C

The heart is what makes for death; the heart is what makes for life. Death and life rest with Heaven, yet is it not also that the fault lies in the heart?

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

1. 心厥為死，心厥為生。

“When the heart/mind is jue—in collapse, reversal, or extremity—it may mean death; when the heart/mind is jue, it may mean life.”

Confidence: 55/100.

Reason: The phrase 心厥 is highly uncertain: 厥 may be a medical/pathological term like “collapse” or “reversal,” or it may function differently. The paired structure clearly contrasts death and life, but the exact mechanism is unclear.

2. 死生在天，其亦失在心。

“Death and life rest with Heaven; yet perhaps the fault, too, lies in the heart/mind.”

Confidence: 70/100.

Reason: 死生在天 is relatively clear: life and death are determined by Heaven/fate. The second clause is less certain because 其亦 may be modal or rhetorical, and 失在心 could mean “the error/failing lies in the mind,” “loss occurs in the heart,” or “it is lost through the heart/mind.”

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 心厥

- Main rendering: “the heart/mind is jue—in collapse, reversal, or extremity”
- Alternatives: “heart collapse,” “heart reversal,” “the mind goes awry,” “the heart is obstructed,” “its heart/mind”

2. 為死 / 為生

- Main rendering: “may mean death / may mean life”
- Alternatives: “becomes death / becomes life,” “results in death / results in life,” “is death / is life”

3. 死生在天

- Main rendering: “Death and life rest with Heaven”
- Alternatives: “Life and death are determined by Heaven,” “Death and life lie with fate,” “Whether one lives or dies is in Heaven’s hands”

4. 其亦

- Main rendering: “yet perhaps also”
- Alternatives: “is it not also,” “it too,” “perhaps likewise,” “surely also”

5. 失在心

- Main rendering: “the fault lies in the heart/mind”
- Alternatives: “the error is in the mind,” “the loss occurs in the heart,” “the failing lies with the heart,” “it is lost through the mind”

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 心

- “heart”: the literal organ, especially if the passage is read medically.
- “heart-mind”: the broader Classical Chinese sense of 心 as both emotional/cognitive center and heart.
- I use “heart-mind” in the main translation to keep both possibilities open.

2. 厥

- Could mean “collapse,” “reversal,” “syncope/fainting”, especially in a medical register.

- Could also function pronominally or adverbially in some Classical contexts, but here 心厥 reads most naturally as a compound: “heart-collapse” or “collapse of the heart.”
- I translate it as “collapse of the heart-mind”, while noting the uncertainty.

3. 為

- Can mean “is,” “becomes,” “amounts to,” “results in.”
- In the paired lines, it may mean either “is death/life” or “brings about death/life.”
- I render it as “may be death / may be life” to preserve the stark ambiguity.

4. 死生在天

- Literally: “Death and life are in Heaven.”
- Meaning: life and death are determined by Heaven/fate.
- I translate “Death and life lie with Heaven.”

5. 其亦失在心

- 其 may be modal: “perhaps,” “after all,” “indeed.”
- 失 can mean “loss,” “failure,” “error,” “fault.”
- 在心 may mean “lies in the heart” or “lies in the mind/intention.”
- I translate: “yet perhaps the failing also lies in the heart-mind.”

Final translation

The collapse of the heart-mind may be death; the collapse of the heart-mind may be life. Death and life lie with Heaven; yet perhaps the failing also lies in the heart-mind.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation (cautious):

“When the heart-mind collapses, it means death; when the heart-mind collapses, it can also mean life. Death and life rest with Heaven; yet the failure, perhaps, also lies in the heart-mind.”

Deliberately sceptical alternative:

“Heart-collapse may become death; heart-collapse may become life. Life and death are in Heaven’s hands, but the loss may also be in the heart.”

Where the alternative diverges and why:

- 心 is rendered as “heart-mind” in the first version, but simply “heart” in the alternative. The word can refer to the physical heart, the mind, intention, or inner disposition; the passage does not make the sense certain.
- 厥 is tentatively translated as “collapses” / “collapse.” This is uncertain: it may suggest fainting, reversal, failure, or a critical disturbance. The alternative keeps it more literal and awkward as “heart-collapse.”
- 為死 / 為生 could mean “means death / means life,” “becomes death / becomes life,” or “brings about death / brings about life.” The alternative uses “may become” to avoid over-deciding the causal force.
- 其亦失在心 is especially uncertain. 其 may be modal, like “perhaps” or “surely”; 失 may mean “loss,” “failure,” “error,” or “what goes wrong.” Thus the line could mean either that the decisive failure lies in the heart, or more cautiously that it may lie there despite life and death being “in Heaven.”

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

When the heart/mind is overturned, it becomes death;
when the heart/mind is overturned, it becomes life.
Death and life lie with Heaven;
yet perhaps the failure, too, lies in the heart/mind.

Back-translation into Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

心厥，乃為死；
心厥，乃為生。
死生在天；
其亦過失在心。

Mismatches / possible drift

- 心 is rendered as “heart/mind,” since it can mean both emotional heart and thinking mind.
- 厥 is uncertain: translated as “is overturned,” but it might also be read more weakly as “its/that” or as a condition of collapse/reversal.
- 為死 / 為生 is translated as “becomes death / becomes life,” preserving the literal “be/become,” though it could also mean “results in death/life.”
- 其亦 is rendered as “yet perhaps ... too,” taking 其 as a modal/softening particle; this is uncertain.
- 失 is translated as “failure,” but it may also mean “fault,” “loss,” or “error.”

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Heart-collapse may be death; heart-collapse may be life. Death and life lie with Heaven; yet the failing, too, may lie in the heart.”

Uncertainty notes

- 心 can mean either the physical heart or the mind/heart-mind. The passage does not make clear whether it is medical, moral, or philosophical.
- 厥 is difficult here. It may mean a kind of collapse, reversal, fainting, or crisis, especially if read medically. I have rendered it as “collapse,” but this is uncertain.
- The repeated phrase 心厥為死，心厥為生 is deliberately paradoxical or contrastive: the same condition/event is said to be “death” and “life.” It may mean that the heart’s crisis can result in either death or survival.
- 其亦失在心 is ambiguous. 失 may be “loss,” “failure,” “error,” or “that which goes wrong.” 其亦 may mean “perhaps also,” “surely also,” or “it too.”

Red-team alternative

“When the heart-mind turns away, it becomes death; when the heart-mind turns back, it becomes life. Life and death are in Heaven, but the error is also in the heart-mind.”

Back-translation audit

Proposed translation back into Classical-style wording:

“心厥或為死，心厥或為生。死生在天，而其失亦在心。”

This preserves the main structure of the source, though the added “或” in the back-translation makes explicit the implied “may be/either,” which is not overt in the original.

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Heart-jué [collapse/reversal] becomes death;
heart-jué becomes life.
Death and life are in Heaven.
Yet the failure, too, lies in the heart.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

When the heart-mind collapses, it is death; when the heart-mind [holds], it is life. Death and life rest with Heaven, yet perhaps the loss also lies in the heart-mind.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Chinese element	Possible readings
心	"heart" (organ); "mind/heart" (seat of intention or feeling)
厥	a medical/pathological "collapse, reversal, syncope"; or pronominal/demonstrative "its/that"; less certainly "to be exhausted/blocked"
心厥	"heart-collapse / cardiac syncope"; "collapse of the heart"; possibly "the mind/heart, in that condition"
為死 / 為生	"becomes death / becomes life"; "counts as death / counts as life"; "leads to death / leads to life"
死生在天	"death and life rest with Heaven"; "life and death are in fate"; "survival and death are determined by Heaven"
其	"perhaps / surely / after all"; or pronoun "its/one's"
亦	"also"; "even so"; "nevertheless"
失	"loss"; "failure"; "error"; "fault"
在心	"lies in the heart"; "lies in the mind"; "depends on the heart/mind"

Translation 1 — medical "heart-collapse," outcome uncertain

Heart-collapse may become death; heart-collapse may become life. Death and life rest with Heaven, yet perhaps the failure also lies in the heart.

Translation 2 — "heart" as mind/inner state

When the heart is overturned, it becomes death; when the heart is overturned, it becomes life. Death and life are in Heaven, but the error, too, may lie in the mind.

Translation 3 — stronger fatalistic reading

Cardiac collapse is death; cardiac collapse is life. Life and death are determined by Heaven; still, its loss is also in the heart.

Translation 4 — "為" as "leads to"

A collapse of the heart leads to death; a collapse of the heart leads to life. Though death and life lie with Heaven, the failing may also be in the heart.

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

"The heart-mind—when it is in collapse/reversal, this is death; the heart-mind—[when it is otherwise restored?], this is life. Death and life rest with Heaven; yet perhaps the fault, too, lies in the heart-mind."

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Literal

“The heart’s jue is death; the heart’s jue is life. Death and life are in Heaven; perhaps the loss too is in the heart.”

Scholarly

“A crisis or reversal of the heart-mind may lead to death; a crisis or reversal of the heart-mind may also lead to life. Though life and death rest with Heaven, the failure may also lie within the heart-mind.”

Plain-language

“What happens in the heart can bring death, and what happens in the heart can bring life. Life and death are decided by Heaven, but the heart may also be where things go wrong.”

Sceptical

“The text first gives the heart responsibility for both death and life, then says life and death are Heaven’s affair—yet it still suggests that the heart may be at fault.”

Uncertainty-marked

“‘Heart-jue’—perhaps a collapse, reversal, or critical condition of the heart-mind—means death; ‘heart-jue’ also means life. Life and death are said to be in Heaven, but perhaps the error, loss, or failure is also in the heart-mind.”

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

The heart may turn—and that is death.

The heart may turn—and that is life.

Death and life rest with Heaven;

yet perhaps the losing of them, too, lies in the heart.

Factual anchors

- 心: “heart,” also “mind” or inner seat of feeling and intent.
- 厥: uncertain here; may suggest a “turning,” “reversal,” or collapse/fainting, but could also function pronominally.
- 死生在天: “death and life are in Heaven,” i.e. under Heaven’s allotment or fate.
- 失在心: literally, “the loss/failing is in the heart.”

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

Heart’s halt may be death;

heart’s halt may be life.

Death and life lie in Heaven—

yet the failing, too, is in the heart.

Factual anchors

Chinese	Literal range	Rendering here
心	heart; mind	“heart”
厥	reversal; collapse; fainting/cessation-like state; also uncertain in force here	“halt”
為死 / 為生	becomes/is death; becomes/is life	“may be death / may be life”
死生在天	death and life are in Heaven	“Death and life lie in Heaven”

Chinese	Literal range	Rendering here
其亦失在 心	perhaps/also the loss, fault, or failing is in the heart	"yet the failing, too, is in the heart"

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

Heart's collapse—perhaps to death,
Heart's collapse—perhaps to breath.
Death and life are Heaven's part;
Yet the loss may lie in heart.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

"The heart/mind: through it there is death; the heart/mind: through it there is life. Death and life rest with Heaven; yet the fault or loss, perhaps, also lies in the heart/mind."

Notes on uncertainty

- 心 can mean both "heart" and "mind"; here either or both may be intended.
- 厥 is difficult here. I have read it as roughly "thereby / through it," but it could also be taken more literally as "its" or "that."
- 失 may mean "loss," "error," "failure," or "fault."

Memory aid — mnemonic rendering, not a critical translation

"Mind makes death; mind makes life. Heaven holds fate, but the heart may fail."

Memory aid — alliterative version, not a critical translation

"Heart brings harm; heart brings health. Heaven holds life and death, yet failing falls within the heart."

Memory aid — short rhyme, not a critical translation

"Heart may deal out death or breath;
Heaven holds both life and death;
Yet loss may start within the heart."

Passage 10

Source text

君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民，其毋獨祈保家沒身於鬼與天，其亦祈諸[心]與身。

Focal Scholarly Translation (focal)

Profile: classical_chinese_focal_scholarly | Model: gpt-5.5

Let rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people not pray only to spirits and Heaven for the preservation of their households to the end of their lives; let them also seek it from their [mind/heart] and body.

Diplomatic Literal

Profile: parallage_01_diplomatic_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, plain people: let them not only pray to preserve the household and [last] to the end of the body/life to ghosts and Heaven; let them also pray for these to/in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Interlinear Gloss

Profile: parallage_02_interlinear_gloss | Model: gpt-5.5

character or short phrase	function	gloss	notes
君	noun, listed subject	ruler; lord	One item in a social/status list.
公	noun, listed subject	duke; high lord	Title/rank term.
侯	noun, listed subject	marquis	Title/rank term.
王	noun, listed subject	king	Title/rank term.
庶人	noun, listed subject	commoner	Non-elite person.
平民	noun, listed subject	ordinary people	Near-synonymous with 庶人; “the common populace.”
其	modal particle / possibly resumptive	let them; they should	Exhortative or jussive force before 毋.
毋	negative modal	not; do not	Prohibitive: “should not.”
獨	adverb	only; merely	Limits the following action.
祈	verb	pray; seek	With 於鬼與天, “pray to / seek from ghosts and Heaven.”
保家	object/purpose phrase	preserving the household/family	What is prayed for or sought.
沒身	object/purpose phrase	to the end of life; for one’s whole life	Literally “until the body is gone/ended”; exact nuance uncertain.
於鬼與天	prepositional phrase	from/to ghosts and Heaven	於 after 祈 may mark the source/recipient of prayer.
其	modal particle	let them; they should	Repeated exhortative.
亦	adverb	also	Adds a second object/source of seeking.
祈	verb	pray; seek	Here perhaps less literal “pray,” more “seek,” because the following objects are mind/body.
諸	contraction	it in/from/to	Usually 之於: “it” + 於. Refers back to what is sought, likely protection/security.
[心]與身	object of 於 in 諸	[mind/heart] and body	[心] is bracketed in the source; treated as supplied or uncertain.

Aligned gloss translation:

“Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people—let them not merely pray/seek, for the preservation of the family and for life to its end, from ghosts and Heaven; let them also seek it in/from the [mind/heart] and the body.”

Syntax Scaffold

Profile: parallage_03_syntax_scaffold | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, lords, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people:

let them not only [pray to ghosts and Heaven for [the preservation of the household] and [the completion of life / the body's end]],

but let them also [seek/pray for these things in [the heart/mind] and the body].

Syntax map:

- 主題 Topic: 君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民 = “rulers, lords, marquises, kings, commoners, ordinary people”
- 其毋獨 A: “let them not only A”
 - A = 祈保家沒身於鬼與天 = “pray to ghosts and Heaven for preserving the household and ending/completing life”
- 其亦 B: “let them also B”
 - B = 祈諸[心]與身 = “seek/pray for them in/from [heart/mind] and body”

Minimal Inference

Profile: parallage_04_minimal_inference | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people: they should not only pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven to preserve their households and last to life's end; they should also seek/pray for this in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Scholarly Readable

Profile: parallage_05_scholarly_readable | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to ghosts and to Heaven that their households be preserved and that they may live out their lives; they should also seek this in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Glossary

- 君、公、侯、王 — rulers and titled nobles/kings; the sequence is translated literally by rank/title.
- 庶人、平民 — commoners, ordinary people.
- 毋獨 — “should not only,” “must not merely.”
- 祈 — to pray for; also possibly “to seek” or “to ask for” in a ritual or moral sense.
- 保家 — to preserve/protect the household or family.
- 沒身 — to the end of one's life; literally “until the body is gone.”
- 鬼與天 — ghosts/spirits and Heaven.
- [心]與身 — “[heart/mind] and body”; the brackets indicate that 心 is supplied or uncertain in the given text.

Smooth Idiomatic

Profile: parallage_06_smooth_idiomatic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to ghosts and Heaven to preserve their households and see them through life; they should also seek this in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Message Paraphrase

Profile: parallage_07_message_paraphrase | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Whether rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, or ordinary people: they should not only pray to spirits and Heaven to keep their households safe and preserve them through life. They should also seek this in their own [minds/hearts] and bodies.

Anchor notes

1. 君、公、侯、王 → “rulers, dukes, marquises, kings”; titles are kept broad, without adding a specific political setting.
2. 庶人、平民 → “commoners, or ordinary people”; the pair seems to broaden the scope beyond elites.
3. 其毋 → “they should not”; taken as a modal prohibition or exhortation.
4. 獨 → “only / solely”; the passage rejects reliance on one source alone.
5. 祈 → “pray” or “seek”; translated first as “pray,” then as “seek” where the object is inward rather than divine.
6. 保家 → “keep their households safe”; literally “protect/preserve the family/household.”
7. 沒身 → “through life”; uncertain nuance, likely “until the end of one’s life” rather than literal “bury the body.”
8. 鬼與天 → “spirits and Heaven”; 鬼 may mean ghosts/spirits, while 天 is rendered as “Heaven.”
9. 諸[心]與身 → “in their own [minds/hearts] and bodies”; [心] is bracketed in the source, so the translation preserves its uncertainty.

Controlled English

Profile: parallage_08_controlled_english | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not pray only to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of the household and for life until death.

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should also seek the preservation of the household and life until death from the [heart/mind] and the body.

Analyst Brief

Profile: parallage_09_analyst_brief | Model: gpt-5.5

- Main claim / translation: “Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not only pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven to protect their households and preserve them to life’s end; they should also seek/pray for this in the [heart-mind] and the body.”
- Agency: The named social groups are the ones who pray or seek protection. “Ghosts/spirits and Heaven” are addressed as external powers, while the “[heart-mind] and body” are also made into loci or means of seeking security.
- Causal relation: The passage suggests that safeguarding one’s household and life is not to depend solely on supernatural appeal; it also involves something internal or embodied.
- Uncertainty: 「其」 is read here as exhortative, “should/let them.” 「沒身」 may mean “to the end of one’s life” rather than “death” itself. 「諸[心]與身」 is uncertain: 「諸」 may compress “之於,” “it in/with regard to,” and 「[心]」 appears to be a supplied or uncertain character.
- Interpretive risk: It would be risky to read this as denying ghosts or Heaven; the text more clearly says “not only” pray to them, adding the heart-mind and body as further sites of concern or efficacy.

Plain Language

Profile: parallage_10_plain_language | Model: gpt-5.5

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not only pray to ghosts (spirits) and Heaven (the divine order) to protect their families until death. They should also seek this in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Learner's Translation

Profile: parallage_11_learners_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Close translation

"Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people: they should not merely pray to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their households and for safety to the end of life; they should also seek/pray for these things in their [hearts] and bodies."

Alternative nuance: "祈諸[心]與身" may mean "pray for it through/in the [heart] and the body," i.e. not only appeal outwardly to spirits and Heaven, but also turn inward to one's own mind/heart and bodily conduct.

Grammar notes

1. 君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民 is a list of social ranks or categories, ranging from high-status figures to ordinary people.
2. 其 before 毋 functions as a modal or exhortative marker: "let them...", "they should...", or "one should..."
3. 毋 is a negative imperative/prohibitive: "do not," "must not," "should not."
4. 獨 means "alone, only, merely." Thus 毋獨 = "do not only / should not merely."
5. 祈 means "pray," "petition," or more broadly "seek/desire." The object is somewhat compressed.
6. 保家 literally means "protect/preserve the household/family."
7. 沒身 literally "to the sinking/ending of the body"; idiomatically it can mean "to the end of one's life" or "until death." Here it likely refers to bodily/life security lasting through one's lifetime.
8. 於鬼與天 marks the beings or powers to whom prayer is directed: "to ghosts/spirits and Heaven."
9. The second 其 in 其亦祈... parallels the first and continues the exhortative sense: "they should also...."
10. 諸 is likely the contraction 之於, "it/them in/to/at." Thus 祈諸[心]與身 ≈ "pray/seek it in/with the [heart] and body."
11. [心] is bracketed in the source, so the reading is visibly uncertain or supplied; the translation keeps it as "[heart]."
12. 與 links paired terms: 鬼與天 = "ghosts/spirits and Heaven"; [心]與身 = "[heart] and body."

Mini vocabulary

- 君 — ruler; lord
- 公 — duke; high noble
- 侯 — marquis; noble rank
- 王 — king
- 庶人 — commoner
- 平民 — ordinary people; common folk
- 毋 — do not; should not
- 獨 — only; merely; alone
- 祈 — pray; petition; seek
- 保家 — preserve/protect the household
- 沒身 — to the end of life; until death
- 鬼 — ghosts; spirits
- 天 — Heaven
- 心 — heart; mind
- 身 — body; person; self

Named Entity Explicit

Profile: parallage_12_named_entity_explicit | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, the common people, and ordinary folk: let them not only pray to ghosts/spirits and to Heaven for the preservation of their households throughout their lives; let them also seek/pray for it in the [heart-mind] and in the body.”

Note: The bracketed [心] is treated as uncertain or supplied in the source.

Named entities and abstract concepts

Term	Translation	Role in passage	Confidence
君	ruler / lord	Social-political rank included among those addressed	High
公	duke / lord	Noble rank included among those addressed	High
侯	marquis	Noble rank included among those addressed	High
王	king	Royal rank included among those addressed	High
庶人	common people	Non-elite social group included among those addressed	High
平民	ordinary folk / commoners	Non-elite social group included among those addressed	High
鬼	ghosts / spirits	Supernatural beings to whom people pray	High
天	Heaven	Cosmic/divine power to whom people pray	High
家	household / family	Object to be preserved or protected	High
身	body / self / life	Human locus in which one should also seek/pray; also possibly involved in “throughout one’s life”	Medium
[心]	heart-mind / mind	Inner locus in which one should also seek/pray; bracketed and uncertain in the source	Medium
祈	praying / seeking	Main action: petitioning or seeking protection	High
保	preservation / protection	Desired outcome of prayer	High
沒身	to the end of one’s life / lifelong	Duration or extent of preservation; literally “until the body is gone”	Medium
毋獨	not only / do not merely	Restricts reliance on ghosts and Heaven alone	High

Forked Lattice

Profile: parallage_13_forked_lattice | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguous spans

- 君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民
 - “lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people”
 - “rulers, nobles, kings, and the common populace”
 - “prince, duke, marquis, king, the many people, and the plain folk”
- 其毋獨祈...其亦祈...
 - “they should not merely pray..., but should also pray...”
 - “let them not only seek..., let them also seek...”
 - “surely they must not pray only..., but also...”
- 保家沒身
 - “to preserve their households throughout their lives”
 - “to protect their families until death”
 - “to keep their houses secure and bring their own bodies to life’s end”
- 於鬼與天
 - “to ghosts/spirits and Heaven”

- “from spirits and Heaven”
- “through ghosts/spirits and Heaven”

5. 祈諸[心]與身

- “seek it in the heart and the body”
- “pray for it from their own mind/heart and person”
- “turn also to [the heart] and the body for it”

Note: [心] appears supplied or uncertain in the source.

Translation A

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to ghosts and Heaven to preserve their households throughout their lives; they should also seek this in their own [hearts] and bodies.

Translation B

Whether ruler, duke, marquis, king, commoner, or plain person, let none pray only to spirits and Heaven for the protection of family and for life to its end; let them also pray to—or seek from—their [heart] and body.

Translation C

Princes, nobles, kings, and the common folk must not simply appeal to ghosts and Heaven to keep their houses secure until death; they must also turn for this to the [heart] and the body.

Uncertainty Annotated

Profile: parallage_14_uncertainty_annotated | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

“Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, common people, and ordinary folk should not pray only to ghosts/spirits and Heaven for the protection of their households and for safety to the end of life; they should also seek/pray for it in their [mind/heart] and body.”

Sentence confidence: 78/100

Reasons:

- The overall structure is fairly clear: a list of social ranks/groups followed by a negative “not only...” clause and a balancing “also...” clause.
- 祈 ... 於鬼與天 is reasonably read as “pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven for...”.
- 其毋獨 ... 其亦 ... is likely exhortative: “they should not only...; they should also...”.
- Main uncertainty lies in 保家沒身, which could mean “protect the household and oneself,” “preserve the household to the end of life,” or “secure the family and life.”
- The bracketed [心] suggests textual uncertainty or supplementation, so “mind/heart” should remain visibly tentative.

Top 5 risk phrases and alternatives

1. 君、公、侯、王

- Chosen: “lords, dukes, marquises, kings”
- Alternatives: “ruler, duke, marquis, king”; “lords, high nobles, marquises, kings”
- Risk: The titles may not map neatly onto English ranks, and the order is unusual.

2. 庶人、平民

- Chosen: “common people, and ordinary folk”
- Alternatives: “commoners and common people”; “the masses and ordinary people”

- Risk: The two terms overlap; the distinction may be rhetorical rather than technical.

3. 其毋獨

- Chosen: “should not ... only”
- Alternatives: “let them not merely”; “one must not solely”
- Risk: 其 may be exhortative, predictive, or resumptive depending on context.

4. 保家沒身

- Chosen: “protection of their households and safety to the end of life”
- Alternatives: “preserving the family until death”; “protecting family and body/person”; “keeping the household secure throughout life”
- Risk: 沒身 literally “until the body is gone / to death,” but its relation to 保家 is ambiguous.

5. 祈諸[心]與身

- Chosen: “seek/pray for it in their [mind/heart] and body”
- Alternatives: “pray for these things from the [heart/mind] and body”; “look for it in one’s [heart/mind] and body”; “appeal also to [mind/heart] and body”
- Risk: 諸 may compress 之於 (“it in/to/from”), and bracketed [心] indicates uncertainty in the text.

Decision Log

Profile: parallage_15_decision_log | Model: gpt-5.5

Decision points and alternatives

1. 君、公、侯、王

- Options: “lords, dukes, marquises, kings” / “rulers, dukes, marquises, kings.”
- Decision: Use “lords, dukes, marquises, kings.”
- Justification: The passage lists social ranks or statuses broadly; “君” is left as “lord” rather than generalized to “ruler.”

2. 庶人、平民

- Options: “commoners, ordinary people” / “the multitude and the common people.”
- Decision: Use “commoners and ordinary people.”
- Justification: The two terms overlap; the translation preserves the duplication rather than collapsing them.

3. 其毋獨

- Options: “they must not only” / “let them not merely” / “they should not merely.”
- Decision: Use “let them not merely.”
- Justification: 其 can mark a hortatory or admonitory tone; 毋 is prohibitive.

4. 祈保家沒身於鬼與天

- Options:
 - “pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven to protect their households and preserve them to life’s end”
 - “pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven for the protection of their households and the completion of their lives”
- Decision: Use “pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven to protect their households and preserve them to life’s end.”
- Justification: 沒身 can mean “to the end of one’s life”; 保家 is “protect/preserve the household.” 鬼 is rendered as “ghosts/spirits” to preserve ambiguity.

5. 其亦祈諸[心]與身

- Options: “let them also seek it in the [heart/mind] and the body” / “let them also pray for it from the [heart/mind] and body.”

- Decision: Use “let them also seek it in the [heart/mind] and in the body.”
- Justification: 諸 may be read as 之於, “it in/at/from.” The bracketed [心] is preserved as supplied, indicating textual uncertainty or supplementation.

Final translation

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people: let them not merely pray to ghosts/spirits and Heaven to protect their households and preserve them to life's end; let them also seek it in the [heart/mind] and in the body.

Adversarial Red Team

Profile: parallage_16_adversarial_red_team | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, the many people and the common folk should not only pray to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their households and for safety to the end of life; they should also seek this in their own [minds/hearts] and bodies.

Sceptical alternative translation

Rulers, nobles, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people: let them not pray only to spirits and Heaven to protect their families and carry them through life; let them also pray for these things through the [heart-mind] and the body.

Points of divergence and uncertainty

- 君、公、侯、王: I render these as ranks or types of rulers, but the ordering is unusual. “Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings” is literal rather than historically systematised.
- 庶人、平民: These overlap; “commoners” and “ordinary people” preserves the duplication.
- 祈: Could mean strictly “pray,” especially with 鬼與天 (“ghosts/spirits and Heaven”), but in the second clause it may broaden to “seek” or “look for.”
- 保家沒身: Literally something like “preserve the household, to the end of the body/life.” I take 沒身 as “to the end of life,” but it could be read more awkwardly as “protect the family and the body unto death.”
- 諸[心]與身: 諸 likely compresses 之於, “it in/from/with.” The bracketed [心] is visibly uncertain or supplied in the text; therefore “mind/heart” should not be treated as fully secure.

Back Translation Audit

Profile: parallage_17_back_translation_audit | Model: gpt-5.5

English translation

“Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not pray only to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their households and for protection to the end of life; they should also pray/seek for these in the [heart/mind] and the body.”

Back-translation into a Classical-Chinese-like literal gloss

君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民，其毋但禱於鬼與天，以保其家、終其身；亦當祈求之於[心]與身。

Mismatches / possible drift

1. 沒身

- Translated as “to the end of life” / “protection to the end of life.”
- The phrase can more literally mean “until the body is gone,” “all one's life,” or “to die.” The English smooths this into an idiom.

2. 祈保家沒身

- I read this as “pray for preserving the household and lasting safely through life.”

- It could also be read more compressedly as “pray to preserve the household and the body/life,” depending on how 沒身 is taken.

3. 諸[心]與身

- 諸 is treated as “之於,” i.e. “for it/in them, in the [heart/mind] and body.”
- The exact force is uncertain; “pray to the [heart/mind] and body” is more literal but awkward in English.

4. [心]

- The brackets are preserved as uncertainty in the source. I rendered it as “[heart/mind]” to keep both the literal and conceptual possibilities visible.

5. 祈

- Rendered as “pray/seek” in the second clause because praying “to” one’s heart and body may imply inward seeking rather than ritual prayer. The original word remains the same in both clauses.

Audit Pack

Profile: parallage_audit_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not only pray to ghosts and Heaven to preserve their households and keep themselves safe until life’s end; they should also seek this in the [mind/heart] and in the body.

Uncertainty notes

- 其毋獨: rendered as “should not only.” The particle 其 may be exhortative: “let them / they should.”
- 祈保家沒身於鬼與天: literally something like “pray for preserving the household and ending/completing the body/life to ghosts and Heaven.”
- 沒身 usually suggests “to the end of one’s life” or “until death,” but its exact force here is not fully certain.
- 於鬼與天 is taken as the recipients of prayer: “to ghosts and Heaven.”
- 諸[心]與身: 諸 likely means “之於,” “for it in / from.” The bracketed [心] indicates textual uncertainty or editorial supplementation; I have translated it visibly as [mind/heart].
- 君、公、侯、王: translated as ranks/titles: “rulers, dukes, marquises, kings.” The order is unusual if treated as a strict hierarchy.

Red-team alternative

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, the many people, and the common folk: let them not merely pray to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their families and for safety through the whole span of life; let them also pray for it from the [heart/mind] and the body.

Back-translation audit

- “Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people” → 君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民
- “should not only” → 其毋獨
- “pray to ghosts and Heaven” → 祈……於鬼與天
- “to preserve their households” → 保家
- “keep themselves safe until life’s end” → interpretive rendering of 沒身
- “also seek this in the [mind/heart] and in the body” → 其亦祈諸[心]與身

Potential drift: the English “keep themselves safe” makes explicit a protective sense inferred from 保 and the context; 沒身 itself more literally means “to the end of the body/life” or “until death.”

Compact Literal

Profile: parallage_compact_literal | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, ordinary people: they should not only pray to ghosts and Heaven to preserve their households and end their lives safely. They should also pray for these in the [heart] and the body.

Idiomatic Reader

Profile: parallage_idiomatic_reader | Model: gpt-5.5

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to spirits and Heaven to preserve their households and keep them safe to the end of life; they should also seek this in their own [heart/mind] and body.

Lattice Pack

Profile: parallage_lattice_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Ambiguity lattice

Segment	Defensible readings
君、公、侯、王、庶人、平民	"lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, ordinary people"; broadly, people of every rank. The order is unusual, so the titles should probably be kept rather than normalized.
其母	Injunctive: "let them not," "they should not"; or softer exhortation: "may they not."
獨	"only," "merely," "alone."
祈	"pray," "supplicate"; also more generally "seek," "ask for."
保家	"preserve/protect the household/family"; possibly "preserve the house/lineage."
沒身	Usually "to the end of one's life," "lifelong"; more literally "until the body disappears/dies." Could attach to the action of praying/seeking, or to the desired preservation.
於鬼與天	"to spirits/ghosts and Heaven"; or "from spirits/ghosts and Heaven," depending on whether 祈 is read as praying to or seeking from.
其亦	"they should also," "let them also," "may they also."
祈諸[心]與身	If 諸 = 之於: "seek/pray for it in the heart/mind and the body." The bracketed [心] is visibly uncertain/supplied, so "heart/mind" should remain marked as uncertain. Alternatively: "pray also to the [heart/mind] and body," though this is less smooth.

Translation 1 — "pray to Heaven and spirits, but also seek within oneself"

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their households to the end of their lives; they should also seek it in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Translation 2 — taking 於 as "from"

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, the lower people, and the common folk: let them not seek only from ghosts and Heaven the protection of their families throughout life; let them also seek it from the [heart/mind] and the body.

Translation 3 — preserving a more literal "pray" throughout

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and plain people: may they not only pray, for the safeguarding of their houses and for life until death, to ghosts and to Heaven; may they also pray for these things in relation to the [heart/mind] and the body.

Translation 4 — with "house/lineage" and visible uncertainty

Whether lord, duke, marquis, king, commoner, or ordinary person, one should not merely supplicate ghosts and Heaven to keep one's house secure for one's whole life; one should also seek such security in one's own [heart/mind] and body.

Scholarly Edition

Profile: parallage_scholarly_edition | Model: gpt-5.5

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not only pray to ghosts and Heaven for the preservation of their households and for safety until life's end; they should also seek/pray for these things in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Spectrum Pack

Profile: parallage_spectrum_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Literal

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, ordinary people: they should not only pray to ghosts and Heaven to protect the household and carry the body to life's end; they should also pray for it in the [heart/mind] and the body.

Scholarly

Rulers, nobles, kings, and common people alike should not merely seek from spirits and Heaven the preservation of their families and their persons throughout life; they should also seek this in the [mind] and in the body.

Plain-language

Everyone—from kings and nobles to ordinary people—should not just ask spirits and Heaven to keep their family and themselves safe. They should also look to their own mind and body.

Sceptical

Whether high-born or low-born, people should not rely only on prayers to ghosts and Heaven for household security and lifelong safety; the matter must also be sought in the [mind] and the body.

Uncertainty-marked

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people: let them not merely pray to / through ghosts and Heaven for “protecting the family” and “ending the body” — perhaps meaning living safely to life's end — but let them also seek/pray for it in the [心], the heart-mind, and in the body.

Mnemonic Translation

Profile: parallage_18_mnemonic_translation | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Let lord, duke, marquis, king, commoner, and plain folk not pray only to ghosts and to Heaven to keep their houses safe until life's end. Let them also seek it in the [heart/mind] and in the body.

Factual anchors

Anchor	What the text says
People named	君, 公, 侯, 王, 庶人, 平民 — lord/ruler, duke, marquis, king, commoner, ordinary people
Warning	毋獨 — “do not only...”
Prayer directed to	鬼與天 — ghosts/spirits and Heaven
What is prayed for	保家沒身 — preserving/protecting the household through the end of one's life
Added inward turn	亦祈諸[心]與身 — “also seek/pray for it in the [heart/mind] and body”

| Uncertainty | [心] is bracketed in the source, so its status is visibly uncertain/supplied.

Alliterative Mnemonic

Profile: parallage_19_alliterative_mnemonic | Model: gpt-5.5

Rhythmic translation

Lords, dukes, marquises, kings—
common folk and plain people:

let them not only pray to ghosts and Heaven
to guard the home and keep them to life's end;
let them also seek it
in the [heart / mind] and in the body.

Factual anchors

Source phrase	Anchored meaning
君、公、侯、王	"lords, dukes, marquises, kings"
庶人、平民	"common folk and plain people"
毋獨	"not only / not merely"
祈保家沒身	"pray to protect the household and preserve oneself to life's end"
鬼與天	"ghosts/spirits and Heaven"
亦祈諸[心]與身	"also seek/pray for it in the [heart/mind] and the body"
[心]	Bracketed in the source; rendered visibly as uncertain or supplied "heart/mind."

Rhyming Poetry

Profile: parallage_20_rhyming_poetry | Model: gpt-5.5

Poetic translation:

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, and common people all,
Pray not to ghosts and Heaven alone to keep house and life from fall;
For home and self till death, seek also from within—
From the [heart/mind?] and from the body, where such prayers begin.

Memory Pack

Profile: parallage_memory_pack | Model: gpt-5.5

Translation

Rulers, dukes, marquises, kings, commoners, and ordinary people should not merely pray to spirits and Heaven to preserve their households and their lives to the end; they should also seek this in their [hearts/minds] and in their bodies.

Notes on uncertainty

- [心] is bracketed in the source, so I render it visibly as [hearts/minds] rather than treating it as fully secure.
- 沒身 can mean "until death," "to life's end," or more literally "until the body is gone." Here I translate it as "their lives to the end."
- 祈諸[心]與身 is somewhat compressed: literally, something like "pray/seek it in/at the [heart/mind] and body."

Memory aids — not critical translations

Mnemonic rendering

High or low, do not only ask Heaven and spirits to guard your home and life; also look to your [heart] and body.

Alliterative version

Kings, commoners, and courtly chiefs must not merely beg beyond, to ghosts and Heaven, for house and life; they must also seek security in [heart] and body.

Short rhyme

Do not just pray to Heaven's art
To guard your home and breath;
Seek it too in body and [heart],
From life until death.